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PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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Correction of errors of substance may be made only on the floor of the House with the permission of the Speaker. However, correction of typographical or grammatical errors which Members suggest for the Bound Volumes which will be compiled at the end of the Meeting may be clearly marked in the Daily Report, and the copy containing the corrections submitted at the Editor's Office, Parliament House, not later than four clear days after the publication of the Daily Report.

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Tuesday, 16th December, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 12:48 p.m.*

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER,
MR BERNARD AHIAFOR,
IN THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, there being no Communication from His Excellency the President and by the Speaker, we would take the item numbered 5, *Correction of Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we have for our correction the *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday, 12th December, 2025.

Page 1...13—Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you so much.

Mr Speaker, I have been on my feet since you mentioned the page numbered 10—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Just take note of the page.

Mr Afriyie: On the page numbered 10, the item numbered 10, line 2. I propose that after the name “Dzifa” we delete the word there and insert “Gomashie”.

Then on the page numbered 11, the item numbered 15, that is clause 2—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What should we delete after the name “Dzifa”?

Mr Afriyie: We should delete the word there and insert the name “Gomashie”

I think that the spelling for the name “Gomashie” is incorrect.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, if you would indulge me, on the page numbered 11, the item numbered 15, item number 2, the last but one line which reads,

“The Hon First Deputy Speaker directed the draftsman to reconcile...”. I pray that we insert the word, ‘to’ before the word “reconcile”.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, kindly take note.

Page 12...19—

Mr Afriyie: Yes, the page numbered 18, the item numbered 3 (xix), which reads; “Deputy Director, Department of

Social Welfare, Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Welfare.” The words ‘Social Welfare’ should be deleted to insert ‘Social Protection’.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Are you saying we do not have a Deputy Director, Department of Social Welfare?

Mr Afriyie: No, Mr Speaker. My correction has to do with the proper rendition of the Ministry.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What page number are you talking about?

Mr Afriyie: The page numbered 18, the item numbered 3(xix).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I have seen it. Table, take note.

Page 21...32—

Mr Afriyie: On the page numbered 30, the item numbered 1 which reads: ‘Estimates of the Ministry of...’ May we kindly delete the word ‘the’ before word “Health”.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, take note.

Page 32...35—

Mr Afriyie: The page numbered 35, the item numbered 3(xlvii), I think the word should be “Ankaful Psychiatric” so if the word there can be deleted and the

right spelling used. Consequentially, same should be done on the next paragraph.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, take note.

Page 36...38?

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday, 12th April, 2025, as presented and corrected, is hereby accepted as the true record of proceedings.

12:58 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The *Official Report* of Wednesday, 3rd December, 2025 is under correction.

Hon Members, any correction?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Wednesday, 3rd December, 2025]

Yes, Hon Deputy Majority Leader, any indication?

Deputy Majority Leader (Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan): Yes, Mr Speaker.

I wanted to vary the Order Paper and go to, at the Commencement of Public Business, to lay a few Papers. The item numbered 9(a).

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, the Leader has failed to convince us as to

why we should vary the Order of Business and the reasons are not far-fetched. The Questions have been pending for a very long time. We have agreed to navigate and get many of the Estimates taken. We have done more than 90 per cent of the Estimates. We are just heading towards Appropriation and we know we would be rising soon, on the 19th of December, thereabouts. These Questions advertised in the name of the Minister of State, Public Sector Reforms, have been on the *Order Paper* for a very long time. So, we have to take them because we would be rising on Friday so we have to take these Questions. Otherwise, it would be a problem. Besides, Frontbench, the Minister for Food and Agriculture just wrote to us. I was just given a copy that he cannot come. That is fine. Hon Eric Opoku has been a very dutiful person and I would not begrudge him but his Deputy must be here. If the substantive Minister cannot come, his Deputy, Hon John Dumelo should be here.

Mr Speaker, their application does not find favour with us, so they should find something reasonable to tell us. Of course, we would consider that Bill. We have been given a heads up on the Bank of Ghana Bill and we are going to support them to do it. But before then, the Minister of State, Public Sector Reforms must find her way to the Chamber. I saw the Majority Chief Whip here a while ago. He should step out of the Chamber and call the Deputy Minister for Food and Agriculture. If the Minister cannot come, the Deputy Minister must be here. That was the agreement. Once the Ministers cannot

come to lay a Paper, the Deputy Ministers must be here, where is Hon John Setor Dumelo? So, their application is not finding favour with us. Look at their Backbench; beside the point, look at their Backbench and look at our Side.

Mr Speaker, this is not funny. Deputy Majority Leader, do not smile. They should go and bring their Ministers. At least we have supported them to pass all their Estimates, apart from the Appropriation. We would help them pass the Appropriation Bill as well. Today, we are not going to compromise. They should hurry up and bring their Ministers; they should go and bring their Ministers. Especially the Minister for Food and Agriculture, as I said, we would not begrudge him. Hon Eric Opoku is a dutiful MP I respect, but once he is not here, his Deputy must be here because of the exigencies of time. We are just about rising, so, they should find something reasonable to tell us. Hon Colleagues, do you not agree with me?

Some Members of the Minority:
We agree.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, my Colleague is right that we have received a letter from the Minister for Food and Agriculture that he would not be able to attend to answer these Questions. One would expect that if the Minister will not be here, he would have indicated in his letter also if the Deputy is available to take his place. But it does not say so explicitly. So, as we speak now, we need to find out whether the Deputy is around. But by this letter, I get the impression that the Deputy Minister

is probably not available. Otherwise, the Minister would have indicated that he would not be here but his Deputy would be here to answer the Questions. I would find out where the Deputy Minister is and if he would be able to answer the Questions. On the issue of what has actually been advertised, I think this has been advertised for a while. So, they can understand. The Minister of State, Public Sector Reforms has been here on several occasions. I have spoken with her as to whether she would be able to answer the Questions on a particular day. Unfortunately, because of what we have been doing with the Estimates and all that, we have not been able to accommodate these Questions. So, the Minister of State, Public Sector Reforms probably does not know yet that these Questions are still here and whether she would be given the opportunity to be able to answer them when they are asked.

Mr Speaker, so we will look at how we can get the Minister of State, Public Sector Reforms back to come and answer these Questions. But they have done well in doing some jabbing. That is all right. If the Minister is not available — that is why I did not request to Mr Speaker for the Minister to come and answer the Questions. We would put the arrangement in place so that these Questions are answered. I do agree with them that they should be answered before we leave here, and we will do so.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: We would not litigate this matter. But just to sound a note of, I would not say caution, but

just a reminder that, Hon Leader, when you say that you probably do not know if the Minister is aware or not, that is not a good expression. Because the Table Office — there is a laid down procedure before these Questions are advertised. They have been given prior notification so the Minister must be in the know. Whatever it is, we can compromise for us to make progress. We can progress to take the Bill, item 9(a), that was what you called. Yes, we can progress to take it.

Mr Speaker, that is the compromise we will stage for them. However, we will insist, get the Whip to call the Minister. Wherever he is, he must come. Wherever he is, he must even come with the first flight from Kumasi, Tamale or wherever. He must be here. We cannot compromise on these Questions. These are very important Questions on public sector reform and we know how important that area of the economy is. The Question has been on the *Order Paper* for a very long time and she is a Member of Parliament. Yes, the Minister is a Member of Parliament.

Mr Speaker, we on this Side are insisting. Even as we progress to take item 9(a), Frontbench, their Whip has already abandoned them. That is fine but we have an available Deputy Whip, he can make calls, right? He should step up and call the Minister of State, Public Sector Reforms that Mr Speaker says she must find her way here. Then we can consider the Bank of Ghana Bill while we wait for the Minister of State, Public Sector Reforms.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Deputy Minority Chief Whip, you are the one speaking. Why are you asking him to go and say, Mr Speaker says?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, that can be expunged. I said it with your blessings and I know that you have blessed me. The Deputy Minister for Food and Agriculture must also find his way here. The President must be watching. The first reshuffle must happen. Hon Alfred Okoe Vanderpuije has been waiting; he has been lacing his shoe for a very long time.

The first reshuffle must happen. Hon Leader, tell the President, he must reshuffle the Ministers who are not ready to do Public Business. Hon Zuwera Mohammed Ibrahimah is ready. Hon Francis-Xavier Kojo Sosu for instance has been suffering for long.

Mr Speaker, let us proceed and take item 9(a). We have agreed with our Colleagues; his application finds favour with us. We would take item 9(a) but get the available Whip to call the Deputy Minister.

1:08 p.m.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, my Colleague misunderstood what I said earlier. I did not say the Hon Minister is not aware that this has been advertised. I said it has been advertised for a while and the Hon Minister is aware, and she has been here repeatedly to answer Questions, but anytime she comes, she does not get the opportunity to do so. But for today, I am not quite sure whether she is aware that today it has been advertised.

But I understand, for their information, the Hon Minister is actually around, and we would try and get her to come and answer the Questions when she gets into the Chamber.

So, yes, Mr Speaker, we can take the item numbered 9 (a)

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, at the Commencement of Public Business —Presentation of Papers, the item numbered 9(a), by the Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, the Chairperson of the Committee is not around at the moment. I am trying to get him to come to the Chamber and table this Paper, but can I seek your indulgence to ask another Chairperson to do that on his behalf?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Chief Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, we want to help the Hon Deputy Majority Leader because it is obvious that he is struggling. So, we want to help him. If there is a Member of the Committee, that Member can lay the Report. Fortunately, I was at the Committee meeting with Mr Speaker, and I understand fairly what happened. So, he should get a Member of the Committee and not another Chairperson.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Or we can volunteer to do it for him.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Or I can volunteer to do it for him because I was there with Mr Speaker.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, actually, we have an Hon Deputy Minister here. So, with your indulgence, I would like to invite the Hon Deputy Minister to do that on behalf of the Chairperson.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, is there any Hon Member on the Finance Committee here?

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, this is the Committee on Economy and Development, and there is no Hon Member in sight at the moment.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well, then the item numbered 9(a) is hereby deferred.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, as the Hon Deputy Majority Leader is struggling, I can volunteer to do it.

Mr Speaker, you would bear me witness that I was at the Committee meeting, so I can just do it on behalf of —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But you are not a Member of the Committee. So, Hon Deputy Majority Leader, any other indication?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the Leader could make an application for anybody there to do it; we will support him, but not an Hon Deputy Minister. This is by the Chairperson of a Committee.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, as I said earlier, the Chairperson is not around. I was requesting that the Hon

Deputy Minister does it, but in the absence of it, I can get another Hon Member to do that on his behalf.

Mr Speaker, if you may, may I ask the Chairperson for the Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare, to do that on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee on Economy and Development.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 9(a).

PAPER

By Rev Helen Adjoa Ntoso on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee—

Report of the Committee on Economy and Development on the Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Report is duly presented, and it is for distribution to Hon Members.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, the item numbered 9 (b), and then again, I will ask permission to get the Hon Chairperson for the Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare to do that on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee on Youth and Sports.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the Hon Deputy Majority Leader owes both the House and respected Chair a duty to let us know where the Chairperson is

Mr Speaker, he cannot just get up and say that somebody else should lay the Paper. He needs to let us know where the Chairperson is, and then, if it is the pleasure of the House or the respected Speaker, he would be permitted.

The Leader should please get up and do it.

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, they had a meeting and we agreed that the Chairperson should be here by 1:00 p.m. so that we could lay the Papers. I am surprised that he is still not here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. So, if that is the agreement, accordingly, the item numbered 9(b) is deferred.

Please, any indication?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we want to take the item numbered 10(b), the Hon Minister for Finance gave the indication that he will be here to do it himself, and he is not here.

Mr Speaker, we would defer that —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I would have to take a five-minute suspension and engage the Leadership from both Sides.

1:16 p.m. — *Sitting suspended.*

1:43 p.m. — *Sitting resumed.*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we deferred the presentation

of the Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports on the Ghana Sports Fund Bill. Can we have that Paper laid, and then come back for the Questions? Is there any Member of the Committee on Youth and Sports?

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Yes, Mr Speaker, I think we have a Member of the Youth and Sports Committee here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minority Leadership, may the Member lay the Paper on behalf of the Chairman of the Committee?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we will not object to that.

PAPER

By Ms Lawrence Dziwornu on behalf of the Chairperson—

Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports on the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Report is duly presented, and it is for distribution.

We would then move to Questions.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Yes, Mr Speaker. The Minister is here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, she has already taken the designated seat. Hon Minister, you are welcome. Item 7, the Question numbered 236, standing in the name of Hon Gloria Owusu, Member of Parliament for Trobu Constituency.

Mr Fredrick Addy: Mr Speaker, I come under Order 88(3). May I seek your leave to ask the Question on behalf of the Hon Member?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, my leave can only be conditioned on you having her authority.

Mr Addy: Mr Speaker, I have the authority from the Hon Member.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, so say that for the record. You may go ahead and ask the Question.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTER OF STATE (PUBLIC SECTOR REFORMS)

Specific Reforms to Improve Efficiency, Transparency and Accountability

Mr Fredrick Addy on behalf of Ms Gloria Owusu (NPP — Trobu): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister of State in Charge of Public Sector Reforms what specific reforms the Ministry is implementing to improve efficiency, transparency and accountability.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Minister of State in Charge of Public Sector Reforms (Ms Lydia Lamisi Akanvariba) (MP): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for giving me the opportunity.

Mr Speaker, the Public Sector Reform Secretariat (PSRS) exists to improve public service delivery by

initiating, facilitating and coordinating reforms for timely and transparent services to promote private sector-led growth and national development using innovation and professional staff. Our vision is to have a responsive public sector with reformed services for national development.

Mr Speaker, over the years, the Secretariat developed the National Public Sector Reform Strategy (NPSRS 2018–2023), themed “Delivering for Citizens and the Private Sector,” that aimed to enhance public service delivery and support private sector growth. The NPSRS I primarily focused on improving efficiency, accountability, and service delivery.

Mr Speaker, the Public Sector Reform for Results Project (PSRRP) was a partial implementation of the NPSRS I, funded with a credit facility from the World Bank during the period 2019–2024 to improve efficiency and accountability in the delivery of selected services.

Mr Speaker, under the PSRRP, the Secretariat coordinated reform initiatives to improve service delivery in some selected public institutions. These included:

1. Births and Deaths Registry (BDR)
2. Driver and Vehicle Licensing Authority (DVLA)
3. Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice (CHRAJ)

4. Passport Office (PO)
5. Public Services Commission (PSC)
6. Office of the Head of the Civil Service (OHCS)
7. Ministry of Transport (MoT)
8. Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology (MEST)
9. Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs (MoLGCRA)
10. Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA)
11. National Information Technology Agency (NITA)
12. Public Sector Reform Secretariat (PSRS)
13. Monitoring and Evaluation Secretariat (MES)

Some of the people-centred services being provided:

- i. DVLA Mobile App: The application has been developed primarily to enable citizens and the motoring public to access various services such as application-related/informational services, payment of DVLA services and other citizen-centric functionalities.
- ii. Installation of a Queue Management System in four (4) DVLA Offices.
- iii. DVLA Mobile Services: targeted DVLA services to institutions, made use of a cashless payment system.
- iv. DVLA Tertiary Drive (TertDrive): targeted DVLA services to tertiary institutions, made use of a cashless payment system.
- v. CHRAJ Electronic Case Management System: This system has also been developed to receive, track and manage complaints that CHRAJ handles. The system has enhanced accessibility, reliability, efficiency, transparency, and accountability of CHRAJ services. It has streamlined CHRAJ's internal processes, reducing the time it takes to resolve complaints and improving the accuracy of data and records.
- vi. Upgraded BDR website to a world-class, dynamic and responsive database-driven website, integrating a grievance redress mechanism

Mr Speaker, the PSRRP used these strategies and innovative practices to ensure efficiency and accountability in public service delivery:

Business Process Reviews and Re-engineering to streamline processes of frontline service delivery, agencies and other government institutions, such as the Driver and Vehicle Licensing Authority (DVLA), the Births and Deaths Registry (BDR), the Passport Office (PO) and the Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice (CHRAJ), to deliver people-centred services.

and a chatbot software into the web portal.

- vii. Harmonisation of the three (3) silo applications of the Births and Deaths Registry into one centralised system to ensure the integrity of data, and ease retrieval of data.

The development of the Comprehensive Gender Strategy for the Public Sector (CGSPS 2024-2028) aims to mainstream gender consideration into the operations of the public service.

The standardisation and improvement of Client Service Charters include compliance reports to assess the adequacy of the standards for each of the services rendered, ascertain the level of satisfaction of clients and gain feedback from clients on how to improve services. All Ministries, Departments, Agencies and Public Sector Organisations are to go by these standards to deliver services.

1:28 p.m.

Equipment modernisation: State-of-the-art equipment (computers, printers, multi-purpose photocopiers, finger print reader, scanners, signature pads, video conferencing systems) were procured and delivered to selected entities (DVLA, Ministry of Transport, BDR, Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs, Public Services Commission, Office of the Head of the Civil Service, CHRAJ, Ministry of Monitoring and Evaluation and Passport Office) to replace obsolete equipment, digitalise manual processes leading to improved efficiency in service delivery.

Mr Speaker, on the One-Stop-Shops for Service Delivery, the PSRS is championing the reintroduction and establishment of One-Stop-Shops (OSSs) across the country, which will deepen public service accessibility at the decentralised level.

Mr Speaker, under the PSRRP, a draft framework and strategy for the implementation of One-Stop-Shops (OSSs) was developed, drawing from the best international practices and lessons learned from the previous pilot implementation (2014-2015). The Secretariat will undertake a feasibility study to assess its viability, identify bottlenecks and determine a viable implementation approach.

Mr Speaker, the OSS will provide consolidated access to multiple public sector services through three (3) models.

Model one: Single Door-Multiple Windows will render multiple services in one physical location.

Model two: Single Door-Single Window will deploy trained personnel to render multiple public services on behalf of the respective public institutions.

Model three: No-Door-No Window will render single window systems through a web-based portal, call centre and mobile platforms.

This means citizens will have access to passports, driver licenses, pension services, Government permits and other key public services through these platforms.

Mr Speaker, the citizens of Ghana have high expectations of service levels and experience, as they are increasingly demanding timely, responsive, and transparent service delivery. The OSS can be beneficial, especially to persons with disabilities (PWDs) and groups of citizens who reside in remote communities. The OSS will represent a visible commitment of Government to improve service delivery and increase accountability.

Mr Speaker, presently, the Secretariat is working assiduously to finalise the National Public Sector Reform Strategy (NPSRS II) to build on the gains made from the implementation of the previous NPSRS I. The Strategy aims to reengineer public sector business processes, digitalise workflow, create a conducive work environment that enhances productivity, and promote discipline across the workforce.

Mr Speaker, a Technical Committee has been inaugurated to finalise the National Public Sector Reform Strategy (NPSRS II). The NPSRS focuses on these seven (7) pillars:

1. A citizen and private sector-oriented public sector.
2. A capable and disciplined workforce.
3. Strengthened public sector regulatory framework.
4. Modern and improved working conditions.

5. Strengthened local governance structures.
6. Digitalised public sector systems and services.
7. Sustainable funding for public sector reforms.

Mr Speaker, the NPSRS II will also take into consideration emerging issues such as Greening Public Administration and Climate Change. These indicated areas are not exhaustive, and any other transformative innovations aimed at driving digital governance will be considered.

Mr Speaker, on the Open Government Partnership Initiative, PSRS also facilitates and coordinates the implementation of the Open Government Partnership (OGP) in Ghana. The OGP is a multilateral initiative aiming to secure concrete commitments from governments to promote transparency and accountability, empower citizens through public participation, and fight corruption by harnessing new technologies to strengthen governance. Ghana signed onto the initiative in September 2011, and has since developed and implemented four (4) OGP National Action Plans with specific commitments that the country had reported on to the global fraternity through the Global Secretariat. The 5th OGP National Action Plan that was adopted and published in December 2023, is under implementation from 2023-2027. The 5th National Action Plan contains eighteen (18) commitments in the areas of transparency, accountability, citizen

participation, technology and innovation, open Parliament and justice. These commitments are being implemented by Ministries, Departments and Agencies in collaboration with Civil Society Organisations (CSOs) and other State Actors. Mr Speaker, the implementation of these commitments will improve efficiency, transparency and accountability in the public sector.

Detailed Commitments in Ghana's 5th Open Government Partnership National Action Plan

Ghana's commitments under ACCOUNTABILITY are focused on:

Asset declaration:

- Pass the Conduct of Public Officers Bill into law, ensuring that provisions on assets declaration require verification and come with severe sanctions for non-compliance.
- Develop regulations to fully operationalise the Conduct of Public Officers' Bill when passed into law.

Lead implementing institution:
Office of the Attorney General and Ministry of Justice

Witness Protection Act:

- Provide effective protection for persons who are exposed to danger for witnessing in criminal prosecutions, by passing regulations

to the Witness Protection Act, 2018 (Act 975) and setting up the Witness Protection Agency.

Lead implementing institution:
Office of the Attorney General and Ministry of Justice

Public Accounts Committee and Audit Report Implementation:

- Ensure effective implementation of Audit recommendations from Internal Auditors, External Auditors, Audit Committees and Public Accounts Committee on the reports of the Auditor-General and Management Letters by Public Institutions by building the capacity of Internal Audit Units (IAUs), Audit Committees, Heads and Boards of Public Institutions to implement the new Audit Report Recommendations and Implementation Instructions (ARR&I).

Lead implementing institution:
Internal Audit Agency

Anti-money Laundering and Combating Terrorism Financing (AML/CTF):

- Effectively implement the Anti-Money Laundering Act, 2020 (Act 1044) to ensure that Ghana does not get blacklisted again for lapses in the country's AML/CTF regime.

Lead implementing institution:
Financial Intelligence Centre

Enabling CHRAJ's Administrative Justice Delivery Mandate:

- Develop a comprehensive online/web-based complaint and redress system on all mandate areas of the Commission to enable it to perform its administrative justice delivery mandate better.

Lead implementing institution: Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice

Health Service Delivery

- Ensure greater accountability in the health sector by establishing digital platforms to facilitate complaints and feedback on quality-of-service delivery.
- Uncap the NHIA funds to ensure prompt disbursement and release of NHIA allocations to primary healthcare centres.

Lead implementing institution: Ministry of Health

Ghana's commitments under Transparency are focused on:

Power Purchasing Agreements:

- Amend the PURC Act to expand its mandate to include public disclosure of PPAs.
- The proposed amendment will also make power sector contracting process open and transparent.

Lead implementing institution: Ministry of Energy/Public Utility Regulatory Commission

Right to Information:

The commitments are three-fold:

- Create public awareness on the RTI Act, 2019 (Act 989), how it operates and obligations of public institutions.
- Pass Regulations to fully operationalise the RTI Act, 2019 (Act 989).
- Provide adequate funding for the implementation of the RTI Act, 2019 (Act 989).

Lead implementing institution: Right to Information Commission

Fisheries Transparency:

- The commitment is to pass a new Fisheries and Aquaculture Act, 2025 (Act 1143) or amend the existing one to provide for greater transparency in the fisheries sector.

Lead implementing institution: Ministry of Fisheries and Aquaculture Development

Ghana's commitments under Citizen Participation are focused on:

Citizens' Complaints Centre: (CCC):

- The commitment is to establish a coordinated and syndicated citizen

feedback mechanism on public policy and public service delivery.

Lead implementing institution:
Public Sector Reform Secretariat/
Commission on Human Rights and
Administrative Justice

Gender Equality:

- Ensure the progressive increase in women's political participation at all levels of government, by passing the Affirmative Action Bill into law.

Lead implementing institution:
Ministry of Gender, Children and Social
Protection

Citizen Participation in Local
Government:

The commitment is two-fold:

- Enhance Citizens' Participation in Local Gov't through election of MMDCEs.
- Enhance Opportunities for Political Participation of Persons with Disability by passing the Persons with Disability Re-enactment Bill, and the accompanying legislative instruments.

Lead implementing institution:
Ministry of Local Government,
Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs

Ghana's commitments under
Technology and Innovation are focused
on:

Misinformation and Disinformation:

The commitment is two-fold:

- Implement structures to combat Misinformation/Disinformation on digital platforms.
- Strengthen the provisions in the Electronic Communications Act, 2008 (Act 775) and the Criminal Offences Act, 1960 (Act 29) to deter misinformation and disinformation on digital platforms.

Lead implementing institution:
Information Services Department

Collaborating state institution:
Ministry of Communication, Digital
Technology and Innovations

Technology and Innovation: Data
Sharing and Intermediation of Public
Service Delivery Platforms:

- Strengthen Data sharing and intermediation among public service delivery platforms.

Lead implementing institution:
Ministry of Communication, Digital
Technology and Innovations

Ghana's commitment on Open
Parliament focused on:

The commitment is three-fold:

- Establish oversight mechanism in Parliament to ensure the

achievement of the national OGP commitments.

- Enhance access to information on parliament's work in an easily accessible, user friendly, and timely manner.
- Increase engagement between Parliament and citizens.

Lead implementing institution:
Parliament of Ghana

Ghana's commitments under Justice are focused on:

Passage into law of the Community Service Bill:

The commitment is in three-fold components:

- Pass the Community Sentencing Bill into law by 2026.
- Create public awareness of the law.
- Build the capacity of stakeholders for smooth implementation of the law.

Lead implementing institution:
Ministry of the Interior

Passage of Draft Legislative Instrument and Legal Aid Commission (Implementation of Paralegal System) Regulations 2024:

The commitment is in two-fold components:

- Pass into law the draft Legal Aid Commission Legislative Instrument and paralegal framework for legal aid delivery in Ghana.

- Create public awareness/sensitisation on the legislative instrument and paralegal guide for legal aid delivery, when passed into law.

Lead implementing institution: Legal Aid Commission

Transparency in Road Sector and Flagship Health Infrastructure Projects:

The commitment is two-fold:

- Enhance transparency and foster public trust by providing seamless access to data on road infrastructure projects, facilitating participatory monitoring, and informed citizen engagement in decision-making processes.
- Develop and implement a robust accountability mechanism for flagship infrastructure projects that ensures public disclosure of project data, incorporates independent audits and participatory evaluation to ensure alignment with project goals, specifications and budget.

Lead implementation institution:
Ministry of Roads and Highways

Thank you very much.

1:38 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is a very elaborate answer. Hon Member, is there any supplementary question?

Yes, Hon Boamah-Nyarko? Have you changed your seating place?

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I came to confer with my Leader. Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

Mr Speaker, I will put two questions in one. The first is referencing the objective of the Ministry to promote the private sector-led growth and national development using innovation and professional staff. My first question is; what practical steps has the Ministry taken this year to improve—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, the rule is that you ask one question after the other.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: So, Mr Speaker, my first question is to ask the Minister that following her response, what pragmatic steps has the Ministry taken to promote the professionalism of staff to deliver on this public sector reform?

Ms Akanvariba: Currently, the Ministry works with other ministries; we do not work in isolation. We coordinate reforms. So, if any other ministry wants to have reforms, we look at their staff strength and capabilities, to find out exactly what they want them to do and

whether they have the needed capacity to go into that particular reform.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, in the Minister's response to this House, referencing the standardisation and improvement of client service charters to include compliance reports, she said that all Ministries, Departments, and Agencies (MDAs), and public sector organisations are to go by these standards to deliver services. I know that a number of the MDAs have not developed the service charters based upon which Ghanaians are supposed to measure their effectiveness and efficiency.

Can the Minister assist this House in terms of what the status of the provision of service charters by these government agencies? And what are we going to do to publicise it for Ghanaians to know the availability of these charters to hold them accountable?

Ms Akanvariba: In the answer, I mentioned to the House that I have inaugurated a committee that is working on the National Public Sector Reform Strategy, and all the agencies and departments are part of that committee. We are about 21 in number. Currently, the Public Service Commission and the Civil Service have their charter and they have their code of conduct. Because of that, we have incorporated all the ministries and departments into it, so that we can work together to make sure that all the other agencies or ministries that do not have it, also have theirs. As a nurse, I know that Ghana Health Services

has their charter and their code of conduct as well. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We will then move to the Question numbered 249, standing in the name of Hon Samuel Awuku, Member of Parliament for Akuapem North.

Digitalisation of Public Service and Reduction of Bureaucratic Delays at Key Government Agencies

Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh *on behalf of Mr Samuel Awuku (NPP — Akuapem North):* Mr Speaker, I come under Standing Order 88 (3). I have the permission of the Member of Parliament, Hon Samuel Awuku, to ask the Question for—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, we do not work with permission.

Mr Ayeh: Authority, Mr Speaker. I am guided. I have the authority of the Member of Parliament, Mr Samuel Awuku, to ask the Question on his behalf.

Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister of State in Charge of Public Sector Reforms what steps are being taken to digitise public services and reduce bureaucratic delays at key Government agencies.

Ms Akanvariba: Mr Speaker, the Public Sector Reform Secretariat, is taking the following steps to digitalise public services and reduce bureaucratic delays in key Government institutions.

Steps

The National Public Sector Reform Strategy (NPSRS)

Mr Speaker, two (2) pillars of the NPSRS II are specifically linked to digitalising public services to reduce bureaucratic delays:

Pillar 1: A Citizen and Private Sector-Oriented Public Sector.

Programme One of Pillar One seeks to optimise processes for digital transformation by conducting process audits to identify and analyse existing processes to pinpoint inefficiencies and bottlenecks. Adopt technologies such as e-governance platforms, automated workflow, and digital record-keeping to streamline operations. A user feedback loop will be established to regularly review and refine processes based on performance data.

Programme Three of Pillar One seeks to create One-Stop-Shops at strategic locations and online to provide various related services. Provide citizens and private sector with timely, simple and easy access to public services.

Additionally, Mr Speaker, re-engineer service delivery business processes to reduce waiting time, either in person, online or otherwise. This includes making services available electronically, improving customer service (courtesy, guidance, helpdesk), ensuring predictable service turnaround times (standards), reducing bureaucracy

and paperwork (red tape), simplify forms and documents and creating easy access to information about the service.

Pillar 6: Digitalised Public Sector Systems and Services

Programme One of Pillar 6 seeks to expand and enhance the following activities to increase access to citizens:

- Ensure digitalisation to support broader policy making on NITA across institutions.
- Educate and train public servants in e-service management under the NITA programme.
- Introduce online service delivery and e-client service charters to facilitate business operations, for example, timely online acquisition of licenses, passports, business certificates and property identification.
- Standardise digital operations within institutions and across Government institutions; and
- Capture and digitise staff profiles for performance appraisal.

These steps will target the following key Government institutions and frontline service delivery Agencies:

- i. Births and Deaths Registry (BDR)
- ii. Ghana Immigration Service (GIS)

- iii. Driver and Vehicle Licensing Authority (DVLA)
- iv. National Identification Authority (NIA)
- v. Passport Office
- vi. Office of the Registrar of Companies (ORC)
- vii. National Information Technology Agency (NITA)

Mr Ayeh: Mr Speaker, I only want to ask a question on pillar 6: Digitalised Public Sector Systems and Services. With all the institutions that have been mentioned, are we looking at a specific timeline for some of these things?

2:14 p.m.

Ms Akanvariba: Thank you, Mr Speaker, and thank you, Hon Member.

We are doing all these things because we want to make sure that people can work 24 hours in this country. So, we are working with the 24-Hour Economy to make sure that what we have put on paper and are working on, will come to fruition. So please, I cannot give him timelines, but I can tell him that in due course, we will roll it out.

Mr Ayeh: Mr Speaker, Programme 3 of Pillar 1 seeks to create one-stop shops at strategic locations and online to provide various related services. On this online platform, have there been some steps taken to look at the platform that is going to hold all these one-stop shops, or

is it still something that they are looking at?

Ms Akanvariba: About the one-stop shop, it is something that has been done before, and the framework has already been created. We are going to look at the reasons it did not work well, and then we would now put in measures to make sure that it works well. Because of that, I have travelled to Uganda; they call it “Mesob”. We have another model from Azerbaijan. They are ready to help us work on it, and we also have one in Ethiopia. I believe with those kinds of benchmarks; we would be able to make sure that it works well. It is either going to be online or physical in a shop, or at a particular place where one can go and get whatever they want in one shop. That is why we have the various models. We look at which model will work best for us.

Thank you.

Mr Ayeh: Mr Speaker, I am grateful for the opportunity.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Referencing Programme 1 of Pillar 6, she talked about capturing and digitalising staff profiles for performance appraisal. She indicated the targeted key government institutions. Can the Minister help this House understand, as of now, what the status of digitalising the staff profile is, and which government institutions, as she has shortlisted currently, have initiated this status?

Ms Akanvariba: Mr Speaker, if you look at the NPSRS 1, we try to work with the institutions to make sure that they have what it takes for us to work with the staff. So, NPSRS 2 will now help us to train the staff to be able to work with whatever we are provided.

For instance, if one goes to Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice, we have the case management system. In that case management system, we are building their capacity to be able to use the equipment that has been provided in the first phase. In the second phase, we will be training the staff to be able to work with whatever we provided for those institutions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we then move to the Question numbered 500, standing in the name of Hon Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta, Member of Parliament for Fanteakwa South. Hon Member, you have the floor.

Improving Records Management through PRAAD's Digitisation Programme and Plans for Further Digitisation in 2025

Mr Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta (NPP — Fanteakwa South): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister of State in Charge of Public Sector Reform how the Public Records and Archives Administration Department (PRAAD) digitisation of 55,259 archival sheets and disposal of 8,540 boxes is improving records management, efficiency and what

resources have been allocated for further digitisation in 2025.

Ms Akanvariba: Mr Speaker, the Public Records and Archives Administration Department (PRAAD) is a cost centre under the Office of the Head of Civil Service (OHCS), that is responsible for the proper and effective Management of records in all public institutions of Government. With resources allocated by the Government of Ghana, PRAAD digitised 55,259 No. of sheets exceeding its target of 50,000 No. of sheets in 2024.

Mr Speaker, the digitalisation of the 55,259 sheets and the disposal of 8,540 boxes achieved the following:

1. Increased accessibility and sharing of information: In the long run, digitised materials can be easily shared and accessed by a wider audience, regardless of location or time.
2. Support good governance, accountability, and compliance.
3. Improved preservation: Digital copies have helped preserve original materials from loss, reduced the handling of records from deterioration.
4. Faster information retrieval: Digital materials can be quickly searched and retrieved, saving time and effort.
5. Cost-effectiveness: Digital materials can reduce printing and storage costs.
6. Reduced storage burden of institutions: It helps to remove obsolete records from offices, freeing up storage and working spaces, and prevents overcrowding in Records offices.
7. Enhanced engagement: In the long run, interactive digital content can engage users and enhance the learning experience.
8. Historical heritage preservation: The digitalisation of the record materials has helped to preserve Ghana's historical heritage.

Resource allocated for further digitalisation in 2025

Mr Speaker, an amount of One Hundred and Thirty-Eight Thousand Ghana Cedis (GHS138,000.00) has been allocated to PRAAD for the digitalisation of records in 2025. It could be concluded that this amount is woefully inadequate for the Department to carry out the digitalisation project.

Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary?

Mr Ofori-Atta: Yes, Mr Speaker. I wish to know from the Hon Minister how many sheets were digitalised in 2025 from the amount of money presented.

Ms Akanvariba: Mr Speaker, the year has not yet ended, so we cannot put our fingers on figures for now because the year has to end before we know how many papers have been discharged. Thank you very much.

Mr Ofori-Atta: Mr Speaker, I wish to ask the Minister how the House can support her in asking the Minister for Finance for more funding for this exercise.

2:24 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I wish to ask the Minister

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, ask specific questions. Any other question?

Mr Ofori-Atta: No further questions, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Yes, Hon Patrick Yaw Boamah?

Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah: Mr Speaker, in the Answer of the Hon Minister, she said that an amount of GH¢138,000 was allocated to Public Records and Archives Administration Department (PRAAD) in 2025. I want to find out from her if she took into consideration the amount that was allocated to PRAAD in 2026 in her Answer to this House, because last week, we approved the budgetary allocation to the Office of the Head of Civil Service, and I made my submissions on PRAAD. So, I want to find out from her whether this Answer looked into the allocations made to PRAAD.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: In the Answer that she has given?

Mr Boamah: Yes.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, you can provide an Answer to his question without quoting what is contained in the budget. If the Member wants that, the Member can ask a specific Question. You may go ahead and answer the rest.

Ms Akanvariba: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

I have looked at the figures that have been quoted, but that alone will not necessarily give us an idea of how much is going to be released to the PRAAD. So, we cannot, for now, just say that this is the amount that they are going to give them, because the release has to come from the Minister for Finance.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Question time is ended. I wish to thank the Hon Minister for attending upon the House to respond to Questions on the *Order Paper* for today. You are hereby discharged.

Before I take indications from the Hon Majority Chief Whip, indulge me to acknowledge the presence of students from St Joseph Anglican Basic School, who are here with their teachers, Solomon Narh, Ernest Darko, Isaac Agbemabiase, and Wisdom Nkwasende. They are from Okaikwei South Constituency. Is the Hon Member for Okaikwei South Constituency here? They are 66 in number. We also have Ampah Basic School, led by Benjamin Bortie, a teacher. They are from Effutu, and are 49 in number. We also have Nsuekyie Basic School, led by Francisca Atamakira, a teacher. They are also from

Effutu, and are 36 in number. We have National Commission for Civic Education, led by Araba B. Entsiwah and Sena-Bosson Amedenu. They are 18 in number and I guess they are from various constituencies. Then we have KPCE Demonstration School, led by Antwi Alexander, the headteacher. They are from Abuakwa South, and they are 66 in number.

On your behalf, Hon Members, I welcome our dear students to Parliament of Ghana and wish them a fruitful visit. We also have in our midst, Rev Father Andrew Nii Lante Campbell, founder of Lepers Aid Committee, in charge of Weija Leprosarium. He is also the former priest of Christ the King Catholic Church. Rev Father, you are most welcome to the Parliament of Ghana. Enjoy your visit.

[Students of St Joseph Anglican Basic School were acknowledged]

[Students of Ampah Basic School were acknowledged]

[Students of Nsuekyie Basic School were acknowledged]

[Members of National Commission for Civic Education were acknowledged]

[Students and teachers of KPCE Demonstration School were acknowledged]

[Rev Father Andrew Nii Lante Campbell was acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I pray that we take the Motion numbered 24. Mr Speaker, this Report has been outstanding for some time. So, we agree that we take it out of the way and then we can deal with the Bank of Ghana (BoG) Report.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I think we can proceed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Chairman of the Committee?

MOTION

The Status of Sanitation of Selected MMDAs in Greater Accra and Ashanti Regions

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr John Kwabena Oti Bless): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House adopts Report of the Committee on Sanitation and Water Resources on Monitoring Visits to Selected Metropolitan, Municipal and District Assemblies in the Greater Accra and Ashanti Regions to Assess the State of Sanitation.

Mr Speaker, in doing so, I would like to present the Report of your Committee. Unfortunately, this Report was supposed to have been taken last week, so copies were shared to Members last week, but I am informed that copies have been uploaded onto the console. I ask that the *Hansard* should capture the entire Report as having been read.

Introduction

The Parliamentary Select Committee on Sanitation and Water Resources, as part of its oversight mandate and in line with its 2025 Work Plan, undertook monitoring visits to selected Metropolitan, Municipal and District Assemblies (MMDAs) in the Greater Accra and Ashanti Regions respectively. The Committee also visited the Integrated Recycling and Composting Plants (IRECOP) and Sewerage treatment facility in Accra managed by Zoomlion Ghana Limited in Accra and Kumasi. The purpose of these visits was to assess the state of sanitation management in the Assembly, review the implementation of key sanitation projects, and engage with stakeholders to identify opportunities for strengthening Ghana's sanitation sector.

Background: The State of Sanitation in Ghana

Sanitation remains a critical public health and development issue in Ghana. In urban centres like Accra and Kumasi, the challenges are compounded by rapid population growth, urban sprawl, inadequate infrastructure, and poor waste disposal practices, often resulting in flooding, water pollution, and outbreaks of diseases such as cholera, diarrhea, malaria among others.

Over the years, the government has launched various initiatives to address sanitation concerns. Key among them is the establishment of the Ministry of Sanitation and Water Resources (MSWR) in 2017, the Sanitation

Improvement Package (SIP), Youth Employment Agency (YEA), and the implementation of internationally supported projects such as the Greater Accra Metropolitan Area (GAMA) and Greater Kumasi Metropolitan Area (GKMA) Sanitation and Water Projects. Nonetheless, progress has been uneven, largely due to funding constraints, low public adherence to proper sanitation practices, limited enforcement of sanitation regulations, and infrastructural gaps.

The Government-Zoomlion Partnership

In an effort to accelerate progress in the sanitation sector, the Government of Ghana entered into a strategic public-private partnership with Zoomlion Ghana Limited, under which the company is tasked with providing a broad range of sanitation services under the Sanitation Improvement Package (SIP), including waste collection, street cleaning, recycling, and disinfection services. Zoomlion also spearheads the development and operation of the IRECOP facilities, which are designed to promote waste recycling and composting, reduce landfill reliance, and create green jobs.

The partnership, while ambitious in scope, has attracted mixed reactions from various stakeholders. The initiative has driven significant infrastructural improvements and expanded service coverage across communities. However, public scrutiny has emerged regarding contract transparency, value-for-money of provided services, and long-term operational viability. These concerns are

particularly relevant given the documented delays in government payment disbursements and challenges with establishing effective off-taker agreements for compost and recyclable materials.

The situation is further complicated by funding allocation issues, with questions about how sanitation levies are being distributed and utilised. The Committee therefore embarked on a monitoring visit to ascertain the challenges and get firsthand information on the implementation of the sanitation programme by the service providers at the MMDAs.

Objectives of the Visit

The primary objectives of the monitoring visit were to:

- i. Assess the sanitation infrastructure systems in place within the Metropolitan, Municipal and District Assemblies.
- ii. Evaluate the performance of private waste contractors and public service providers.
- iii. Identify challenges faced by the Assemblies in enforcing sanitation by-laws and ensuring compliance.
- iv. Explore the collaborative roles of stakeholders including Environmental Health Departments, service providers, and community members.

- v. Recommend policy or operational interventions to improve sanitation outcomes in the Greater Accra Region.

Municipal Assemblies Visited

The Committee visited the following Municipal Assemblies:

1. Accra Metropolitan Assembly (AMA)
2. Korle Klottey Municipal Assembly
3. Ayawaso Central Municipal Assembly
4. Ablekuma North Municipal Assembly
5. Ablekuma West Municipal Assembly
6. Weija-Gbawe Municipal Assembly
7. Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly
8. Ejisu Metropolitan Assembly
9. Bekwai Metropolitan Assembly
10. Adansi North District Assembly

Acknowledgement

The Committee acknowledges the invaluable support and cooperation of all Municipal Chief Executives (MCEs), Coordinating Directors, and staff of the selected Metropolitan, Municipal, and

District Assemblies (MMDAs) in the Greater Accra and Ashanti Regions for their active participation during the monitoring visits.

Special appreciation is extended to the management and staff of Zoomlion Ghana Limited and the Integrated Recycling and Composting Plants (IRECOP) in Accra and Kumasi for facilitating the Committee's assessment of ongoing operations and for providing detailed briefings on their contributions to Ghana's sanitation management agenda.

The Committee also expresses gratitude to officials from the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs, Environmental Health Directorates, and other stakeholders who engaged meaningfully throughout the exercise, offering insights and recommendations crucial to the Committee's oversight function. Their collaborative spirit greatly enhanced the success of the monitoring visits and informed the Committee's deliberations on ways to strengthen sanitation governance and service delivery in Ghana.

Stakeholder Engagements

The Committee met with Metropolitan, Municipal and District Chief Executives (MMDCEs) and Coordinating Directors, who shared firsthand experiences on sanitation management at the Assembly level. Their input highlighted the administrative and financial hurdles faced in executing sanitation policies and maintaining infrastructure.

The Committee also engaged with Environmental Health Officers, whose role in enforcement of sanitation by-laws at the local level and community education is critical. These officers shed light on the logistical and human resource limitations hampering their ability to ensure compliance with sanitation by-laws. Their feedback emphasised the need for increased staffing, training, and the provision of basic tools and equipment.

Also, present were representatives from Zoomlion Ghana Limited, who participated in the discussions, offering perspectives on the operational challenges of waste collection, including delays in payments, high fuel costs, and access to functional disposal sites.

These stakeholder engagements offered a well-rounded perspective on both the systemic challenges and emerging solutions, equipping the Committee with the insights needed to inform effective, inclusive, and responsive policy interventions.

Findings of the Committee

Accra Metropolitan Assembly (AMA)

The Committee identified significant challenges in sanitation and waste management within the metropolis. The Committee was informed that though the metropolis generates about 4,000 tons of waste daily, existing facilities can only support the management and processing of only 2000 tons, leaving the remaining 2000.

Despite efforts to improve infrastructure through the construction of integrated recycling and compost plants and the procurement of equipment such as skip loaders and refuse containers, the system remains hampered by critical issues including delayed payments to service providers, difficulties in land acquisition for sanitation facilities, inadequate infrastructure, poor waste disposal behaviours among residents, and insufficient prioritisation of sanitation services at governmental levels.

Additionally, the financial sustainability of waste management operations is of great concern, with ongoing debates about dedicated funding sources and innovative financing mechanisms. These challenges collectively undermine service delivery and sanitation outcomes in Ghana's capital, requiring urgent attention to funding models, infrastructure development, and behavioural change initiatives to create a more effective and sustainable waste management system.

Status of Refuse Collection Sites

The Committee noted that out of the fifteen (15) designated refuse collection sites under the jurisdiction of AMA, only eight (8) were found to have clean and emptied containers at the time of inspection. The remaining sites were either overwhelmed by waste or lacked basic infrastructure for proper refuse management. This reflects a systemic lapse in routine maintenance and timely waste collection.

Critical Locations Lacking Basic Waste Infrastructure

The Committee observed that, areas such as Chorkor No. 7, Attoh Quarshie, and Chemuanaa, were operating without any waste containers. Residents in these communities were either compelled to dump waste on the ground or resorted to unauthorised dumping practices, exacerbating public health risks. Other sites, while equipped with containers, were severely overflowing, leading to the spillage of waste into surrounding public spaces and drainage systems.

Challenges with the Sanitation Improvement Package (SIP) Contract

It was also noted that, the current waste collection framework under the Sanitation Improvement Package (SIP), administered in partnership with Zoomlion Ghana Limited, has not yielded consistent results. The contractual obligations outlined in the SIP appear not to be met in practice, with irregular waste pickups and a general lack of operational oversight. These inconsistencies have contributed to public dissatisfaction and undermined the credibility of the waste management programme.

Concerns Raised by AMA Officials

Officials within the AMA expressed significant frustration over the implementation of the SIP, specifically citing lack of consultation prior to the contract's signing. According to multiple sources within the Assembly, the terms of the agreement with Zoomlion were

finalised without engaging key local stakeholders, including AMA's technical and planning units. This lack of involvement has created operational disconnects and limited the Assembly's ability to hold service providers accountable.

In conclusion, AMA's experience illustrates critical deficiencies in both infrastructure and policy implementation. The lack of containers at strategic points, coupled with inefficient service delivery and a top-down contractual arrangement, has impeded progress toward improved sanitation in Ghana's capital. Coordinated stakeholder engagement, rigorous monitoring, and investment in local capacity are essential to rectifying these challenges.

Korle Klottey Municipal Assembly (KOKMA)

During a visit to the Korle Klottey Municipal Assembly (KoKMA), the Committee noted that KoKMA was grappling with multifaceted sanitation and waste management challenges that stem primarily from severe logistical limitations and complex urban dynamics including:

Logistical and Resource Constraints

The Committee was informed by the Municipal Environmental Health Director, that the Assembly was experiencing critical logistical constraints that hinder effective sanitation enforcement and waste management operations which include:

i. Rising Cost of Fuel and Spare Parts

The rising cost of fuel and spare parts has placed an additional financial burden on waste management operations. The increase in operational expenses limits the frequency and reach of waste collection services within the Municipality. Service providers within the municipalities are unable to maintain regular service schedules, leading to further delays and inefficiencies in waste collection and disposal.

ii. Overloaded Refuse Vehicles

Vehicles are often forced to carry more than their designed capacity due to limited fleet availability and high collection demands. These overloaded vehicles not only degrade quickly, increasing maintenance needs and costs, but also pose safety risks and contribute to road damage, traffic congestion and spillage of refuse on roads on the way to final disposal sites.

Budget Strain from Enforcement Activities

The Committee again observed that one of the key challenges outlined was the high cost of night patrol operations, which are essential for curbing the rising trend of illegal waste dumping. These operations, though necessary, place a heavy financial burden on the Assembly, stretching already limited resources and making it difficult to sustain other essential sanitation programs. The cost of fuel, allowances for sanitation officers, and logistics for night

monitoring have all contributed to this budgetary pressure.

Urban Sanitation Complications

The Committee again observed that beyond logistical issues, Korle Klottey faces urban-specific challenges that complicate sanitation efforts. The widespread littering of public spaces, particularly in market areas and busy intersections, remains a persistent problem. This issue is further exacerbated by the visible presence of street beggars and mentally ill individuals, many of whom reside or roam within the municipality's public spaces without access to shelter or sanitary facilities. Their presence, though symptomatic of broader social welfare gaps, contributes to indiscriminate waste disposal and public health concerns.

Inefficiencies in Waste Collection and Disposal

The Committee observed significant inefficiencies in the waste management chain, particularly concerning the backlog in refuse collection and constraints at disposal sites. The accumulation of uncollected waste in many urban and peri-urban communities has created unsightly environments and poses serious public health risks, including the spread of communicable diseases and the proliferation of pests and insects.

A major contributing factor to this backlog is the limited capacity and poor accessibility of waste disposal sites.

Many of these sites are either too far from collection points, already operating at full capacity, or are poorly managed. These logistical constraints result in extended travel and turnaround times for waste collection vehicles, ultimately reducing the overall efficiency and responsiveness of the waste management system. The Committee was of the view that addressing these interconnected issues is critical to improving sanitation outcomes and protecting public health across the country.

Ablekuma West Municipal Assembly

During its monitoring visit to the Ablekuma West Municipal Assembly, the Committee identified serious environmental and security concerns stemming from an illegal dumpsite located in the Gbebu-Glefe-Gbegbeyise area. The site has become increasingly hazardous due to the presence of armed scavengers who have effectively taken control of the location. Their occupation has created a dangerous environment, restricting public access and preventing routine health inspections. This situation poses a significant challenge to both municipal authorities and law enforcement, undermining efforts to manage sanitation and ensure public safety in the area.

Security and Enforcement Challenges

The Committee noted that, despite multiple interventions by military personnel and the imposition of fines intended to deter illegal dumping at the Glefe site, illegal dumping continues on daily basis. This ongoing defiance

highlights a critical breakdown in enforcement mechanisms and reflects a broader issue of limited institutional capacity. According to local reports, these enforcement measures have failed to yield lasting results, largely because of inadequate follow-through and unsustained oversight.

Economic Constraints on Restoration of Glefe

In addressing the issue, the Committee was informed by Environmental Health Officers that evacuation at the site and restoration of the affected area to a safe and environmentally sound condition would require an estimated amount of GHC7 million. This projected cost significantly exceeds the internally generated funds (IGF) of the Assembly, making it impossible for the Assembly to singlehandedly finance the evacuation of the garbage. The Committee noted that the magnitude of the required intervention far surpasses the capacity of the Assembly, making it clear that without external funding support or direct intervention from the national level, the prospects for effective remediation remain highly unlikely.

Socioeconomic Dimensions

During a random interaction with residents within the Assembly, the Committee uncovered a complex socioeconomic dimension to the crisis. Many of the scavengers admitted that they rely on waste-picking at the illegal dumpsite as their primary means of livelihood. For these individuals, the site

represents not just an illegal operation, but a critical survival strategy in the face of limited employment opportunities. This reality presents a significant challenge to straightforward law enforcement measures, as it highlights the intersection between environmental degradation, urban poverty, and informal labour. Addressing the issue, therefore, requires a balanced approach that considers both public safety and the socioeconomic needs of vulnerable populations.

Ablekuma North Municipal Assembly

The Committee's visit to the Ablekuma North Municipal Assembly revealed persistent sanitation challenges, indicative of a wider struggle faced by many Metropolitan, Municipal, and District Assemblies (MMDAs) in managing waste effectively. The Assembly is currently contending with a range of issues that undermine the consistency and efficiency of its waste management efforts. Key challenges identified include the following:

Poor Waste Collection and Dumping Practices

Residents of the municipality informed the Committee that irregular waste collection schedules had become a major concern, frequently resulting in the accumulation of refuse in both residential areas and unauthorised locations. In several neighborhoods, the Committee observed heaps of uncollected waste overflowing from communal bins and temporary collection points. This situation not only creates

unsightly scenes but also poses significant public health risks due to the potential spread of diseases and the attraction of pests.

Blocked Drains and Flooding Concerns

The Committee noted with grave concern that clogged drains and open gutters were major contributors to localised flooding during rainfall. Improper disposal of solid waste, particularly plastics and household refuse, had severely obstructed key drainage channels. This blockage has heightened the municipality's vulnerability to water stagnation, increased mosquito breeding grounds, and increased the risk of outbreaks of waterborne diseases. The situation underscores the urgent need for improved waste disposal practices and regular desilting of drains to mitigate these public health and environmental hazards.

Limited Resources and Logistical Constraints

The Committee attributed the persistent sanitation lapses in the municipality to limited financial resources and inadequate equipment. It was noted that the Assembly struggled to maintain a sufficient fleet of waste collection trucks and faced difficulties in effectively monitoring the activities of private waste contractors. These challenges have contributed to delays and inefficiencies in waste collection and overall service delivery.

Public Indifference and Poor Sanitation Culture

The Committee further noted that a lack of community cooperation and public awareness was a critical factor undermining effective sanitation management in the municipality. Despite ongoing educational campaigns, many residents continued to engage in indiscriminate waste disposal. Municipal officials reported that some households were still dumping refuse directly into gutters or at unapproved locations, significantly hindering the Assembly's efforts to enforce sanitation bylaws and maintain a clean environment.

Implementation Challenges of the Sanitation Improvement Package (SIP) in Ablekuma North

The Committee observed that the implementation of the Sanitation Improvement Package (SIP) in the Ablekuma North Municipal Assembly had encountered considerable setbacks, hampering broader efforts to enhance public health and environmental cleanliness. Key components of the SIP, including the placement of communal waste containers, supply of skip trucks, *etcetera*, faced significant delays.

Again, stakeholders attributed these delays to procurement bottlenecks and bureaucratic inefficiencies. Consequently, many residents, especially in densely populated and low-income areas like Alogboshie, Tabora, and parts of Achimota continued to depend on inadequate and often unsafe sanitation facilities. These setbacks underscore the

need for streamlined processes and stronger institutional coordination to ensure timely project delivery and improved service outcomes.

Insufficient Stakeholder Engagement

The Committee was informed by Assembly officials of Ablekuma North that the initial rollout of the Sanitation Improvement Package (SIP) was hindered by insufficient community engagement and public sensitisation. This lack of stakeholder involvement led to low levels of public cooperation and limited community ownership of the sanitation interventions. This observation highlights the critical importance of effective communication and grassroots participation in ensuring the success and sustainability of such programmes.

Inadequate Monitoring and Supervision

The Committee was informed by Environmental Health Officers that weak monitoring mechanisms significantly undermined the effective implementation of the Sanitation Improvement Package (SIP). It was noted that some contractors failed to meet agreed timelines or adhere to quality standards.

The Committee again observed that limited supervision and follow-up by the Assembly allowed these lapses to go largely unchecked. As a result, some sanitation infrastructure delivered under the SIP was found to be substandard or showed signs of poor maintenance shortly after commissioning, raising concerns about the long-term

sustainability and value for money of the interventions.

Impact on Sanitation Outcomes

The Committee observed that the cumulative effect of the various implementation challenges was reflected in persistently poor sanitation indicators across the municipality. Open defecation remained prevalent in several peri-urban communities, highlighting gaps in access to adequate sanitation facilities. Additionally, the indiscriminate dumping of waste continued to obstruct drains and choke watercourses, particularly during the rainy season, thereby exacerbating the risk of flooding and related health hazards. These failures not only undermine environmental and public health outcomes but also erode public confidence in the Assembly's capacity to effectively manage and sustain sanitation programmes.

Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly (KMA)

During the Committee's visit to KMA, it was observed that the Assembly, through its Waste Management Department, is actively pursuing a range of strategies to address escalating urban sanitation challenges. With an estimated population of 470,000 within the metropolis and about 2.5 million across the Greater Kumasi area, the city generates approximately 550 tonnes of solid waste and 1,000 cubic meters of liquid waste daily. Despite the Assembly's efforts, the Committee identified several critical issues hampering effective sanitation management in the municipality.

Waste Storage and Collection Mechanisms

The Committee was apprised of significant efforts undertaken by the Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly (KMA) to improve waste management within the city. One of the notable interventions has been the installation of over 500 public litter bins across strategic locations in Kumasi. This initiative was aimed at encouraging proper waste disposal habits among residents and minimising the incidence of street littering. However, despite this investment in public sanitation infrastructure, the problem of indiscriminate waste disposal continues to persist, particularly in densely populated and high-traffic areas. This suggests a need for reinforced public education, behavioral change campaigns, and stricter enforcement of sanitation bylaws.

In addition to the provision of waste receptacles, the city has adopted a multi-pronged approach to waste collection. These strategies include the deployment of licensed private waste collectors who utilise a fleet of compactors, tricycles, and waste collection trucks to access different parts of the city, including areas that are not easily reachable by larger vehicles. Furthermore, street sweeping initiatives have been launched under the Youth Employment Agency (YEA), which engages youth to maintain cleanliness along major roads and public spaces, contributing to both improved sanitation in the municipality and job creation.

Night cleaning operations have also been institutionalised, particularly within the central business district (CBD), where daytime cleaning would disrupt commercial activities. These operations are essential to maintaining a clean urban environment and ensuring that the city is ready for business each morning. The implementation of waste segregation, supported by the EU-funded Holistic Recycling and Sustainable Development (HORESD) project, has introduced structured sorting of waste at the point of collection to promote recycling and reduce the volume of waste sent to landfills.

Complementing these strategies are regular morning mop-up exercises and community-driven clean-up campaigns. These activities foster a sense of civic responsibility and encourage residents to participate actively in maintaining a clean and healthy living environment. Together, these efforts form the backbone of Kumasi's waste management system, although continuous improvement and community involvement remain critical to their long-term success.

Financial Commitments

Additionally, the Committee was informed that to sustain its urban sanitation operations, the Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly (KMA) makes considerable financial commitments on a monthly basis. A significant portion of this expenditure is allocated to human resource support and operational logistics. Specifically, the Assembly disburses approximately GHC200,000

each month in the form of allowances to personnel engaged in night cleaning activities. These workers play a vital role in ensuring the central business district (CBD) and other commercial zones are kept clean and free from waste accumulation during the hours when business operations are closed and foot traffic is minimal.

In addition to labour costs, KMA allocates a further GHC450,000 monthly for the fuelling, servicing, and general maintenance of its fleet of refuse collection trucks and other sanitation-related vehicles. These operational vehicles are essential for the daily collection and transportation of waste from households, public bins, markets, and other high-density areas to designated transfer stations or final disposal sites.

Together, these financial outlays totalling GHC650,000 per month underscore the Assembly's ongoing commitment to maintaining an effective and responsive waste management system. However, the scale of these recurring costs also highlights the need for sustainable financing models, efficient resource allocation, and potential partnerships to ensure long-term viability.

Recycling and Resource Recovery

The Committee noted with interest the growing emphasis on recycling and resource recovery as part of Kumasi's broader waste management strategy. Programmes focused on the collection and processing of recyclable materials

such as polyethylene terephthalate (PET) bottles and scrap metals are being actively implemented. One of the notable facilities supporting this initiative is the Asafo Plastic Collection Centre, which serves as a key hub for aggregating plastic waste and preparing it for onward recycling or repurposing.

In support of these local efforts, the European Union has provided substantial backing through the HORESD project with a total investment of €2.5 million. This project not only enhances the logistical capabilities of the Assembly by supplying equipment and vehicles for waste collection and transport but also plays a pivotal role in building institutional and community capacity. It supports training programmes, public education on waste segregation, and structured approaches to managing recyclable materials at the source.

These interventions contribute to reducing the volume of waste sent to landfills, creating economic opportunities through the recycling value chain, and aligning with global goals for environmental sustainability and circular economic practices. However, the Committee also acknowledged the need for stronger integration of these recycling programmes into the mainstream municipal waste system as well as expanded public participation to maximise their impact.

Final Treatment and Disposal of Solid Waste

The Committee further observed that solid waste management in Kumasi incorporates both treatment and final

disposal processes, depending on the nature and recoverability of the waste materials. A notable initiative in this regard is the Safisana–Clean Team project, which operates at the city’s designated landfill site. This project utilises co-composting techniques, a method that involves the combined treatment of sludge (or septage) and biodegradable municipal solid waste. Through this process, organic materials are transformed into compost, which can be used as soil conditioner for agricultural purposes, thereby diverting a substantial portion of waste from direct disposal.

In addition to this, the Kumasi Compost and Recycling Plant (KCARP) serves as a central facility for large-scale waste recovery. Located approximately 5 kilometers from the Oti landfill site, KCARP boasts of high-capacity infrastructure capable of processing up to 2,400 tonnes of waste daily. The facility plays a vital role in both composting and materials recycling, contributing significantly to environmental sustainability and the promotion of a circular economy within the metropolis.

However, not all waste is suitable for recovery or treatment. Waste streams that are either contaminated, non-biodegradable, or not economically viable to process are transported to the Oti landfill, which serves as the final disposal site for residual materials. This layered approach to waste management, combining treatment, recovery, and controlled landfill disposal, represents a significant step toward improving

Kumasi’s waste diversion rates and extending the lifespan of its landfill infrastructure.

Public Bin Misuse and Sanitation Challenges during Peak Hours

The Committee was briefed that there has been a recurring pattern of misuse of public litter bins, particularly in high-traffic urban areas. Many of these bins, though strategically placed to encourage proper waste disposal, are often overwhelmed during peak hours. Residents and passersby frequently deposit waste improperly, leading to overflow, unsightly surroundings, and in some instances, the scattering of waste by wind or stray animals.

Additionally, there is noticeable deterioration in sanitary conditions during peak commercial hours, especially in markets, transport terminals, and the central business district. The surge in foot traffic and commercial activity during these periods results in accelerated waste accumulation, outpacing the capacity of existing collection schedules and infrastructure.

These challenges highlight the need for targeted interventions, including increased frequency of bin emptying, enhanced public education on proper bin use, deployment of mobile sanitation units during high-traffic periods, and stricter enforcement of sanitation bylaws. Addressing these issues is critical to maintaining public hygiene standards and preserving the aesthetic appeal of the city’s busiest zones.

Liquid Waste Management: Sanitation Infrastructure and Access

Again, the Committee observed that the Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly (KMA) has made significant strides in promoting access to basic sanitation through the implementation of on-site sanitation solutions, notably the Compound Sanitation Program and the Container-Based Sanitation (CBS) system. These interventions aim to address the sanitation needs of households, particularly in densely populated urban communities where space constraints and infrastructural limitations hinder the construction of traditional toilet facilities.

As part of the CBS initiative, over 3,000 UniLoo units have been deployed across the metropolis. Each unit is engineered to serve approximately five users and is designed for installation in limited spaces such as compound houses and informal settlements. The service is operated on a subscription basis, with households paying a monthly maintenance fee of GHC70, which covers routine collection, cleaning, and servicing of the toilet cartridge.

The Committee was informed that, to enhance user comfort and manage odours effectively, the system employs the use of enhanced sawdust, a natural deodoriser that also supports the ecological treatment of waste. This approach not only provides a dignified and hygienic sanitation solution but also aligns with sustainable waste management practices by enabling safe containment and planned waste collection for further

treatment and reuse. The KMA's continued investment in such innovative, user-centered sanitation solutions represents a crucial step toward achieving universal access to safely managed sanitation services in line with national and global development targets.

Cross-Sectoral Challenges in Solid and Liquid Waste Management

The Committee was informed that despite ongoing efforts and investments, the Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly (KMA) continues to face persistent challenges across both solid and liquid waste management sectors.

In the solid waste sector, one of the most critical constraints is the inadequate number of environmental health professionals, which limits the Assembly's capacity to enforce sanitation regulations and monitor service delivery. Compounding this issue is the widespread incidence of indiscriminate dumping, particularly in informal settlements and along drainage channels, which undermines environmental hygiene and public health. Efforts to promote behavioral change have seen some progress, but community adherence to proper waste disposal practices remains limited. Additionally, the high operational costs associated with personnel allowances, vehicle maintenance, and fuel consumption continue to exert pressure on the Assembly's budget and sustainability of service delivery.

In the liquid waste sector, challenges are equally pressing. The city's treatment

infrastructure remains inadequate, with current facilities unable to meet the growing volume of waste generated daily. Sewerage coverage is limited, leaving many urban and peri-urban neighborhoods reliant on on-site sanitation systems such as septic tanks and pit latrines, which are often poorly maintained. Furthermore, financial sustainability remains elusive, as cost recovery from user fees is insufficient to support long-term infrastructure maintenance, service expansion, and innovation. These systemic gaps call for a more integrated and adequately resourced approach to sanitation planning, infrastructure development, and community engagement.

Strategic Measures for Improving Waste Management in Kumasi

To address the persistent challenges in both solid and liquid waste management, the Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly (KMA) informed the Committee that the Municipality has outlined series of strategic interventions aimed at enhancing the efficiency, sustainability, and inclusivity of its waste management systems.

Accordingly, the Assembly intends to intensify public education campaigns and strengthen the enforcement of sanitation laws. By increasing awareness and understanding of proper waste handling practices among residents, and by ensuring strict compliance through regulatory oversight, KMA seeks to curb indiscriminate disposal and foster a culture of civic responsibility.

In addition, there are plans to construct subsidised household latrines in underserved communities. This initiative is designed to expand access to basic sanitation, especially in low-income areas where households may lack the financial capacity to install private toilet facilities. The provision of these latrines will help reduce open defecation and improve public health outcomes.

Furthermore, KMA aims to establish Material Recovery Facilities (MRFs) to support waste segregation and resource recovery efforts. These facilities will serve as central hubs for sorting, processing, and repurposing recyclable waste, thereby diverting significant volumes from landfills and promoting a circular economy.

To this end, the Assembly is actively seeking strategic investments and partnerships in infrastructure development and service delivery. Through public-private collaborations and external funding, KMA hopes to scale up its waste management infrastructure, adopt innovative technologies, and build long-term resilience into the city's sanitation system.

Strategic Insights and Lessons from KMA's Waste Management Approach

The Committee observed that the Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly's waste management strategy embodies a multifaceted and evolving approach that integrates infrastructure development, community education, recycling initiatives,

and collaborative partnerships. This holistic framework reflects a recognition of the complex and interrelated factors influencing urban sanitation and environmental health.

Noteworthy progress has been made through the deployment of sanitation infrastructure, expansion of container-based systems, investment in recycling facilities, and mobilisation of private sector participation. These initiatives have not only improved waste collection and disposal but also laid the groundwork for a more resilient and efficient waste management ecosystem.

However, the Committee noted that the persistence of core challenges, including inadequate human resources, limited treatment capacity, financial constraints, and behavioural barriers underscores the need for sustained investment, policy decentralisation, and adaptive innovations. Addressing these gaps is critical to ensuring that KMA achieves its long-term goals of environmental sustainability, public health protection, and urban development.

Key Observations

Waste Collection and Disposal

The Committee noted that despite the existence of arrangements with private waste contractors in most Assemblies, the overall efficiency of waste collection services remains a significant concern. Many communities continue to experience irregular waste collection, resulting in unsightly and unsanitary living environments. This situation is

exacerbated by the state of dumpsites and transfer stations, some of which were found to be either overstretched or poorly managed. The inadequate capacity and maintenance of these facilities raise serious environmental and public health concerns, including the risk of water and soil contamination, the spread of disease, and air pollution. Additionally, waste segregation at the source is limited or non-existent in many areas. This lack of separation hinders efforts at effective recycling and proper disposal, leading to increased volumes of mixed waste and reduced efficiency in managing the waste stream.

Sanitation Infrastructure

It was also noted that, sanitation infrastructure in the region was notably inadequate, particularly in densely populated and low-income communities. Many Assemblies did not have sufficient public toilet facilities to meet the needs of their residents, which often led to open defecation and other unhygienic practices. Compounding the sanitation challenge is the poor state of drainage systems, many of which are choked with solid waste. These blocked drains not only emit foul odours but also pose a significant flood risk during the rainy season, threatening lives and property. Furthermore, the absence of dedicated landfill sites within the region places undue stress on existing waste management facilities, many of which are already underperforming or operating beyond capacity. This gap in infrastructure contributes to the inefficient and unsustainable management of solid waste and wastewater.

Enforcement and Compliance

The Committee further noted that, enforcement of sanitation by-laws remained weak due to multiple systemic constraints. Environmental Health Officers, who are tasked with ensuring compliance, report chronic shortages in logistics and staffing, severely limiting their operational effectiveness. Without sufficient vehicles, protective gear, and personnel, enforcement efforts are sporadic and inconsistent. Public education campaigns intended to raise awareness about sanitation practices are similarly underfunded and poorly coordinated, diminishing their impact. As a result, many residents continue to engage in unsanitary behaviours, including the refusal to comply with house-to-house waste collection systems. This widespread indiscipline, coupled with inadequate enforcement, undermines communal efforts to maintain a clean and healthy environment.

Funding and Resource Constraints

It was observed that financial and resource limitations remain major challenges confronting Assemblies in their efforts to improve sanitation services. A recurring concern is the delay in the release of funds from the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF), which significantly hampers the timely implementation of planned activities. Additionally, funds are often deducted at source from the Assemblies' share of the DACF to support the Sanitation Improvement Package (SIP) and other national sanitation programmes; however,

in many cases, the corresponding services remain unpaid, creating tension between service providers and the Assemblies.

Moreover, most Municipal Environmental Health Units operate under severe logistical constraints, lacking basic resources such as vehicles, personal protective equipment (PPE), and essential sanitation tools. These deficiencies limit their capacity to conduct field operations, monitor sanitation conditions, and respond effectively to public health emergencies. Without adequate, timely, and transparent funding, coupled with the necessary operational resources, meaningful and sustainable progress in local sanitation management will remain out of reach.

Sanitation Performance across MMDAs

During the visits to the MMDAs, the Committee also observed a marked variation in sanitation outcomes across the Assemblies. Some MMDAs, such as the Ayawaso West Municipal Assembly, had demonstrated improvements in waste collection and public space sanitation. However, others, particularly in densely populated areas like Ayawaso East, continued to face serious challenges with indiscriminate dumping of waste into drains and public spaces. The Committee noted that while state institutions such as Greater Accra Metropolitan Area (GAMA)- and Greater Kumasi Metropolitan Area (GKMA)-supported projects have delivered impressive results with

thousands of household and institutional toilets constructed, the pace of construction in Kumasi lagged behind Accra, necessitating closer supervision and contractor accountability.

Assessment of IRECOP Waste Processing Facilities

At the IRECOP facilities, the Committee was impressed by the state-of-the-art infrastructure and the commitment of staff. Both the Accra and Kumasi plants had been fully constructed and equipped with the capacity to process hundreds of tons of waste daily. However, the Committee noted with concern that neither plant was operating at full capacity due to delays in concluding government off-taker agreements, which would guarantee markets for compost and recycled products. Discussions with Zoomlion officials revealed that while the technology and manpower were ready, financial and policy bottlenecks were stalling the plants' operationalisation. The Committee also noted that sustained maintenance and protection of the facilities would be necessary to avoid equipment deterioration during periods of inactivity.

Key Challenges Identified from the Entire Visit

Risks to IRECOP Sustainability: Gaps in Off-Taker Agreement

The Committee noted several pressing challenges that, if unaddressed, could jeopardise the country's sanitation

gains. Key among these is the slow pace of finalising off-taker agreements essential for the sustainable operation of the IRECOP plants. Without a ready market for compost and recyclables, the plants risk becoming white elephants despite the heavy investments made.

Behavioural and Enforcement Challenges in Sanitation Management

Additionally, the Committee observed that behavioural change among the citizenry remained a significant hurdle. Public education on proper waste disposal and segregation is insufficient, resulting in continued reliance on illegal dumping practices. Compounding these issues is the weak enforcement of sanitation by-laws by MMDAs, attributed to inadequate resources, lack of political will, and the absence of specialised sanitation courts in many jurisdictions.

Financial Transparency and Accountability Concerns

In addition, financial transparency and accountability also emerged as a grave concern. Some officials of the MMDAs raised questions about the opaque nature of some sanitation service contracts and the perceived high costs of outsourcing services without competitive bidding processes. The Committee recognised that the delay in disbursement of payments to service providers like Zoomlion affects operational effectiveness and morale among sanitation workers.

Performance Gaps in the Sanitation Improvement Package (SIP)

Furthermore, the current waste collection framework under the Sanitation Improvement Package (SIP), implemented in partnership with Zoomlion Ghana Limited, has failed to deliver consistent and reliable results. Despite clear contractual obligations, the system suffers from irregular waste pickups, weak operational oversight, and unmet service expectations, leading to public dissatisfaction and a loss of trust in the waste management program.

Inadequate Supply of Waste Containers

The Committee noted that, in most of the District Assemblies, Zoomlion was to provide eleven (11) containers to the District Assemblies under the Sanitation Improvement Package (SIP), however, in reality, Zoomlion has not been able to provide all. In Ablekuma North for instance, the Assembly received only six (6) out of the eleven (11), which had two (2) defectives. In Ablekuma West, the Assembly received seven (7), and only four (4) are usable. Again, in Weija-Gbawe, the Assembly received seven (7), with container overflow issues, while in Ayawaso Central, the Municipal received ten (10), but almost all of them are defective.

Poor Waste Collection Logistics

The Committee also observed that vehicles, particularly skip loader trucks, are often missing, broken down, or stationed outside the premises of the

Assemblies, which severely limits their capacity to respond to waste management needs in a timely manner. In many cases, fuel shortages further delay the collection of waste, resulting in overflowing bins, environmental hazards, and unsanitary conditions in communities. Additionally, the under-supply of skip trucks by Zoomlion under the Sanitation Improvement Package (SIP) was identified as a critical constraint, leaving several Assemblies inadequately equipped to manage waste effectively despite deductions from their DACF allocations.

Lack of Contract Customisation

The Committee again noted that the sanitation contract with Zoomlion was a general one and not tailored to the specific needs or realities of individual Assemblies. The Assemblies were not consulted during contract drafting or signing, thereby limiting their input and needs in the SIP contract.

Fumigation Service Misrepresentation

The Committee noted that the fumigation contract being implemented by Zoomlion fails to meet expectation. The Assemblies also raised concerns about untrained personnel that perform this function and the inadequate use of chemicals that do not truly solve the problem.

YEA Contract Challenges (Low or Nonexistent Worker Deployment)

Another Challenge noted by the Committee was that, the list of sanitation workers submitted by the YEA are often

inflated. The number of sanitation workers on the payroll are less than those that work on the field. At Ablekuma North for instance, officials stated that less than 10 per cent of listed workers are actually present on the ground, Ablekuma West had 35 YEA staff active but with limited coverage while at Weija-Gbawe, all YEA workers have abandoned work due to non-payment of stipends. At the Accra Metropolitan Assembly, there are about 200 YEA sanitation workers, but only 20 of them work. However, deductions are made from the Assemblies for the payment of all YEA Officers.

Recommendations for Enhancing Sanitation Management

To address the persistent challenges facing sanitation management in Ghana, a set of strategic recommendations has been proposed by the Committee. These focus on strengthening institutional capacity, improving infrastructure, fostering greater community involvement, and identifying a dedicated funding source for Sanitation Management.

MMDAs Involvement in Sanitation Management

The Committee recommended that the Metropolitan, Municipal, and District Assemblies (MMDAs) be fully involved in all aspects of sanitation management to ensure more effective and sustainable outcomes. Given their proximity to communities and their governance mandate, MMDAs are well-positioned to lead localised sanitation planning, implementation, and monitoring efforts.

Their involvement should include the formulation of district-specific sanitation strategies that align with national policies while addressing local challenges. The Committee emphasised the importance of empowering MMDAs with adequate resources, both financial and technical, to support these efforts.

Strengthen Funding Support

One of the most critical needs is the timely disbursement of sanitation-related funds to Metropolitan, Municipal, and District Assemblies (MMDAs). Delays in accessing funds from the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF) have significantly hampered operations, from waste collection to the maintenance of sanitation infrastructure. Ensuring a more sustainable, dedicated and efficient funding channel would empower local authorities to plan and execute sanitation initiatives without disruption.

Capacity Building of Environmental Health Officers

The Committee emphasised the urgent need to strengthen the capacity of Environmental Health Officers (EHOs) through targeted investment in recruitment, training, and the provision of adequate resources. EHOs serve as frontline enforcers of sanitation by-laws and are instrumental in promoting public health education at the community level. To enhance their effectiveness, especially in underserved and densely populated areas, it is essential to equip them with the necessary logistical support, including vehicles, protective gear, and communication tools.

Improved capacity and mobility will significantly boost their ability to monitor, enforce, and educate, thereby contributing to more effective sanitation management.

Public Education and Sensitisation

Public understanding and cooperation are essential for sustainable sanitation management in the country. Assemblies should intensify awareness campaigns focusing on proper waste disposal, the importance of household waste segregation, and the consequences of violating sanitation laws. Such campaigns, delivered through schools, community forums, radio, and digital platforms, would promote behavioural change and strengthen compliance at the grassroots level.

Improve Supervision of Contractors

The supervision and enforcement of contracts with private waste contractors must be significantly improved. Municipalities need to establish clearer performance benchmarks, conduct regular evaluations, and hold service providers accountable for lapses. Effective oversight ensures not only the reliability of waste collection services but also builds public trust in the sanitation system. Payment mechanism for sanitation service provided at MMDAs must be reviewed to ensure Assemblies play a major role. This will ensure that service providers are paid only for work done and not contract sums.

Infrastructure Investment

A long-term solution to the sanitation crisis requires robust infrastructure development. The government, in collaboration with development partners and the private sector, should prioritise the construction of engineered landfills, modern transfer stations, and accessible public toilet facilities. Such investments will help address the current strain on existing facilities and support environmentally sound waste management practices.

Data Collection and Monitoring

There is a pressing need for reliable data systems at the local level. Assemblies should develop mechanisms to routinely monitor waste generation trends, collection efficiency, and by-law compliance. Accurate and timely data will not only enhance decision-making but also allow for better planning, resource allocation, and policy evaluation.

Urgent Action on Off-Taker Agreements for IRECOP Facilities

The Committee strongly urges the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs to expedite the finalisation of off-taker agreements to allow for full operationalisation of the IRECOP facilities. The Committee emphasised that without firm market structures for compost and recyclables, the investment made in these facilities would not yield the intended returns. The Committee further urges the Ministry of Food and

Agriculture to procure the compost produced by the IRECOP facilities to support its agriculture programmes.

Promoting Waste Segregation and Legal Enforcement

The Committee also recommended a comprehensive national campaign on waste segregation at the household level and the provision of the needed infrastructure to support that. It called for greater collaboration between the Ghana Education Service, civil society organisations, religious groups, and traditional leaders to promote a culture of proper waste disposal from the grassroots level. Additionally, the Committee proposed the establishment of sanitation courts in all regional capitals and major districts to facilitate swift prosecution of sanitation offenders.

Transparency and Competitiveness in Engagement of Service Providers

Recognising the concerns about financial transparency, the Committee advised that all major sanitation contracts should be subjected to competitive procurement processes and made publicly accessible to enhance accountability and ensure value for money. Furthermore, it recommended timely disbursement of funds to sanitation service providers to ensure uninterrupted service delivery and improve the welfare of frontline sanitation workers.

Review of the YEA contract

The Committee recommended that the YEA programme be reviewed to enable the Assemblies have direct

supervision of beneficiaries of the YEA in sanitation. It was noted that reports are not taken from the Agency before the workers are paid, neither does the Agency supervise the work of the workers.

Call for Support and Private Sector Involvement

The Committee appealed for increased support from central government and development partners to enhance sanitation infrastructure in the municipalities and the country as a whole. The Committee also called for partnerships with private waste management companies to improve sanitation management.

Municipal Response and Forward Strategy

Finally, the Committee urged the Municipal Assemblies to review the SIP implementation framework, improve monitoring systems, and intensify community engagement. The Committee also called on MMDAs to make the effort to work closely with traditional leaders, youth groups, and private contractors to ensure better transparency, participation, and efficient delivery of future sanitation projects.

The Committee's Action Plan (Policy Reforms)

The Committee laid out a comprehensive action plan to address systemic issues in sanitation management. Acknowledging the widespread concerns raised by stakeholders, the

Committee emphasised the need for a coordinated, inclusive, and reform-oriented approach. One of the immediate priorities is the review of existing contract agreements governing sanitation services. The Committee stressed that the current arrangements often exclude critical stakeholders such as local Assemblies and technical experts, leading to inefficiencies and weak accountability. Revising these contracts would enhance transparency and ensure that service delivery reflects local needs and capacities.

In recognition of the recurring issue of delayed disbursements from national sources, the Committee proposed that Assemblies consider utilising their internally generated funds (IGF) to sustain essential sanitation services in the interim. This measure would ensure continuity in waste management operations and help assemblies respond more effectively to immediate sanitation needs, even in the face of funding uncertainties.

Conclusion

The Committee on Sanitation and Water Resources' monitoring visits provided valuable insights into the progress, challenges, and opportunities within Ghana's sanitation sector. While substantial strides have been made, particularly through the government's partnership with Zoomlion Ghana Limited, systemic challenges related to operational efficiency, transparency, public behaviour, and enforcement mechanisms persist.

The Committee is committed to working with all stakeholders, including government agencies, private sector partners, civil society organisations, and the general public, to address these challenges decisively. It remains the firm belief of the Committee that with the right interventions and a collective national effort, Ghana can achieve its vision of becoming a clean nation.

The Committee acknowledged the efforts of the MMDAs, private service providers, and other stakeholders in managing sanitation. However, significant gaps remain in infrastructure, funding, enforcement, and public compliance. It is imperative that a coordinated, well-resourced, and multi-stakeholder approach be adopted to sustainably address the sanitation challenges.

The Committee will continue to follow up on the progress of these Assemblies and collaborate with relevant Ministries, Departments, and Agencies (MDAs) to drive improved sanitation outcomes nationwide.

In view of the above, the Committee therefore recommends to the House to adopt its Report in accordance with Order 215(1) of the Standing Orders of the House.

Respectfully submitted.

Yesterday, we may have heard that the Environmental Service past students were picketing at the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs. This is because, they have not

been posted for the past five years; that is serious. Because, without adequate Environmental Service workers, I do not think that this country would make progress as far as sanitation management is concerned at the various Metropolitan, Municipal and District Assemblies (MMDAs).

Mr Speaker, if you recall — in those days, some of us were very young — that is during the Provisional National Defence Council (PNDC), the early days of National Democratic Congress (NDC) era, we used to refer to them as ‘tankas’, that is the Town Council People. One would remember the fear one had any time one heard of the ‘tankas’ coming to one’s house. Do we remember the fear and discipline in the system—

2:33 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Chairperson, the *Hansard* has captured the Report, so in conclusion?

Mr Oti: Mr Speaker, I have a few more things to say. Let me touch on the critical issues briefly.

One of them has to do with non-payment. We all know that before a prophet can give accurate and good prophecies, he must be fed properly. The Environmental Health Service Providers Association visited your Committee and told us that they have not been paid for some time now. As a country, if one visits a war-torn country like Rwanda and sees their practices and what they are doing in sanitation, it tells us that Ghana has a long way to go.

Mr Speaker, with your permission, I want to call on the Government and those who matter, to try as much as possible to pay environmental health service providers. Mr Speaker, they are doing a very good job for this country—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: In conclusion?

Mr Oti: Mr Speaker, if you want me to conclude—*[Interruption]*. I have a few more things to say.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, once you ask the *Hansard* to capture the entire Report as having been read, there is no point reading the Report for the *Hansard*.

Mr Oti: Mr Speaker, I am just making brief points. I am not reading the entire Report. If I want to read the entire Report, it will take us over almost an hour.

Mr Speaker, in conclusion, I want to appeal to the Government and especially our good Brother, Dr Ato Forson, who is doing so well so far, to try as much as possible and make payment to these environmental service providers. This would enable them to continue to do a good job for this country.

Mr Speaker, I thank you so much for giving me the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you.

The Motion is moved. Is there any Seconder? Yes, Hon Zuwera.

Ms Zuwera Mohammed Ibrahimah (NDC — Salaga): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion on the Report presented by the Chairperson of the Committee on Water and Sanitation.

Mr Speaker, in seconding the Motion, I just want to add that, going around and listening to all the stakeholders, government agencies, private people involved in the effort to clean up our country, there was one feature that was very constant, and that was financial resources. This is to enable the effective activity of all these stakeholders.

Mr Speaker, it is so easy to reference best practice in other countries but what we also found in those countries, including Rwanda is that, the system works. The system enables everybody to play their role properly. So inasmuch as we talk about recruiting and posting environmental sanitation workers, we also have to take a step back and look at our own individual activities. As individuals and citizens of this country, what are we doing to enable a clean environment?

Mr Speaker, it starts with us. It starts with me refusing to dump that empty bottle and rather putting it into my handbag after I have drunk water. It starts with my brother who would refuse to throw that wrapper of a packet of biscuits out there, as if it is someone else's responsibility. We all have a duty. In Rwanda, as my Chairperson said, no

one litters; there is no policeman. It is just that; it is the attitude. Without littering, we would have a clean environment.

Mr Speaker, we also found that household data is very crucial to the efforts to keep our country and the environment clean. In Rwanda, the system captures everybody. So, everybody pays for the cleaning of their environment. In this country, we do not have the data to enable us to plan and pay at the end of the month through mobile money. So, I would call *aboboyaa* today. Today, he comes, he says he is charging GH¢30. On another day, he would charge GH¢50. On the third day, he would change the amount again. This is how we are running the issue of sanitation in this country.

Mr Speaker, it is about time that we held the bull by the horn and take some very serious, drastic, but pragmatic action to involve everybody in the effort to clean this country. In Rwanda, they told us that they clean their portion of the lake between them and DR Congo. Because they say the Congolese make the water dirty. So, they have permanent patrol on their side. It costs a lot of money to keep a patrol on the water, to make sure that the water is clean. This is a system that is responsive to its citizens.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I second the Motion. Thank you.

Question Proposed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Boamah-Nyarko Isaac, you have the floor.

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko (NPP — Effia): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to comment on the Report read by the Chairperson of the Committee on Sanitation and Water Resources.

Mr Speaker, sanitation in this country is a big concern and worry for which reason a Ministry has been created to help improve the state of sanitation in this country. The three critical areas where Ghana faces challenges in sanitation, which was highlighted in the Report, includes, the improper waste management that we do in this country, the lack of infrastructure, and importantly, trying to establish a waste disposal site, provision of quality drinking water, as well as the all-important lack of hygiene education in this country.

Mr Speaker, making this situation even worse, is the lack of political will, where Government continues to deprioritise the issue of sanitation in this country and also stifle the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources, when it comes to financing of its programmes and projects.

Mr Speaker, we sat in this House and approved a budget for the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources. Then, as at the end of year when the 2026 Budget was read, we all saw clearly that the Ministry had been under-financed or under-resourced by almost 70 per cent. So how can we expect the Ministry of Work, Housing and Water Resources to be able to do and deliver on the issues that it prioritised for the year 2025?

Mr Speaker, per this Report, we cannot, as a House continue to belabour the point when we have put responsibilities in the hands of the state, led by the Government and the President, who also has a Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources, be able to lead the charge and help us improve sanitation.

He talked about the Town Council practice. We all know about it, but what resource are we giving the assemblies to be able to deliver in improving the sanitation situation? People are dropping rubbish and garbage all around our country. How have we provided the needed waste bins across very key areas in our cities or in our towns to be able to minimise these issues of dirt and unsanitary conditions?

Mr Speaker, I would like to make this recommendation and it is in tandem with what they said. One, Government should prioritise the issues of sanitation. Prioritisation means they should make available adequate resources for the Ministry to be able to manage and improve on our sanitation. We talk about making Ghana one of the cleanest countries in Africa, but what are we seeing? Continuous deterioration in our sanitation condition—*[Interruption]*. They should read their manifesto.

Mr Speaker, I would want to join on all force with our Colleagues that we improve on the sanitation condition in this country.

Government should release funding to support the Ministry so that at the end

of the day, we can all see a better and a clean country.

With these few words, I want to thank you for the opportunity.

2:43 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib?

Second Deputy Minority Whip (Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib): Mr Speaker, I thank you sincerely for giving me this opportunity. Listening to the Chair of the Committee, there were a few things I picked and one is a matter I had the opportunity of raising here.

Mr Speaker, it has to do largely with mindsets. The way and manner we believe that we can litter; there is no caution whatsoever when it has to do with littering. People see drains and they actually dump refuse into drains. People actually do so when it is just about to rain and we watch them. They do so with black polythene bags and the content of those polythene bags — if we do not take steps—As we speak today, there is some sort of surge in COVID-19 again. And why? It is because of the way and manner we deal with issues of the environment.

Mr Speaker, the Chairperson of the Committee raised a very salient point on staff numbers. We call them the Municipal Environmental Health Office (MEHO) or District Environmental Health Office (DEHO). The numbers we have in the respective District Assemblies, as in people who are

operating as DEHOs and MEHOs, because their numbers are a matter we would have to deal with; they are seriously understaffed. When we go to the Accra Metropolitan Assembly, there are not more than two Metropolitan Health Environment and Health Officers and when they have some sub-districts, then it means that those sub-districts are being run by people who are not the right staff. This is what happens when the mindset is not right. Because for someone, he or she chews gum — and there have been instances even in this Chamber, we end up stepping on chewing gum. I ask, even if we are doing so around this area, what do we expect my people, wherever they find themselves to be doing?

Mr Speaker, we need some sort of revolutionary education on health and the environment. We should know not to be dumping at the wrong places. When you come to my Constituency, there is a whole place that is now being covered by garbage. Hitherto, it was a Ramsar site; the President advised and directed that, that place should be taken care of but no action has been done. No action has been taken whatsoever. When we also come to the non-payment of these workers, especially those who are in the uniforms of Zoomlion Ghana, I reiterated it here, that they have not been paid for about nine months. How do we expect them to go to work? And their pay, we used to say that their pay is like the Teachers and Educational Workers Union (TEWU) pay. This is less than TEWU pay, very small amount of — and some of them are our grandmothers. They are very old, but they are still being kept in this function.

Let us recruit the right calibre of people, stronger men and women, and let us find a better package for those who are at the age of retiring. Let them exit in a very proper manner and pay them properly.

Mr Speaker, with all of these, we should also open up for the issue of sanitation to be catered by a larger group of people, not one company. If it is one company—Now even within the airport surroundings, garbage is not being lifted by the sanitation service providers and it is because there is no competition. There is the belief that one person is able to do it. Meanwhile, that one single company is unable to perform. If we are able to take this up seriously—These days, people prefer travelling to Aburi because it has a better environment. Some of us have not been able to purchase lands there. But if that is going to be the situation, we will all run up to Aburi, and that place will also be congested. The mindset will start there again. People will start littering, they will start felling trees, and do all manner of activities which will then end up affecting our environment.

Mr Speaker, today you are healthy. I am also healthy by the grace of God. So, it should be a proper position for this august House to consider, just like the Majority Leader once said, charity begins at home. To begin from our homes, to lead lives that are environmentally friendly so that we can call ourselves Legislators, people who think about the environment.

Mr Speaker, with all of this said, I want to thank you very much for giving me the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Second Deputy Minority Whip. Yes, Hon Sebastian Ngmenenso Sandaare?

Dr Sebastian Ngmenenso Sandaare (NDC — Daffiama/Bussie/ Issa): Mr Speaker, thank you. I just also want to add my voice in support of the report taken by the Chairperson of the Committee on Sanitation and Water Resources.

Mr Speaker, there is a direct relationship between the environment and the health of the people. No matter how nice a man dresses, if his or her environment is dirty or not clean, that man is not clean. Environmental health is something that we should take seriously because it determines our health as a people of this country. So, measures should be taken to ensure that our environment is clean. One thing I want to add is that our monthly or quarterly sanitation days, yes, it is a good measure, but we should go beyond that to have daily sanitation days where everybody, every household must take steps to clean their environment every day and not wait for monthly or quarterly sanitation days. I want to add my voice to the Chairperson's that we should look at how we motivate and pay our environmental health officers so that they can do a good job and ensure that our environment is clean.

Mr Speaker, I want to thank you for giving me the opportunity.

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Yes, I am grateful for indulging me. Let me remind the

House that when we were considering the estimates for the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs, there was thunder all over. The Majority Leader had a cause to raise the matter. I think these matters if we are putting it in proper context — First of all, let me *ab initio* commend the Chairperson and the Leadership of the Committee on Sanitation and Water Resources; detailed work was done, including visiting almost five regions, and I am also aware that they visited other countries to look at best practices, so we can compare and contrast.

Mr Speaker, these are matters we cannot belabour and I intend to limit myself to specific portions of the Report. Separation of waste – there is nowhere in the world that waste is not separated. It is only in Africa or in Ghana that it is difficult to separate waste. We need to separate the biodegradable waste from the non-biodegradable waste.

2:53 p.m.

We are not doing that. In other jurisdictions, there are designated containers for biodegradable waste, and that is the start of waste processing.

Mr Speaker, if we cannot process our waste, which is a resource, then we are wasting the waste. Because this waste can be converted to other forms. For instance, generating electricity from waste and it is done all over the world and we generate so much. Our greatest challenge is how to decommission landfill sites. Landfill sites all over the country have become a death trap, and we cannot pretend all is well; it is a problem.

Mr Speaker, for instance, in Nsumia, a suburb of Nsawam Adoagyiri, leachate is being produced, which is seeping into the water table of the environment, and that is practically poison to flora and fauna.

Mr Speaker, as Mr Shaib said, we also have to change our ways, and our way of life has to be changed. But the crux of the matter is that we cannot treat this as — it must fall within the core activities of the Ministry; waste is huge.

Mr Speaker, I was very unimpressed when the Hon Chairperson said that “Ato is forcing”. Where is he forcing? When service providers —*[Interruption]*— well, he is trying, but it is not good enough.

Mr Speaker, for close to one year, solid and liquid waste service providers have not been paid. Where is Ato forcing, they should tell me? He is not paying. For instance, the liquid waste generated by Parliament, I am aware that the service providers for close to one year have not been paid, and we risk an epidemic.

Mr Speaker, I will be very glad, and I know you are not a fan of consequential directives, but I will pray for your office — This matter cannot be left hanging. Sanitation portends on health, and health portends on productivity. So, I will be glad if there could be some directives for an engagement with the Hon Minister for Finance to make sure that all the sanitation service providers are paid. *Ato ntua*, to wit, Ato is not paying, and the service providers are crying.

Mr Agbodza — *rose* —

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I see my good Friend wants to speak. If it is the case that he wants to support, I will yield to him. He should support me so that we will get the Hon Minister for Finance to *tua*—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I believe strongly he is up because you have converted the House into a Twi-speaking platform. So, if you can refrain from speaking Twi and stick to the official language, he would not be up on a point of order

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am guided accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let me hear from the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways—

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, my good Friend, the Hon Minority Chief Whip, is giving the impression that the current Hon Minister for Finance is not paying, and he said it in Twi.

Mr Speaker, the fact is that the Hon Minister for Finance, within the past few months, has paid more than any Minister for Finance within one year. Today, he is up to date with payment of the Common Fund to the extent that Adaklu Assembly has money sitting in their accounts to pay for services they are procuring. The National Health Insurance Scheme (NHIS) is fully up to date; Ghana Education Trust (GETFund) is fully up to date.

Mr Speaker, the truth is that sanitation is an important issue. For example, when I became a Member of Parliament in 2013, a service provider was taking money at source from the Adaklu District Assembly Common Fund for providing certain services. I wrote to that service provider and said that he had taken money belonging to the Adaklu Assembly and did not provide the services. That service provider agreed, and today, in Adaklu, there is a water tanker there, which is a compensation for taking money from the Adaklu Assembly and not providing the service. All we are saying is that, yes, and I agree with my Colleague, Mr Shaib, when he asks why not tackle the issue at source? For instance, I drink sachet water and then open the window of my vehicle and throw it onto the street because there is somebody who is supposed to clean it, and be paid for it. How about we say that we be cleaner as a country, which does not mean that we should pay for cleaning, but rather, we will be cleaner in our attitude towards the environment, so that we do not litter things around? But it has always been about paying sanitation workers. What about we actually stop littering so that we can reduce that?

So, Mr Speaker, I agree but all those who are providing services in sanitation across the country must also be accountable. There is no free money in this country, where every time people insist that it is their right to take public money and pretend that they are cleaning places.

Mr Speaker, as of the time one of them was supposed to be cleaning

Adaklu, my district capital, did not have an inch of tarred road or anything; there was no litter, yet, they were still cleaning when there was no litter to clean. In fact, the place was clean, and they were still doing so much fumigation but we never saw anybody doing fumigation anywhere.

Mr Speaker, reset means that it is an accountable time; there is no free money for certain service providers to take for doing nothing. If Adaklu Assembly wants to engage anybody to do cleaning there, let them engage them at the District Assembly level; there is no central source of cash for anybody to take.

Mr Speaker, I thank the Committee for the Report, but I am a bit worried that the Report did not focus enough on the cleaning services.

Mr Speaker, let me conclude by saying that Dr Ato Forson is actually paying and has paid within the last 11 months more than any Minister for Finance in the history of our country.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, let me try and conclude.

The Hon Minister for Roads and Highways mentioned other payments that are ongoing. I am not disputing that; unfortunately, that is not a subject matter for discussion. The Common Fund, the NHIS, we are aware that some good payments have been made; that is not in

dispute. What is in dispute is the service providers whose services have been rendered, and the moneys have not been paid; that is the crux of the matter.

Mr Speaker, I am sure this matter has come to your notice. This discussion cannot be left hanging, and this is the representative of the people. Some directives should be sent to the Hon Minister and these service providers.

Mr Speaker, I am surprised the Chairperson did not speak to these service providers' payments which have been hanging close to a year. We should engage and make sure that even if all of the outstanding payments cannot be dealt with, some good advances should be made to them, and that will go a long way to up their game in the delivery of their service.

So, we cannot leave this matter to hang, but let me conclude by thanking the Committee for bringing this matter to the Floor, and we must proceed to see it to its logical conclusion. It cannot be an adoption of the Report, and it ends there; that cannot be too good for us.

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

3:03 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader.

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr Speaker, let me put on record the fact that this Committee embarked on a tour of sanitation facilities across the

country following the recommendation of Leadership that Committees should be out there in the field engaging constituents, agencies and institutions they ought to be superintending over so that they can have a clear appreciation of the issues on the ground and report back to the House so we can take the Reports, debate them and if there are commendable recommendations that we can make to the Executive arm of government, we can make those recommendations and the people will begin to see that parliamentarians are on top of the issues; parliamentarians are paying attention to the issues on the ground and are contributing their voices to defining solutions to the problems in our communities.

So, I want to commend the Chairman of the Committee for taking the Committee across the country and bringing us this very useful Report. I urge other chairpersons of the various Committees to do the same during the recess. I know during recess we are supposed to be in our constituencies, with our families *et cetera*, taking time off to rest, but we are also to take time to tour the country and find out what the situation is, so that when we resume, we can take these Reports and try to deal with them.

Mr Speaker, on the substance of the Report, let me indicate that what I see is quite a scary situation. In paragraph 7.1, the Committee indicated that in the Accra Metropolitan Assembly, the metropolis generates about 4,000 tonnes of waste daily. Existing facilities can only support the management and

processing of only 2,000 tonnes, leaving the remaining 2000 tonnes. This is a national crisis. If the foremost metropolis in our national capital generates 4,000 tonnes of waste daily and has only the capacity to manage 2,000 tonnes, half of it every day, where is the other half going? That is why I say this is a national crisis. We must sit up as a people. If this is a situation in our national capital where all 276 Members of Parliament sit and work, where our Presidency sits and works, where all our ministries and government agencies sit and work, where all the most important offices in the private sector sit and work, and where I will say most of the elite of this country live. If that location in our country generates 4,000 tonnes of waste daily and can manage only 2,000 tonnes, I wonder what is happening in the various cities across the country.

Mr Speaker, that is why I say the Report of the Committee raises a major red flag and as a people and as Leadership, we must sit up. As Chairperson of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies, I am responsible, with my Colleagues, for overseeing the Common Fund administrator, the Fund itself, and its distribution. It has come to my notice through petitions presented to me and the Committee that, in the past, allocations were made through the Common Fund for the management of sanitation. We are being entreated as a Committee to reconsider the current allocation of the Fund.

Let me state that we have considered the petitions carefully. One, in the past, the Common Fund used to pay for

sanitation under an item known as National Sanitation Management. Huge amounts of money used to be put there. With the decision of this Government to make sure that 80 per cent of the money goes directly into the accounts of all district, municipal and metropolitan assemblies, it is no longer possible to maintain that item in the formula. No matter what we say, within the formula, the various assemblies are authorised to use, I think, 10 per cent of the allocations given to them to manage their sanitation. What used to happen in the past, which I thought was unfair, was that out of the bigger basket, a chunk of the money was taken and used to maintain major sanitation infrastructure, which were mostly in the major cities, including Greater Accra, Kumasi and Takoradi.

So, what it meant was that the people of Bawku or Sandema were subsidising for those living in Accra. So, Mr Speaker, that is why I continue to support the policy of the President that 80 per cent of the Common Fund money must hit the accounts of the various metropolitan, district and municipal assemblies. But I do agree that we need to invest in sanitation infrastructure. The question is, where should we find the resources to invest in sanitation infrastructure?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Majority Leader, I have seen a former deputy leader on his feet.

Mr Dominic Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, thank you very much. I want to supply some useful information to the Majority Leader.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hold on, you are up on a point of information? Well, the rule is that if it is information, is the Majority Leader willing to yield?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, no. I am not yielding to him.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. He is not willing to yield, so you cannot supply him with the information.

Majority Leader, you have the floor.

Mr Ayariga: So, there is a critical need to finance sanitation infrastructure in the urban centres. The assemblies in the urban centres, on their own, and based on the allocation made to them, cannot afford to maintain those critical sanitation infrastructures. We cannot say that Greater Accra Metropolis should manage the waste treatment plant in Greater Accra because it cannot afford to maintain it. The allocation made to them is woefully inadequate to maintain it. The question then is what should be the solution?

Mr Speaker, property rate collection is the solution. In Greater Accra, Ashanti, and the urban cities, it is the properties and their occupants who are causing the waste problem. Those properties and their occupants must pay for the waste they generate. That is the basis of the polluter pays principle. One cannot choose to come and live in Accra, then I will remain in Bawku, and yet I will be subsidising their waste management to the Common Fund allocation, which money should have come to people in Sandema or Jirapa, but

is sent to Accra so that Accra can help manage its waste.

3:13 p.m.

Experts have said that property rates can go up to GHC18 billion per annum if we collect them. We are not collecting the property rates. Those generating the waste are living in those properties, yet others are being called upon to pay for the management of the waste. I think this is not right. I agree with Dr Ato Forson that the money should go directly to the districts. So, let us see how we can collect property rates, and use some of that money to pay for the waste management infrastructure that these cities are hosting. When we look at even an analysis of properties and their values, Greater Accra alone has, I believe, more than two-thirds of most valuable properties in the country. If we have GHC18 billion in property rates that we are not collecting, it means that Greater Accra alone has the potential to generate not less than GHC5 billion per annum. I have looked at the figures, and what is needed to manage the waste is about GHC1 billion per annum. If we are collecting the GHC5 billion from all the properties in Greater Accra, and we put GHC1 billion into sanitation infrastructure and the maintenance of the infrastructure, we will still have an outstanding GHC4 billion to put into other infrastructure such as inner city roads, drainage, and other facilities that will make life more livable in the communities in Greater Accra.

Mr Speaker, I do admit that we have a national crisis. We must sit up and find a solution to this crisis, but it cannot be a

lazy solution. The lazy solution was a system where we just said, District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF) has a basket of money, so let us just dip our hands into the DACF and take the money and then just give it to sanitation management. When the real cost of the waste is the property sitting in Greater Accra, and nobody is thinking of how to collect the property rates and use it for waste management. I urge Hon Colleagues that the Committee working together with the Committee on Local Government and Rural Development and the Finance Committee must sit up, come together, and brainstorm around how we can collect property rates and how the money can be channelled into supporting sanitation infrastructure.

Lastly, I think that sanitation infrastructure such as huge drains that would move the waste to treatment plants, the treatment plants and landfill are major public works infrastructure. They are not the sole responsibility of the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs. In many countries, such infrastructure is the responsibility of the ministry responsible for public works. The Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources must be given adequate budgetary support so that they can construct and maintain the sanitation infrastructure. It cannot be the sole responsibility of the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs or even the various district assemblies who clearly do not have the capacity to invest in such massive public infrastructure. I think that as a House, we must advocate for the Ministry of Works and Housing, which generally oversees public works, to be

given adequate budgetary allocation to be able to construct the needed sanitation infrastructure in the various municipalities that are very populous and need additional support to manage their infrastructure.

Mr Speaker, there are many issues that have been raised and flagged in this Report. I cannot delve into all of them due to the constraints of time, but I want to conclude by once again commending the Chairperson of the Committee for such a diligent job and encouraging him to continue to tour the various facilities; bring the issues on the Floor, let us debate them, let us find amicable solutions, and make recommendations to the Executive.

On that note, Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Hon Members, in the meantime, let me acknowledge students from Elite Smart Kids School, led by Lucas David, a teacher. They are from Ablekuma North and they number 37.

[Pupils of Elite Smart Kids School were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Deputy Majority Leader?

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor): Mr Speaker, may we take the Motion numbered 34.

Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance is unavoidably absent, so I pray that we humbly request the Minister for Roads and Highways to take this on his behalf.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): I do not know why they always set traps for me. But, no problem. Mr Speaker, I would not object to that. The Minister for Road and Highways should go ahead and do the needful.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Minister for Roads and Highways, you may move the Motion numbered 34.

BILLS — SECOND READING

Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025

Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Governs Agbodza) (MP)
on behalf of the Minister for Finance:
Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That the Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025 be now read a Second time.

Mr Eric Afful: Mr Speaker, let me thank you. I rise to second the Motion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, at Second Reading, we do not second Motion. That is why I am calling on the Chairperson to present the Committee's Report. On the *Order Paper*

is Minister for Finance moving the Motion, calling on the Committee to present the Report. Just present the Report without seconding the Motion.

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Eric Afful): Mr Speaker, the Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill 2025 was presented to Parliament—*[Interruption]*

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, just to draw your attention, I have got a copy of the Report and perused it. Mr Speaker, also to refer the House to Order 160 and Order 167. If it is the case that we are coming under Order 167, basically to look at a full debate, that is fine, and it is in compliance with Order 167. However, if we look at, page 1 of the Report, the item numbered 2.0, it also talks and reference Order 160. The two fused together, Order 160 and Order 167 being put together in one Report. That is not our practice. That is wrong. What he should do, because the Report captures the two in one, he should seek the leave of the House or Mr Speaker's leave, and either stick to Order 167, which is Second Reading, after which we can look at Order 160, which is about taking it under certificate of urgency. But as it is now, the Report puts the two together, and that is not right.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairperson of the Committee, may you present the Committee's Report.

Mr Eric Afful: Thank you, Mr Speaker. The Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill 2025 was presented to Parliament by Hon Deputy Minister for Finance, Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem, in

accordance with Article 174 of the 1992 Constitution and Standing Order 165 of the House, and read the First time on Wednesday, 10th December, 2025. Mr Speaker, I will therefore entreat the *Hansard* take this Report as having been fully read while I touch on a few areas.

Introduction

The Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025 was presented to Parliament by Hon Deputy Minister for Finance, Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem, in accordance with Article 174 of the 1992 Constitution and Standing Order 165 of the House and read the first time on Wednesday, 10th December 2025.

Subsequently, the Bill was referred to the Committee on Economy and Development for consideration and report in accordance with the Article 106(4) of the 1992 Constitution and the Standing Orders 230 of Parliament.

Urgency of the Bill

The Committee met to determine the urgency of the bill pursuant to Standing Order 160 of the House. After careful consideration, the Committee by consensus, determined that the Bill was urgent and recommended to the House to take the Bill under certificate of urgency.

Deliberations

The Committee, in considering the Bill, held meetings with the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, the Hon Deputy Minister for Finance, Mr Thomas Ampem Nyarko, the Governor of the Bank of

Ghana, Dr Johnson Pandit Asiamah, and technical teams from the Ministry of Finance and Bank of Ghana. Officials from the Legislative Drafting Division of the Ministry of Justice and Attorney-General's Department were also in attendance to provide technical and legal assistance to the Committee.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents in the consideration of the Bill:

- i. The 1992 Constitution
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament
- iii. Interpretations Act, 1960
- iv. Bank of Ghana Act, 2002 (Act 612)

Object of the Bill

The purpose of the Bill is to amend the Bank of Ghana Act, 2002 (Act 612) and provide for related matters

Content/Structure of the Bill

The Bill contains twenty (20) clauses, as follows:

Clause 1 amends subsection (2) of section 3 of Act 612 by introducing the phrase “without prejudice” in subsection (2).

Clause 2 introduces a new section 3A on medium-term inflation to be determined jointly with the Government.

Clause 3 introduces new sections 5A and 5B on authorised capital of the Bank and the coverage of shortfalls in authorised capital, respectively.

Clause 4 substitutes section 6 of Act 612 on the General Reserve Fund and payments into the Consolidated Fund. *Clause 5* amends section 8 of Act 612 by removing the voting rights of the representative of the Ministry responsible for Finance to ensure the independence of the Bank.

Clause 6 amends subsection (1) of section 10 of Act 612 by increasing the tenure of office of Board members of the Bank from four to five years which is renewable for another term only. *Clause 7* amends section 11A of Act 612 by disqualifying certain Government officials, including Members of Parliament, from serving on the Board of the Bank.

Clause 8 amends section 16 of Act 612 to expand the functions of the Audit Committee of the Bank, including oversight of financial reporting and disclosures, internal control processes, and implementation of audit recommendations.

Clause 9 amends section 20B of Act 612 by modifying the grounds for removal of a Deputy Governor of the Bank. *Clause 10* amends subsection (3) of section 27 of Act 612 to disqualify employees of the Bank, Members of Parliament, and persons holding official Government positions from serving on the Monetary Policy Committee.

Clause 11 provides for temporary advances to the Government by restricting the Bank from purchasing Government securities in the primary market or granting loans or advances except for the purpose of filling a seasonal shortfall in budgeted revenue. *Clause 12* provides for temporary advances to the Government in situations of *force majeure* where there is a temporary deficiency in Government revenue and sets conditions for repayment. It also requires the Minister to report to Parliament within thirty days on the terms and conditions of such an advance.

Clause 13 amends section 46A of Act 612 on the provision of emergency liquidity assistance to banks and financial institutions deemed illiquid but solvent. *Clause 14* amends section 49 of Act 612 on categories of business the Bank may not engage in and requires the Board to provide timelines for exiting prohibited activities.

Clause 15 amends section 51 of Act 612 to empower the Bank, under specified conditions, to borrow from foreign institutions and to grant short-term credit to financial institutions.

Clause 16 introduces a new section 53A requiring the Bank to submit half-yearly reports to the Minister for onward presentation to Parliament. *Clause 17* introduces a new section 62A on indemnification of Bank officials acting in good faith. *Clause 18* amends section 69 of Act 612 by adding to the definitions of expressions used in the Bill.

Clause 19 amends the Presidential Transition Act, 2012 (Act 845) by exempting members of the Board of the Bank from the application of subsection (1) of section 14 of Act 845. *Clause 20* provides for a transitional period for the recapitalisation of the Bank by the Government.

Observations

Rationale for the Bill

The Committee observed that since Bank of Ghana was created, the Bank has put in place many institutional, operational, transparency, and accountability measures to support the monetary policy framework. However, in 2021 and 2022, the country experienced major economic challenges. During that time, the Central Bank provided significant monetary financing which contributed to macroeconomic imbalances and a substantial accumulation of Government securities.

The subsequent Domestic Debt Exchange Programme also caused significant losses on government securities, leading the Bank to have negative equity and impaired the ability of the Bank to conduct effective monetary policy. These challenges brought to the fore the importance of enhancing the Bank's autonomy and its capacity to handle crises effectively.

The Minister for Finance, Hon Dr Cassiel Ato Forson informed the Committee that in order to strengthen the Bank's independence and its capacity to handle crises effectively as well as align

Act 612 with international best practices, the Amendment Bill has been proposed to:

- introduce a legal cap on the extent to which the Bank may provide monetary financing for Government operations as well as specify exceptional circumstances under which the legal cap may be exceeded, subject to strict conditions and oversight measures
- clarifying the roles, powers and responsibilities of the Bank
- establish a mechanism for the automatic recapitalization of the Bank in the event of significant losses, and
- reinforce the autonomy of the Bank, improve monetary policy effectiveness and restore confidence in the financial system of the country.

In a response to the need to pass the Bill urgently, the Minister indicated that the Bill was one of the International Monetary Fund Programmes with Government and it was also a condition precedent for the drawdown of the next tranche of the IMF support to the country. The next drawdown is expected to be released by late December 2025.

The Minister indicated that Bill, if passed, would enable the Bank improve monetary policy efficiency, enhance the Bank's operational and institutional framework and help to restore confidence in the financial system of the country

Disqualifying Members of Parliament and the Deputy Ministers for Finance from serving on the Board of Bank of Ghana

The Committee observed that the Bill seek to disqualify Deputy Ministers for Finance and Members of Parliament from serving on the Board of the Bank.

The Minister explained that the presence of the Deputy Ministers for Finance and Members of Parliament on the Board of the Central Bank impedes the independence of the Bank.

The Governor indicated that the amendment was consistent with best practices practiced in other jurisdictions to ensure the independence of the Central Bank. The Governor however admitted that both the MPs and the Deputy Ministers did not serve on any board or committee that was responsible for the performance of the critical functions and autonomy of the Bank such as the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC).

He also stated that the Deputy Ministers and MPs did not interfere with the mandate of the Central Bank. Their role was mainly limited to the administration of the Bank.

The Minister described the presence of the Deputy Ministers for Finance and Members of Parliament on the Board of the Central Bank as a healthy relationship and acted as an early warning system.

The Committee disagreed with the suggestion that the presence of the Deputy Ministers for Finance and

Members of Parliament on the Board of the Central Bank undermines the independence of the Bank. The Committee opined that Ghana's legal system was the hybrid system which provided for Members of Parliament served as Ministers and Deputy Ministers of State. Further Members of Parliament serve on the Boards on other regulatory Authorities, and their presence did not affect the autonomy and independence of these Authorities.

The Committee pointed out that the Deputy Ministers of Finance and Members of Parliament on the Board are government representatives, and their presence supported the principles of good governance.

The Committee held the view that their presence on the Governing Board did not undermine the autonomy and independence of the Central Bank but rather promoted it. It therefore recommended that in view of the uniqueness of the legal framework of the Ghanaian Legal Systems, those proposed amendments be expunged from the Bill.

Tenure of Office of Board members

The Committee observed that the Bill seeks to amend the tenure of the members of the Board from four (4) years to five (5) years.

The Governor indicated that the amendment became necessary as usually after a new Government is sworn in, it takes a while for the Board to be constituted. This hampers the operation of the Board severely. By extending the tenure, the situation would be avoided.

The Committee however disagreed with the Governor and opined that the four years which is conterminous with the tenure of Government should remain. The Committee indicated that new Governments were reluctant to work with members of the Board of the Central Bank who were appointed by another political party. By keeping it at four years, it would be consistent with the tenure of a new Government

The Committee holds the view that the tenure of members be kept at four (4) years.

Payment in the General Reserve Fund and the Consolidated Fund

The Committee noted that the Bill amends the existing provision on the General Reserve Fund and the Consolidated Fund by providing that the Bank would now transfer all the net profit into the General Reserve Fund if the amount of money in that Fund is less than 10 percent of the total monetary liabilities of the Bank.

The Governor indicated that this new arrangement was to ensure that the Bank would set off its indebtedness before transferring the balance into the Consolidated Fund.

Advances to Government

The Committee observed that the Bill details how temporary advances/loans can be made to the Government. It provided that the Central Bank could give advances to the Government through an overdraft, buying treasury

bills or securities, or any other way the Board decides, but these advances can't be more than five percent of the total revenue from the previous year. Further, the loan or advance granted to Government was to be repaid within three months after it is given.

The Bill estops the Bank from buying any securities made by the Government or its agencies and further that where the Government was unable to pay back the advance or loan within three months, the Central Bank was prohibited be able to give more advances to the Government. However, in times of emergencies (force majeure) the Bank may grant advances more than 5 percent to the Government consistent with established limits on public debt management.

The Governor informed the Committee that these rules were being proposed in line with best practices and to reinforce the independence and crises management capacities of the Central Bank.

The Committee noted that the Bill requires the Minister for Finance to notify Parliament of the remedial measures to be taken where the total amount outstanding of credit to Government is up to 5 percent of the previous fiscal year. The Bill also provides that where advances are made to the Government in times of emergencies, the Minister for Finance shall submit a report on the terms of the advances to Parliament within 30 days.

The Committee was of the view that these measures would help enhance the operations of the Central Bank and protect the Bank's autonomy.

Reporting to Parliament

The Committee observed that the Bill introduces new provisions which requires the Bank to submit a report to the Minister who intends would forward the Report to Parliament upon receipt of it.

The Committee was of the view that the provisions would enhance parliamentary scrutiny.

Recommendations

The Committee, having carefully scrutinized the Bill, proposes the following amendments for the consideration of the House:

Amendments

1. Clause 5 – Amendment proposed
- Section 8 of Act 612 amended
Delete the clause.
2. Clause 6 – Amendment proposed
- Section 10 of Act 612 amended
Delete the clause.
3. Clause 7 – Amendment proposed
- Section 11A of Act 612 amended
Delete the clause.
4. Clause 11 – Amendment proposed
- Section 30 of Act 612 amended, in subclause (8), line 3, after “Governor shall”

delete “notify” and *insert* “within seven days, give notice in writing to”.

5. Clause 11 – Amendment proposed - Section 30 of Act 612 amended, in subclause (9), line 1, after “subsection (8),” *insert* “within fourteen days,”.

6. Clause 12 – Amendment proposed - Section 30A inserted,

Delete subclause (5) and *insert* the following:

“(5) The Minister shall within thirty days of the grant of a temporary advance submit to Parliament a report on the terms and conditions of the temporary advance granted to the Government for

(a) ratification and the setting of a ceiling to any further temporary advances; and

(b) approval for additional temporary advances to be granted, where necessary.”.

7. Clause 12 – Amendment proposed - Section 30A inserted, subclause (6),

Delete paragraph (a) and *insert* the following:

“(a) a state of emergency declared by the President in accordance with article 31 of the Constitution; or”.

8. Clause 14 — Amendment proposed - Section 49 of Act 612 amended, in subclause (1), line 2, after “, the Bank”

delete “may” and *insert* “shall”.

9. Clause 14 — Amendment proposed - Section 49 of Act 612 amended, in subclause (2), line 3, after “years”

delete “or other period that the Board may determine”.

10. Clause 16 – Section 53A of Act 612 amended, in subclause (2), line 1, after “within”

delete “thirty” and *insert* “seven”.

11. Clause 16 – Amendment proposed - Section 53A of Act 612 amended, in subclause (4), paragraph (a), after “end of” *delete* “July” and *insert* “August”.

Conclusion

The Committee, having thoroughly examined the Bill, recommends to the House to adopt its Report and pass the Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025, into law in accordance with Article 106 of the 1992 Constitution and Standing Order 230 of the House.

Respectfully Submitted.

3:23 p.m.

Mr Speaker, in response to the need to pass the Bill urgently, the Minister indicated that the Bill was one of the International Monetary Fund (IMF) programmes with Government. It was also a conditioned precedent for the

drawdown of the next tranche of IMF support to the country. The next drawdown is expected to be released by late December, 2025.

The Minister also indicated that the Bill, if passed, will enable the Bank to improve monetary efficiency, enhance the Bank's operational and institutional framework and help to restore confidence in the financial system of the country. In view of that, the Committee proposed a lot of amendments which we want the House to assist us to consider.

In conclusion, Mr Speaker, the Committee, having thoroughly examined the Bill, recommends to the House to adopt its report and pass the Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025 into law in accordance with Article 106 of the 1992 Constitution and Standing Order 203 of the House. I so submit, Mr Speaker.

Question proposed.

Mr Isaac Adongo (NDC — Bolgatanga Central): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. The amendments that have been proposed, together with the Bill that has been submitted by the Minister for Finance are well intended to ensure that there is proper coordination between the Ministry of Finance and the Bank of Ghana (BoG). This is in order for the country to be able to deal with the challenges of some emergencies that may befall this country.

Mr Speaker, not long ago, the country experienced the COVID-19 pandemic. At the time, we did not have a

rigorous programme at the Bank of Ghana to assist the Government to navigate the challenges that ensued. This was especially since we had strictly, per the laws of the Bank of Ghana, restricted this country to 5 per cent of the previous year's revenue. But of course, we do appreciate that there are instances where the Central Bank, together with the Ministry of Finance, be empowered to go beyond the ceiling of that 5 per cent. When those things occurred, we basically were groping in the dark because the Central Bank did not have an enabler that could support the Government to deal with those measures.

Mr Speaker, the Bill seeks to ensure that even when those instances occur, these provisions are not abused and that Parliament retains the ultimate authority to approve and monitor the disbursement that would ensue from those circumstances. Because of this, I see this to be a very good law. First, to maintain the process to eliminate the level of fiscal dominance that we had in the past. But even if we have to do that, there are clear rules to ensure that the Executive comes back to this House to obtain the necessary approvals and ratifications to be able to address those challenges.

Mr Speaker, on this note, I wish to encourage all my Colleagues to support this Bill so that we can have a better Bill that coordinates the performance of the Government and the Bank of Ghana.

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko (NPP — Effia): Thank you very much Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to comment on the report of the Committee on Economy and Development on the Bank

of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025. Mr Speaker, the report takes us into the existence of the establishment of the Bank of Ghana and the need for us to do appropriate amendments on the existing Bank of Ghana law.

The Bank of Ghana is our Central Bank. When the Bank of Ghana fails to deliver on its mandate, the entire country stands at its own peril. So, reviewing the report of this Committee, I want to make a few comments on some of the clauses and my understanding of them and their impact on the operations of the Central Bank.

One key amendment this Bill seeks to make is to increase the tenure of members of the Board of the Bank of Ghana from four years to five years. I am sure that it is for some good reason that it intends to increase the tenure of service for members of the Board. But it is not just about extending the number of years of a Board that makes the Board effective and efficient. It is as to the processes, procedures, streamlining and guarantees that we want to see in the operationalisation of the Bank, that will emphasise the effectiveness of the Board. So, I would want this House not just to be swayed by the five years intended increase of service, but what the new Bill seeks to empower the Bank of Ghana on, to deliver on its mandate.

Mr Speaker, the report also speaks to an intention to bar certain officials from serving on the Board of Bank of Ghana. This includes barring Members of Parliament to serve on the Board of Bank of Ghana. I think that is very injurious to

the operationalisation of the Central Bank. Why do they want to stop Members of Parliament from serving on the Board of BoG? It does not accord any rational thoughts to me. Members of Parliament are representatives of the people, and the Central Bank is supposed to also work in the interest of the people of this country.

Why do they want to take Members of Parliament off the radar of serving on the Board of BoG? How do we exercise oversight beyond sitting here as Committees? Members of Parliament ought to serve on the Board of BoG. What are they trying to hide from the people of Ghana? Why? Are they doing this because of Hon Adongo? Are they bringing in this legislation to stop Hon Adongo from serving on the Board of BoG?

So, Mr Speaker, I believe that this Bill is coming before us—Parliament has the power to amend some of the provisions of this particular Bill. I believe that this House, at least in preserving the sanctity of Parliament and its oversight on the BoG, will not countenance removing Members of Parliament to serve on the Board of BoG. Mr Speaker, without further ado, I want to thank you for the opportunity to comment on this.

Second Deputy Majority Whip (Mr Richard Acheampong): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to support the Report before the House. To allay the fears of my Hon Colleague, we have the opportunity to either accept or reject all the drafting

instructions they gave to us because the amendments are before this House. So, when we get to the Consideration Stage, they will move the amendment and if we are going to support it, the ball is in our court.

Mr Speaker, trying to enhance the autonomy of Bank of Ghana is a good thing all of us must support.

3:33 p.m.

We were in this country when we were told that there was crisis in the financial sector, and we needed about GH¢15 billion to deal with the financial sector crisis. They ended up spending GH¢25 billion. The last report we had from the Ministry of Finance quoted GH¢33 billion. In the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, we need an additional GH¢3 billion to deal with the financial sector cleanup.

In all these, Parliament was not aware, and nobody was giving information to the House. They only come and reported their expenditure to us. So, at the end of the day, what is the role of Parliament? This amendment is saying that any decision they intend to take within 30 days, they have to report to Parliament, so that Parliament will seize the opportunity to know what is happening. Even if they want to exceed a 5 per cent threshold, they have to come back to the House, and the House will grant that.

It is not like the Executive and the Bank of Ghana will just connive and finance government expenditure without

recourse to Parliament, and we would see them having negative equity, and the effect will be on all of us. Going forward, we would give them the autonomy; whatever decision they intend to take, they would have to come back to the House, report to us, so that the House will be in the know and grant that approval. I think the amendment they have proposed is in order. Mr Speaker, times have changed. We need to do things differently.

Mr Speaker, in conclusion, I am calling on every Member of this House to support this amendment. It is not about Hon Adongo. Today, it is Hon Adongo; tomorrow, it may be any Member. Mr Speaker, with these few comments, I call on the House to support the amendment so that we can pass a law that can stand the test of time.

Thank you very much for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, you have the floor.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, indeed, you have granted me the floor. I will further pray, if you permit, my Colleague will make some comments before I come in, and the other Leader speaks. Mr Speaker, I make him pleadings, so that my Colleague who is a Member of the Finance Committee—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Stephen Amoah?

Dr Stephen Amoah (NPP — Nhyiaeso): Mr Speaker, thank you very

much for this prestigious opportunity. I am sure that in this country, there are two major economic policy frameworks that, if they are not well managed, the entire long-term goal of our country will be in shambles. We are talking about fiscal policy and monetary policy.

Mr Speaker, anywhere in the world, if an economy of any country would do well when it comes to our monetary policy, they cannot entirely detach such an important body as Parliament, which forms one of the fundamental arms of government, in terms of managing the amount of money in circulation, our policy rate, and even our reserve.

We have been talking about the fact that there should be more space to harmonise the policies that are being managed by our country in terms of fiscal by the Executive and the monetary by the Bank of Ghana. Even what we have today is not enough. How much less are we going to totally detach even the Members of this House who could be of immense assistance to what Bank of Ghana does? Honestly speaking, every decision-making process has an objective.

May I know the objective of what they are? They may be right, because I know that the Minister for Finance, today, is somebody, honestly, who knows the job. But he should be able to tell us and convince us why they want to put in place this inimical, dysfunctional policy decision. Is it to serve a specific purpose? Is it to create a situation where the attempt by the Government to totally control every institution in our country—

because this present Government is controlling all three arms of government entirely? Is it an attempt to get this country off the radar, that others here will know exactly what is going on there? We are highly disappointed and surprised —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Stephen Amoah, the law says contrary to what you are putting on record. What you are complaining about is a mischief that the law is seeking to cure, so that Parliament will come in to approve.

Dr Amoah: Mr Speaker, if you read page 2, clause 7 amends section 11(a) of Act 612 by disqualifying certain government officials, including Members of Parliament, from serving on the Board of the Bank. Transparency is at stake; accountability is at stake and participation by relevant key stakeholders is at stake. What exactly do they want to achieve? We just want to know. Maybe they have a better reason, but for now, they are trying to put in place elements of jeopardy in attaining the resilient economy and the long-term goal that we as a country are confronted with.

Mr Speaker, I think we need to do something about this. The fact that our Brothers have their numbers does not exclusively mean that they can do anything they want in this country. Although we are coming back in 2028, we do not want to come and amend a lot of laws. It is good that my Brother, the Minister for Finance, is here. Mr Speaker, I think we need to be notified, told and understand the underlying

definitional element of this amendment they want to make, because it is raising a lot of doubt. We are very sceptical. We do not know where they want to take this country.

Now, they are widening the gap between our fiscal policies and our monetary policies. Already, we are having problems with that. So, Mr Speaker, why they want to exclude us, Members of Parliament, from this, we want to know. It is a question, and we are asking for clarity, so that we are sure of the needed transparency and accountability.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Stephen Amoah, are you a Member of the Finance Committee?

Dr Amoah: Yes.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But definitely, at the Committee hearing on this Bill, you were not there.

Dr Amoah: But I can be indisposed. What I am reading here is why I am telling you the right thing. I know what I am reading. I read the clause.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, I am asking because most of the issues that you are raising have been addressed at the Committee level. But go ahead.

Dr Amoah: Mr Speaker, I think it has been a convention in this House that even sometimes the basic pieces of relevant information and the discussions we have at the Committee level, sometimes because of disagreement, we need to carry them and get a broader base in terms of proper and effective decision-

making processes. So, there is nothing wrong. My Brother knows that.

In fact, Dr Ato Forson taught me a lot at the Committee. I was new there.

Now, the discussion we had there, he will bring it here and make it bigger for a broader consultation and a stakeholder involvement.

3:43 p.m.

So, I think we want this decision to champion the cause of our country. He has to explain to us. I am not saying he is wrong or right, but we need clarity, the reason, whether it is credible enough, whether it is tangible enough to exclude your own parliamentarians. There are a lot of experienced hands in finance and economics and bankers here. You said they should not be part of it. So, who else? If we here cannot support Bank of Ghana, then who else can? So, we need clarity, transparency, and accountability so that we can support this Bill.

Having said that, Mr Speaker, I will leave it for my Leadership to speak, but for me, I have a lot of doubts about this.

Thank you, Mr Speaker. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I indicated that at Second Reading, we debate on the basis of the explanatory memorandum and the Report of the Committee. The Committee is recommending that the provision relating to a Member not serving on the board should be deleted. That is why I am saying that you should look at the explanatory memorandum as

well as the Report of the Committee, which will form the basis of the debate in this House.

Yes, Hon Minority Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, in line with Order 167, as you rightly reiterated, that a full debate is supposed to ensue on the explanatory memorandum and the Reports generated by the Committee, I think the Report sets out to give us a basis for the proposed amendments, the legal cap, automatic recapitalisation of the Bank, and circumstances under which the Bank could exceed legal cap, among other things. I proceed further to look at page 6 of the Report where there is a call to extend tenure of office of board members from four years to five years, and I perused the Report to find the reasoning for this. Initially, I thought it was an arbitrary decision and the only reason ascribed was that a new government would take a while to constitute the board and hence, we need a year. Why not two or three years? I find that quite arbitrary. So, I am against the changing of the period of service of the board members from four years to five years in that the reason being ascribed is not tenable. If there are other reasons that are convincing, probably when we get to the Consideration Stage, those who move the amendment may have to convince this House. At this stage of Second Reading, I am totally against that and I find it arbitrary.

Mr Speaker, again, just to emphasise the point you had opined earlier relating to disqualification of Members of Parliament from serving on the board, and the reasons ascribed is because it

feeds into best practice. I still struggle to understand how the serving of Hon Isaac Adongo and many others in the future would tend to undermine best practice. I do not get it. So, that is a challenge for me to accept and I think that we can amend that, and thankfully, the Committee rejected it outright. There was a unanimous decision by the Committee to reject that proposal. That is an aspect we have to look at again.

Mr Speaker, the rationale has been well espoused even though I have my few observations and objections here and there. In the fullness of time, when we get to the Consideration, I will make that known. But let me emphasise the point, that changing the four-years-service term to five years is not convincing, and the Hon Minister may have to tell us more, why he wants to come to this House with an amendment of changing the tenure of office of board members from four years to five years. I do not get it.

This will be my observation for now.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I am sorry to intervene again. If you read the Report of the Committee, it says that it should come back to four years and that it should not be five years.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I am just emphasising the position of the Committee in line with Order 167 that the Bill does not find favour in this House and that the proponents of the Bill should do the needful. Probably if they had done some more consultation, they would not have repeated this in the Report, especially where the Committee had said that it should be rejected and reverted to the four years. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Yes, Hon Minority Leader?

Minority Leader (Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin): Mr Speaker, with respect, I have taken the pain to read the memorandum and the Report of the Committee.

Mr Speaker, first of all, we have to revisit the rationale behind the principal enactment. One, the object was to insulate the Bank from Executive interference. I want to emphasise one more time; the object underlining the enactment of the Bank of Ghana Act, 2002 (Act 612) was to insulate the Bank from Executive interference. The clause 1 of this Bill, and same contained in the memorandum accompanying the Bill, defeats this completely. How can we now say that the principal enactment is being amended to state that support of economic policy of the Government is to be prioritised? Mr Speaker, you see clearly that when this House passes this Bill, the Minister would have some unfettered intrusion.

Mr Speaker, I appreciate the zeal of the Hon Minister, I appreciate his patriotism, but the Minister for Finance who is introducing this Bill must know that the Bank of Ghana is supposed to have full independence. The very complaints they made in the past when they said, there was interference—I remember when we had the cedi-dollar situation, the Minority Leader, Hon Cassiel Ato Forson, as he then was, was among those who filed a censure Motion against the former Minister for Finance, Mr Ofori-Atta, and contended with some

force that he had interfered in the activities of Bank of Ghana when there was no such express enactment that allowed the former Minister for Finance, Mr Kenneth Ofori-Atta, to have anything directly to do with the Bank of Ghana.

3:53 p.m.

Mr Speaker, in this Bill, the Minister of Finance is indirectly going to take away the executive mandate of the Governor. He does not need to state it in black and white, but if one has eyes, one can read. One needs to have eyes to see what the Minister for Finance is trying to do. The Minister of Finance should not introduce this Bill by personalising it. An Enactment lives beyond the tenure of a Minister. He can be made the Chief of Staff or the Minister of Defence tomorrow—*bonafide*—Would he say that because of his passion—One does not use passion to enact laws.

Dr Ato Forson, with respect, you may have disagreements with me, but let it be said—let me tell you, I would not just get up; I have my *aide memoir* and I have read on this. So please, he may disagree with me, but he should not say that I have not read, so I am just saying anything. Please, with respect—he knows how much I respect him, my respected Brother—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, address the Chair.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I will not get up on the Floor, when I am not so sure of the points I want to make. He may disagree with me.

Mr Speaker, what I see in this Bill is that, the Minister will be chipping away the independence of the Bank of Ghana (BoG). We have good reason for making the Governor the Executive Chairman and that is why he chairs the Board. That is why the Governor is supposed to be very independent. We are already hearing that every now and then, the Governor is being compelled to pump more money.

Now, it appears that they now want to enact on it and that is the understanding I am getting from this Memorandum and the Report of the Committee. Now, they want to give it a legal backing, so that if tomorrow BoG gives some liquidity support for the Government Economic Policy, we would be told that there is a law backing it.

Mr Speaker, let me read in my memo on this matter. This is what I have identified, that in Clause 1,

“...the Bill amends the principal object of the bank by restating price stability and adding supporting objectives including financial stability and support for Government Economic Policy.”

Mr Speaker, let us define government economic policy.

Let us define it broadly. It will include that when they have implemented some policies and they know that they are having serious challenges, they can now hide under this

Enactment and direct the Central Bank to do as they please.

Mr Speaker, just as my respected Colleague from Nsawam-Adoagyiri said, we will scrutinise it Clause by Clause when we get there. But it is important that *ab initio* we draw their attention to the very danger of what is ahead of us.

Mr Speaker, I identified the loophole that the amendment does not sufficiently insulate, like I said, the primary mandate from being subordinated to government policy priorities. They are not supposed to subordinate the Central Bank. They are supposed to make their own decisions and be very independent. What they are doing is to subordinate, through this Enactment, the Central Bank to policy priorities of Government.

Mr Speaker, so if in their 24-Hour Economy, they want to implement and feasibly the experts at the Central Bank feel that this thing will not help—They are saying that by this enactment, they are compelled to support their own economic policy priorities, even if it will hurt the economy. Is that what we want to do under this reset? No. They have introduced, a strange phrase, thus ‘...to support the economic policy of government.’”

Mr Speaker, our Colleague, the Minister for Finance must tread cautiously. I do not know the experts who provided expert advice on this and whether or not the Central Bank—

Mr Speaker, I am reading the Report. I did not see how involved the Central Bank was in respect of this whole matter and how comfortable they are. Of course, they are technicians. They would not say that they disagree with their Minister. But this will not help the cause of BoG and our economy in general. The Minister should stay away from the activities of the Central Bank. Government must allow the Central Bank to operate with that independence bequeathed them under Act 612; that should be it.

Mr Speaker, I would want to rest my case and pray that we get to the next stage. Once we get there, there would be an opportunity for us on this Side to introduce our amendment, to cure some of the excesses we have identified in this draft Bill. If they are indeed ready to do the needful and to support, so that the Bill would be properly fine-tuned to become mature as a proper law emanating from this House.

Mr Speaker, I rest my case on that point.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, the Minister for Finance, your concluding remarks?

Minister for Finance (Dr Cassiel Ato Forson): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, there is the need for me to clarify some few points. This Amendment Bill is rather supposed to strengthen the Central Bank and not to take its powers away from it. It is rather giving more powers to the Central Bank.

Mr Speaker, in doing so, let me now begin with the Statement made by the Minority Leader. The very Provision that he is making reference to has always been in this Bank of Ghana Act, 2022 (Act 612) since 2020. It is not new. This provision he is making reference to, has always been in the Central Bank's Act. The reason why we are seeing it here is that, we restated it and added another sub-Clause. They are not new.

I urge the Minority Leader to go and take the original enactment and compare it with what we are actually passing today. They are not new. Let me make this point again. Hon Minority Leader, can you listen to me?

Mr Speaker, they are not new at all. In fact, since the original enactment, there have been two amendments and all of them, we have restated. This is coming on the back of the Constitution of the Republic of Ghana. Let me refer to Article 183(1) and (2) of the Constitution, which reads;

“(1) The Bank of Ghana shall be the Central Bank of Ghana and shall be the only authority to issue the currency of Ghana.

(2) The Bank of Ghana shall—

(a) promote and maintain the stability of the currency of Ghana and direct and regulate the currency system in the interest of the economic progress of Ghana;

(b) it shall be the sole custodian of State funds of Ghana, both in and

outside Ghana, and may, by notice published in the *Gazette*, authorise any other person or authority to act as a custodian of any such fund, as may be specified in this notice;

- (c) encourage and promote economic development, encourage and promote economic development, and the efficient utilisation of the resources of Ghana;”

4:03 p.m.

Mr Speaker, oftentimes wrong impressions have been created that the central bank’s only mandate is price stability. They have a constitutional mandate of economic development, and that is actually in article 183(3) of the 1992 constitution. I am not the one who wrote this Constitution. It is the responsibility of the central bank to promote economic development. All we are seeking to do here is to lift what is in the original enactment because of the new amendment that it contributes to the promotion and maintenance of financial stability in the country. That is all. It is not new. It was in Act 612 and it was also in the Act 918. All of them, the same thing.

Mr Speaker, it is not new. What we are rather seeking to do here is to strengthen the provisions against monetary financing, to stop, “the printing of money”. That is what we are seeking to do here so that tomorrow another government will not come and print money in excess, to be able to create excessive inflation. That is what

we are preventing. We all know that monetary financing is against the progress of a country, and there should be some form of breaks in an Act, and that is what this Act seeks to do. What we have done here is to mandate the Minister for Finance to brief Parliament as soon as we reach the threshold of 5 per cent against previous year’s revenue and to assure the House of remedies that they are putting in place to correct those monetary finances. That is all we are seeking to do.

Mr Speaker, we are strengthening the hands of Parliament in the law to mandate the Minister for Finance to appear before you and to account and tell us the reasons behind the monetary financing, recognising that monetary financing breeds unnecessary inflation. That is what we are seeking to do. Aside that, today we have a central bank that has negative equity. We are putting in place measures to compel the government of the day to automatically recapitalise the central bank from 2034. This is because it takes a while to move it from negative equity, and so we will gradually move it from negative equity to positive equity and enshrine it in law so that any time the central bank reaches negative equity position, the government of the day will be compelled to recapitalise the central bank, because this is the central bank of the State.

Mr Speaker, this is best practise. It is done everywhere in the world. Let someone challenge me that that is not the case in other jurisdictions. That is what it is so, this Bill is rather strengthening the central bank, not weakening it. Again, it

is important I make the point that after practising democracy since 1992 and over 30 years of this particular fourth republic, we have learned our lessons, and we should certainly learn our lessons.

We have a central bank of State where any time there is a change of government, sometimes it takes up to 12 months, we have seen a situation where it took 10 months before the board of the central bank was reconstituted. What we are seeking to do here is that regardless of a change of government, the central bank being the central bank of the Republic of Ghana, must run until the time that the government of the day is ready to change the board. This is because we have seen it happen. I had the privilege to serve on the central bank as a board member. I served for four years.

When there was a change of Government, I did not attend board meetings any longer because I felt that I was there to represent the Minister for Finance. It took seven months before the board was reconstituted. But the central bank must run. Beyond the politics, the central bank must run. And that is why we are saying that there should be a system in place where the governing board of the central bank must be in place until the government of the day decides. So, that is the rendition in the Bill. Mr Speaker, all we are seeking to do here is rather to strengthen the corporate governance of the central bank, and to give them more powers for them to be able to perform their monetary policy.

Mr Speaker, let me make this final point. I recall in 2015, this same House debated and approved the current Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Act, 2016 (Act 918). The significant difference between what we approved in 2016 and what existed then was the fact that in the past, the Ministry of Finance nominates someone to serve on the Monetary Policy Committee. We felt that impedes on the independence of the central bank. This is because the Constitution guarantees the monetary policy independence of the central bank. In other words, the functional autonomy of the central bank. So, what we sought to do at the time was to move the Ministry of Finance, being a fiscal agency, from the Monetary Policy Committee. Today, it is a different story and all of these were done at the time to strengthen the independence of the central bank. Today, the central bank is strong, as long as independence is concerned. There is a proposal before this House to go a little bit more.

Mr Speaker, it is for the House to decide but all we are seeking to do here is nothing short of strengthening the central bank to be able to perform their Constitutional mandate of price stability and development. That is all. That is all we are seeking to do and not to rather allow the Ministry of Finance to encourage Bank of Ghana to print money. No, it is the reverse.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with that special leave granted, I was trying to draw my respected Colleague's attention to an important

matter that the issue of the tenure of the board is a matter that has received judicial pronouncement in the *Donkor v the Attorney General* case.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minority Leader, the issue that you are raising is not torn, so why are you trying to patch it?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It is not broken so why are you trying to fix it?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: If we would want to follow the gravamen of this submission, we would realise that the point is that the argument by the respected Minister for Finance to the effect that when there is a change of government, there is this kind of *lacuna* in terms of the next board, *et cetera*. It is a function of the new government to prioritise its activities, including certain appointments.

Mr Speaker, for instance, it has taken almost 11 months for the Road Fund Board to be reconstituted. That is a matter of priority. In *Donkor v the Attorney General*, the Supreme Court was very clear that the appointment is coterminous with the tenor of the appointor. Therefore, my own view is that even if this proposed amendment receives the blessing of this House, it will be rendered otiose by that position of the court.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, you are not getting the

indication from me. Sometimes you make me speak too much. The Committee has taken a position. Which position is coterminous with what you are saying?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I agree, that is why I am saying that—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So that is why I am telling you that if the thing is not torn, why are you trying to patch it? Do not fix it when it is not broken.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I understand you, but the Minister has spoken for *Hansard*. So, I needed to draw his attention. I have followed the proceedings at the Committee and I know the Committee's report on this particular matter. But he was here again trying to justify. So, I only wanted to draw his attention to that matter. That is all.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister for Roads and Highways?

Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza) (MP): Mr Speaker, I agree with the Minority Leader, just for the *Hansard*. Nobody has set up a Road Fund Board. So, I do not know which board the Hon Member is talking about. There is nothing like the Road Fund Board which was set up after 11 months. Let that be the record. It does not exist.

The board he is saying has been set up does not exist.

4:13 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us all take it that what we are considering is not the Road Fund Board; we are considering the Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill. So, let us all stick to the Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

The Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025, accordingly read a Second time.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Can we turn to the *Order Paper Addendum*, Commencement of Public Business, Presentation of Papers.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, we turn to the *Order Paper Addendum*, the item numbered 1(a) and (b).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the *Order Paper Addendum*, item numbered 1(a), by the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways.

PAPERS

By the Minister for Roads and Highways—

Contract Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana represented by the Ministry of Roads and Highways and the Contracting Authority and Accra-Kumasi Expressway Limited as the Concessionaire.

Referred to the Committee on Roads and Transportation and the Leadership of the Finance Committee.

By the Chairman of the Committee—

Report of the Committee on Education on the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, on the item numbered 1 (a), I just needed clarity.

It reads:

“Contract Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana represented by the Ministry of Roads and Highways and the Contracting Authority and Accra-Kumasi Expressway Limited as the Concessionaire.”

Mr Speaker, this Paper is being laid, and I want to know whether the Concessionaire is government-owned and when it was incorporated.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, with all due respect, at the presentation of Papers, do we ask questions?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I am not asking questions. The rule requires that if requested.

Mr Speaker, we need some patience here. The Standing Orders is clear that an explanatory position from the Hon Minister can be made, and as a Member, I can ask of him.

Mr Speaker, Order 97(3) is clear. For the avoidance of doubt, I may want to read:

“A short explanatory statement shall be made by the person presenting a Paper where requested by the House or a Member upon presentation.”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, if that is what you are asking, I would have allowed the Minister to give the short explanation, but in this case, you are asking questions.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, no!

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is why I indicated that at the presentation of Papers, do we ask questions?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, do not let us have a back and forth. Let me put it in a proper context.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, please do.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I rise on Order 97(3) to request the Hon Minister to provide a short explanatory statement in respect of the Paper.

Mr Speaker, I say so because some introductions are being made. Firstly, —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, the Standing Order is clear. So, once you have stated your position, let me offer the opportunity to the Hon Minister —

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I need to state clearly what I want.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, it does not lie in your mouth to indicate this is what you want, or what you do not want. The Orders state that you have the right to ask the Hon Minister to give an explanation to the Paper being introduced in the House. So, I will ask the Hon Minister in two minutes to give a short explanation.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, indeed, this is a concession contract between the Government of Ghana and a concessionaire. Details of the incorporation and everything will be available to the Committee during consideration, and the Report will be presented to the House. So, I agree with him. The details of the concessionaire and everything will be available. It is 100 per cent owned by the Government of Ghana.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Minister. The referral still stands to the Committee on Roads and Transportation and I am urging the Leadership of the Finance Committee to join them and consider the Contract Agreement and, accordingly, report to the House.

Yes, Mr Richard Acheampong?

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, we will take the item numbered 2 on the *Order Paper Addendum*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister for Finance, Motion numbered 2 on the *Order Paper Addendum*.

MOTION

Suspension of Order 169 (1) Minister for Finance (Dr Cassiel

Ato Forson): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 169(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that when a Bill has been read a second time, the Bill shall pass through a consideration stage which shall not be taken until at least two sitting days have elapsed, the Consideration Stage of the Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025 may be *taken* today.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Motion moved. Any seconder?

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Isaac Adongo): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

BILL — CONSIDERATION STAGE

Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, do not let the continuous rising from the Minority Frontbench irritate you; it is part of democracy.

Mr Speaker, I want clarity. I am a student of the rules, and I am still learning. By this Motion 2 being taken, does that suggest that the intendment is to take the Bill through the Consideration Stage today and consider everything under Certificate of Urgency? Is that it? I want to know from the Majority Frontbench, because it is now the norm from the new Majority that every Bill is taken under the Certificate of Urgency.

If it is so, I want *Hansard* to record that this all-important Bill that has just been introduced today and everything must be taken. Is Certificate of Urgency the new norm? Mr Speaker, this is the new norm. Every Bill that is brought, before we realise, it is taken under Certificate of Urgency. Then we sit in this House, and Civil Society Organisations will raise issues. When they raise issues, we are quick to come to this House.

4:23 p.m.

When parliamentarians raise matters, because of their partisan interests, they do not listen. I would want to say that it would be wrong to take this Bill through a certificate of urgency, on the same day. Let us tread cautiously.

It happened in the Lithium Agreement; Hon Abu Jinapor raised it here, but our Colleagues opposite defended it. When IMANI and other Civil Society Organisations came in and added their voices, they now came to this House, humbly withdrew, and now called for stakeholder consultation. Parliament, as a people's chamber, can deal with this. If everything we raise is taken as a partisan matter and we are not listened to, Mr Speaker, our democracy will suffer. It should not take the Civil Society Organisations to wake them up. We are here to do the needful. They cannot take this Bill under a certificate of urgency. They cannot use the rules to say they are taking everything today. What is the urgency when MPs have not had the opportunity to scrutinise? They should go ahead, and their masters, the CSOs, will be at their throats.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the rules are clear as to when a procedural Motion is supposed to be moved—Bank of Ghana (Amendment Bill), 2025 at the Consideration Stage. Once the mace has been tilted, please let us proceed.

Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I drew your attention earlier in context to Order 160(2)

“The Speaker shall refer a Bill to the appropriate Committee for determination of the urgency or otherwise after the presentation and First Reading.”

And then, if we proceed further, Order 167 basically talks about Second Reading. I am saying that the practice of this House has been that the two are determined independently; we do not fuse the two. The earlier Report that was submitted by the Chair, we had Order 160 and 167 incorporated, where we were basically doing a Second Reading of the Bill. I tried to draw your attention to the fact that it is an anomaly. It is not done like that. The determination of the urgency of the Bill should have been done independently of the Second Reading. But we fused the two. It is not done.

Nobody is against the Bill. We want to help them pass it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, can you read Standing Order 169(1)?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, Order 169(1) reads,

“When a Bill has been read a Second Time, the Bill shall pass through a Consideration Stage in the House which shall ordinarily not be taken until at least two sitting days have elapsed.”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, under what circumstances do we move a procedural Motion?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, with respect, I am basically drawing your attention to the fact that our practice in this House has been that any time we are engaging in a determination under Order

160, which is the urgency of the Bill, the report is generated differently from 167, which is the Second Reading.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You see, at Second Reading, the Report of the Committee is taken together with a Motion. That is why Order 167 states that the basis of the debate is the explanatory memorandum and the Report of the Committee which we considered at Second Reading. Now, being masters of our own rule, under normal circumstances, 24 hours would have elapsed before we can move to the Consideration Stage. And fortified by Standing Order 169, a procedural Motion was moved and carried by the House. Then, from there, we moved to the Consideration Stage.

So, where a procedural Motion is moved, I do not know why we are still talking about urgency or otherwise.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I will defer to you on these matters of interpretation. But maybe at another time, I will engage you for us to discuss this matter in more detail. I have my own views, but on this occasion, I will defer to you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I am open to a debate. So, you realise that I indicated that the Bill is at the Consideration Stage after the procedural Motion was moved.

Clause 1—Section 3 of Act 612 amended.

Mr Eric Afful: Mr Speaker, thank you. There are no proposed amendments.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Kojo Oppong Nkrumah.

Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah: Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr Speaker, there is a proposed amendment to *delete* clause 1 of the Bill as it stands now.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposal by Hon Kojo Oppong Nkrumah is to *delete* clause 1 of the Bill.

Mr Nkrumah: If I may, I will provide the reasoning for Colleagues to understand.

Mr Speaker, the old section 3 of Act 612 has already been amended. It has been amended by Act 918. And if we look at 918, permit me to read 918, it amends the subclause 2 to say that:

“without limiting subsection 1, the bank shall

- (a) support the general economic policy of the government
- (b) promote economic growth and development, and effective and efficient operation of the bank and credit system, and
- (c) contribute to the promotion and maintenance of financial stability in the country.”

Mr Speaker, that is the exact same thing that this new amendment proposes. So, it has already been amended by 918, and that is why we are suggesting that it be deleted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairman of the Committee, let me first hear the Minister for Education.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, Hon Kojo Oppong Nkrumah is relying on the amendment in 918. Is he suggesting to the Chairman that because 918 already captures the objects of the Bank of Ghana, which includes, without limiting it to (b) and (c), he stands down the proposed amendment of section 3 of Act 612, as amended?

Mr Speaker, what he is suggesting is, per your own guidance, when we looked at the GETFund Act, you gave a similar clue as to maintaining what is in the original legislation. So maybe, Mr Speaker, when you hear from the Chairman of the Committee, we will be guided. But for his argument, he should have been here earlier to guide the Minority Leader. Because he came quoting the same thing as if the Hon Minister for Finance and the Chairman of the Committee were doing something different. Yet, the same amendment was done.

That is why the Minister for Finance stated categorically and emphatically that what he is doing is probably what happened here before. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

4:33 p.m.

Mr Afful: Mr Speaker, I think at the committee level, we agreed on this matter that Act 612 was amended to Act 918. That particular clause was earmarked for change. But later, we realised we needed to return to the earlier proposition in Act 612. So, I do not know where the amendment is coming from.

Thank you.

So, Mr Speaker, the original Act 612 had two sub-section under Section

3. The first was the omnibus provision, if I may just read the original provision—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, to get a better understanding of this particular Bill, you need to take the original Act, Bank of Ghana Act 2002 (Act 612) and you must again put the Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Act 2016 (Act 918) together. The Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Act 2016 (Act 918) in Section 2, amended Section 3 of Bank of Ghana Act (Act 612). These were the amendments to the law.

2. “The principal enactment is amended in Section 3 by the substitution for subsection 2 of

(2) Without limiting subsection 1, the Bank shall:

- a) support the general economic policy of the Government;

- b) promote economic growth and development and effective and efficient operation of the banking and credit system, and
- c) contribute to the promotion and maintenance of financial stability in the country.”

Hon Members, the amendment which is being proposed is:

“Object of the Central Bank

3. (1) The primary object of the Bank is to maintain stability in the general level of prices

(2) Without prejudice to subsection (1), the Bank shall

- (a) support the general economic policy of the Government;
- (b) promote economic growth and development, and effective and efficient operation of the banking and credit system; and
- (c) contribute the promotion and maintenance of financial stability in the country.”.

“...the principal object of the Bank is to maintain stability in the general level of prices...”

Section 2 (a) here, the 2B is the same and 2(c) is also the same. What I am not seeing in the Act 918 is the ‘primary object of the Bank is to maintain stability in the general level of prices.’

Mr Nkrumah: Mr Speaker, let me help you. In the amendment of 2016, which is the Act 918, that amendment did not deal with the subsection 1. It maintained it, and then it amended the subsection 2.

Today, if we read the two pieces of legislation together, the Subclause 1 exists and the Subclause 2 in the original 612 has now been amended by 918. There is not a single word that is different from this and what is being proposed currently.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I will put the question.

Yes? Let me hear from the Minister for Finance.

Dr Forson: Mr Speaker, yes, what Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah is talking about is the case. But the draftsman felt that it is a bit—it is not neat if one is to read from two different amendments. So, they are deleting it and restating it by consolidating it. That is what the drafters felt should be done. Nothing has changed. It is the same, but they are just consolidating it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, if this amendment is carried out, what it will mean is that, to understand the object, we would have to pick Act 612, Act 918 and this amended Act. As it is, once this one is not bringing anything new, let the provision as it is in Act 612 and Act 918 stand. That is the basis of the proposal, that this clause 1 is needless, so it should be deleted.

Question put and amendment negatived.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think this thing will need to be subjected to more interrogation. Based on Mr Speaker's argument and what the Minister has done, it was clear that this was not needed. If they continue in this order, Mr Speaker, I will invoke Order 151(3) on this matter. Mr Speaker there must be clarity on that. If the Minister is speaking in support of a proposed amendment of which the Minister is the Minister for Finance, and then we are subjecting it even without listening to any kind of voting, then we will scrutinise every part of it and vote on every clause of this Bill. It should not be the same.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon First Deputy Minority Whip, you know the process of making the law. We put a question and then we decide the votes. So one thing that I say is that at the Consideration Stage, there is always an opportunity of a Second Consideration Stage if you feel so strong about your position.

Clause 1 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 2 — Section 3A inserted.

Mr Nkrumah: Mr Speaker, we have a proposed amendment. Mr Speaker, please give me some latitude. This is a very important piece of legislation. The House has agreed to take it through one day by the suspension of the Standing

Orders done earlier. But the least we can do is to take our time and go through it so that we do not create any problems for ourselves. This first one, we will bring it back at Second Consideration. There was a question of the independence of the Central Bank that was raised by the respected Minority Leader earlier. There are a number of clauses like this one that in our interpretation are taking back the independence of the Central Bank. This Section 3A, or clause 2 of the amendment Bill now, seeks to insert a new Section 3A in the original Acts 612.

4:43 p.m.

Mr Speaker, please listen to the wording: "The Bank of Ghana shall determine the medium-term inflation target jointly with the Government.". Inflation targeting has forever been the preserve of the Central Bank. Yes, they consult and talk to various other entities, but it is important to have it clearly known that the Central Bank has its total independence in inflation targeting.

We are proposing that the words "jointly with Government" be *deleted* so that the rendition will be "The Bank shall determine the medium-term inflation target.". We do not need to legislate that now in determining the medium-term inflation target, they should go and literally get instructions from Government. We think that would be dangerous for the independence of the Central Bank, and that is why we propose that we *delete* the words "jointly with the Government.".

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, that is the proposal. It is for the consideration of the House. Yes, Hon Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I support this proposed amendment. If the House may recall, some 20 or so minutes ago, the Minister, in his argument, suggested that this Bill would rather ensure more independence as needed by the Central Bank. He again said the amendment is to ensure efficiency. This was to rebut my earlier submission that this Bill that has been introduced seeks to subordinate the independence of the Central Bank to the authority of the Government.

Mr Speaker, where the Government determines the political question, the Central Bank is there to restrain the politics of the central Government, and to ensure that the economy is run in a way that would ensure sufficient transparency, clarity and give assurances to the investing public. How do they enact a law that would say inflation should be jointly determined by the Central Bank and the Government? Oh, are they anticipating their failures already? Let us not encourage this.

There is nothing independent in this enactment. The independence of the Central Bank is being chipped away; that is the least I can say. That is if they are not taking away their independence. If they say that it should be jointly determined who should do that? Do they mean the Governor should come to the Ministry of Finance, report to the Minister and if he tells the Governor that

the Ghana Statistical Service has these figures, so he should not publish it, then the Governor will say “Yes Sir”? This is because in the end, they are the political master.

We should not treat this proposed amendment the way we treated the clause 1, where Hon Oppong Nkrumah made the proposal and some people— *[Expunged by orders of the Speaker]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, the statement that some people— *[Expunged by order of the Speaker]*

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I take that one out. That is correct and all right. I think it is fair to take that one out.

We should not introduce in this enactment any provision that would take away the independence of the Central Bank. That is the mainstay of the argument coming from the Member for Ofoase Ayirebi. Why do they want to interfere? Then they claim that there is going to be independence.

Mr Speaker, we should support this amendment. But I can promise the Majority one thing. If they do not listen to us, the only masters they know, the Civil Society Organisations (CSOs) will summon them back into this Chamber.

I rest my case.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, let me hear— Hon Minister, just take it easy. Let me hear Hon Adongo, then I will come back to you.

Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah: This is the second time I have heard—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I will come back to you.

Mr Isaac Adongo: Mr Speaker, I think it has to be made very clear that inflation targeting framework is a methodology, therefore, it is not about someone summoning another person to a particular location. It is a methodology, and the Government statistician is the one who reports the actual inflation that is delivered. So, it is not as if, if we want to define our methodology and we identify a key stakeholder whose activities impact on the methodology, and we say that it is important for us to create a mechanism that allows us to share information so that us can improve the framework, it amounts to somebody taking away another person's independence. That is just far-fetched.

So, Mr Speaker, I do not think that jointly doing the framework and identifying the methodology is in any way an attempt to take away the independence of the Central Bank. Everybody knows that a key tool of the Central Bank is the Monetary Policy Committee; that is where the technical work is done. At the Monetary Policy Committee, there is no Executive representation on that committee. Therefore, the independence of the Central Bank is not in question at all.

They may have their views, but this idea of almost blackmailing everybody with CSOs, is unacceptable. We cannot tolerate that posturing, that in

everything, our masters are CSOs. We were in this country when the Central Bank printed GH¢80 billion. Did the laws of our land support it? Were they supported by the laws of our land?
[*Interruption*]

We kept quiet when the Hon Minority Leader was talking. I listened to him in silence. The intolerance is just too much. Anytime he says something and somebody has a contrary view, he feels jittery, and that is not fair. There is nothing about somebody taking away the independence of the Central Bank. The Monetary Policy Committee's work is not being hijacked, neither is the financial stability function of the Bank of Ghana being hijacked.

But the Central Bank works with other stakeholders, and one of its key stakeholders is the Government of Ghana. If the two have to work together to ensure that they develop an appropriate framework, so be it.

So, Mr Speaker, I oppose the new amendment that is being proposed.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, we are making an amendment to an Act. In it, we are saying that the Central Bank should determine the medium-term inflation target jointly with the Government. Why are we making an express provision in a Bank of Ghana Act, that the decision to make a determination of an inflation target should be done jointly with the Government of the Republic? That is far-fetched and incongruous. This is because we are establishing from the whole

memorandum up to where we are talking about even representation on the board. We are saying that we want to establish a Central Bank that is independent. So why are they legislating an independent body to take a decision in conjunction with the Government? The independence must be seen in substance, not in the form.

4:53 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I believe that this particular provision is not supposed to be accepted by this House. Please, let us take note, we are not passing this Bill for the Majority. The Central Bank Act is not an Act for the Majority; we are passing it for the good people of this country. We should be very careful with the decisions we take today. The Central Bank ought to be independent, and we cannot legislate for the Central Bank to make a determination of inflation target. They can consult. Why? The Central Bank has always been in consultation with the Government and with other stakeholders. Why are they legislating a joint decision? Then let us do everything jointly in it.

Mr Speaker, this provision that “The Bank shall determine...”, is supposed to be mandatory. Why should it be mandatory for them to make a decision jointly with the Government? This should not be. As I am saying, this Bill is not for the Majority; it is for Ghana, and Ghanaians are saying that the Central Bank cannot take a decision jointly with the Government.

I so submit, Mr Speaker. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister for Finance, let me hear from the Minister for Education, and then I would give you the last bite.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I have listened to the last speaker and the first proponent of the opposition to Section 3 being inserted. May I urge them to take their time to read the headnotes and the substance of the provision, which reads, “Medium-term inflation”, not short-term.

Mr Speaker, from the economics they studied, the monetary policy is the domain of the Bank of Ghana, and fiscal policy—[*Interruption*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, why are we doing this? Let us have the patience to listen to each other.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, let Hon Habib Iddrisu tell him that a year past, my name was synonymous with economics.

Mr Speaker, I am saying that fiscal policy and monetary policy impact inflation. All that this provision is saying is that in determining the medium-term inflation target—So when the Minister for Finance, including their previous Ministers for Finance, when they stand here and read inflation target, how do they determine it? So, I do not think there is anything wrong with saying: “The Bank shall determine the medium-term inflation target jointly with Government.” No, it is a medium-term determination of the inflation target. It is not only monetary policy that affects

inflation; fiscal policy and monetary policy affect inflation.

In any case, it is the Minister for Finance who comes here to make a determination. Mr Speaker, maybe they should be guided well. In the United States of America (U.S.A.), what is the rate of inflation? It has stayed reasonably 2 per cent to 4 per cent. This is because they are keeping the pursuit of monetary and fiscal policy to meet the inflation target. That is all this Minister seeks to do. They should read it well; medium-term target to determine a future target, so that both in the pursuit of monetary policy and fiscal policy, we would work towards the attainment of that medium-term target.

I thank you.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, you are up again?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, we are at the Consideration Stage.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I have heard you on this matter already, that is why I am using the word you are up again. Am I wrong in saying so?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I appreciate.

I have heard the Minister for Education using some very technical terms in an attempt to confuse this House. But the matters are simple in language. The contention of the Minority

is on the express language used that there shall be a joint determination of medium-term inflation. *Simpliciter*. All this economics; monetary impact and fiscal impact, is not the mainstay of the call. The burden of Hon Oppong Nkrumah's submission is to the effect that by introducing this mandatory provision, they will be chipping away the independence of the Central Bank. That is all he is saying. They have not addressed that.

All those who spoke on their Side could not address this very important point, and that is the issue. Why would they introduce a mandatory provision? The Hon Member for Effia argued that we know of general consultation but that is not enacted upon. We know that from time to time, there are steering committee meetings that are chaired by heads of institutions, including the Minister for Finance. These are part of the general consultation process. But what they are doing now is to bring an enactment that will make it mandatory and subject the Governor to their whims and caprices if they find it convenient to do so. But we also know that as a Minister, he determines the political question. We have good reasons for saying that the Central Bank should be independent.

Mr Speaker, like the Hon Member for Effia said, this is not an enactment for the Majority of which they will claim victory or otherwise. We are not in an ego field. It is an enactment to regulate an important sector of the economy for the people of Ghana. Our duty from this Side is to draw your attention to some of these

errors, some of these overlooks, and some of these excesses. It is we who must tell them that they cannot legislate to subordinate the authority and independence of the Central Bank to political authority. They cannot do that. That amounts to state capture, that the political authority is capturing every independent authority we have in the country.

Mr Speaker, medium-term inflation is what makes it more dangerous. They did not say “may”; if it were “may”, we could accommodate that. But if they say “shall”, then our Friends must listen. When I say it is the civil society organisations (CSOs) they are listening to, I say so on good authority because the CSOs themselves published their engagement with the Executive and said that what they told the Executive is what has been accepted. It is a matter of public record. It is not Afenyo-Markin who is concocting this.

Meanwhile, the very things that the CSOs have been telling them and they listen to, are the very things we tell you from this Side of the House. So, why would they not avail themselves to listen to us? Rather, they throw us away, dismiss our views, look down upon our views, and think it is political because we do not share the same ideology with them. No. If they go outside, the CSOs will say the same thing. They cannot say that the Bank of Ghana should determine medium-term inflation jointly with them, the Minister for Finance and the Government. If they say “may”, we will accommodate. Even in that “may”, that means a level of consultation; we can.

This is because the essence of governance is to engage. We accept it. But if they say mandatory, do it. So, if they do not do it, they would not allow them to make certain public announcements?

Mr Speaker, I have a problem with that. I think that the proposal must be accepted by the House.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Armah-Kofi Buah, let me hear you.

Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah: Thank you, Mr Speaker. This debate is not about the independence of the Bank of Ghana. It has already been explained, and it is very clear. But it is important that as we debate, we will make sure that we do not confuse the people of Ghana and put out facts that are incorrect, as the Minority Leader is trying to. He has made three points consistently that we redrew the Lithium Agreement because of CSOs. Let the records be clear, and this is a House of records.

5:03 p.m.

I have been in this House for five terms, and it is a long time. I have seen Ministers lay Bills here, and for very good reasons, they withdraw the Bills to bring it back strengthened. That is exactly what we did.

We have been working on an array of regulations to support the Bill that was laid, and it was wise for me, as sector Minister, to withdraw it, work on the regulations, so that we can bring the Bill back with the regulations together. And

that is a decision which has nothing to do with CSOs, even though CSOs are very important stakeholders, and there is nothing wrong with engaging CSOs. But for the Hon Minority Leader to consistently make this point which is factually inaccurate on this Floor, he should get his facts right.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I think we have debated this clause enough. I want to give the opportunity to the Minister for Finance to conclude on this matter. Hon Members, let us concentrate on the Bill at stake.

Yes, Hon Minister for Finance, you may have the concluding word.

Dr C. A. B. Forson: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

I vehemently disagree with the amendment as proposed by Hon Kojo Oppong Nkrumah, and in doing so, let me state for the record that as at today, Ghana is on an International Monetary Fund (IMF) relief programme. The IMF, as we all know, is a monetary institution. The global monetary organisation is the IMF, and there is no way a government of any country can introduce a Bill that seeks to take powers from its monetary authority that the IMF will approve.

Mr Speaker, the amendment before us is only sticking to international best practices. Let me explain. Monetary policy alone cannot anchor inflation. It does not matter what you do. Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) decision cannot determine what inflation will be.

It is a fact that the fiscal policies of the day together with the monetary policies is what anchors the inflation framework. If you are to have a budget before you that says that this is where I am going with inflation, that I am going south while the central bank is going north, in the end you will not achieve your inflation target. The two institutions of State are conjoined by an Act of Parliament, the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921) to introduce what we call Economic Policy Coordinating Committee so that they can talk to each other and anchor economic progress.

Mr Speaker, in most countries today, medium-term inflation targeting is done by the two institutions. When I come here and present a Budget Statement and Economic Policy for and on behalf of Government, and assume that inflation is going to be, for instance, 8 per cent plus or minus 2 per cent, my policies introduced in the Budget should anchor that inflation, targeting together with the policies of the Central Bank. So, I cannot go south while the Central Bank goes north. So, all what we are seeking to do here is that the medium-term inflation framework must be developed by these two institutions of State.

Mr Speaker, what we are saying is that the Monetary Policy Committee of the Central Bank is extremely independent. They take their decisions, but the Ministry of Finance or Government is not leaving the inflation target entirely to the Central Bank. Let us plan together. Let us together anchor inflation. It is the responsibility of the

Government of the day, to make sure that prices of goods and services do not get out of hand, and so, if today I am seeing food inflation, the Central Bank cannot anchor food inflation. It is the responsibility of the Government of the day to introduce policies in the fiscal year to reduce food inflation.

What is the role of the Central Bank if prices of services or food stuffs are high? What can the Central Bank do? Are they the Ministry in charge of Agriculture? Are they the ones planting cassava and yam? No. It is the fiscal authorities, the Government of the day. So, the medium-term inflation target of the Central Bank must be in sync with government policies. That is all.

Mr Speaker, I heard the Hon Minority Leader say that this is State capture. This cannot be state capture. We know what State capture is. We have seen State capture before. State capture is when you get the Central Bank to print GH¢80 billion for you in one fiscal year. That is State capture. Let me give you an example of State capture. It is when you collateralise royalties in the name of Agyapa for 20 years. That is State capture.

Mr Speaker, let us put this in proper perspective. What is before us has nothing to do with State capture. What is before us is to make sure that together, as the Government of the day, we anchor inflation and make sure that prices of goods and services are reduced. That is what we are seeking to do. So, Mr Speaker, you can propose your amendment, but I beg to say that I oppose that amendment.

Thank you very much

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, the proponent of the amendment?

Mr Nkrumah: Mr Speaker, I think some things have been lost in the heated exchanges that are going on. First of all, we are helping the Minister to get this amendment right, so he should calm down and kindly listen to the rationale behind the arguments we are making.

We are not saying that the Central Bank should not determine medium-term inflation. In fact, if you go to the original Act 612, it starts off under the Section 3 by saying that the primary objective of the Bank is to maintain stability in the general level of prices. There is a reason for which, as part of the broader economic policy, when it comes to the maintenance of price levels, that is divorced to the Central Bank, and there is a reason for which it is supposed to operate independently. So, while we agree that it is a good idea to bring in Clause 3(a) to expressly announce the determination of medium-term inflation, we are warning them that if they now, in black and white, say that the independent Central Bank should now do that, “shall” determine this jointly with the Government, they are sending wrong signals at the lowest level. Today, he may believe that he is a good Minister for Finance who is well-intended and that he is only seeking to coordinate. Tomorrow, what if the person in that chair decides that he now wants literally to have fiscal dominance in making those inflation-targeting decisions?

So, Mr Speaker, my proposed amendment, and I will leave it here, is that let us just delete the words “jointly with government” so that we also do not fall into this hole that is now becoming clear that the Executive literally wants to start dictating to the Central Bank.

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So now the proposal for the consideration of the House is not to delete the entire Clause 2, but to delete “jointly with Government”.

Yes, Hon Minister for Education?

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I have been reading the Bank of England Act of 1998, United Kingdom, and government sets inflation targets, not the Bank of England. What the Bank of England does is to operationalise the targets. That is all he is doing. So, for purpose of responsibility—How come that Mr Ken Ofori-Atta, as Minister, came here and set inflation targets? Then after a few months, he came and said he was revising his inflation target. It was not the Governor who came here. *[Interruption]* No, if they want us to improve “jointly”, I have no problem. But they working together to set a medium-term target—You can go to the Bank of England Act of 1998. I said the government sets the inflation target and then the Bank of England operationalises the target.

So, Mr Speaker, along the line, if the Government is deviating from the inflation target, the Governor will write

to remind him of the target. So that is what the Governor will do. If, for instance, Hon Ato Forson sets a target of 11 per cent and the pursuit of fiscal policy is not geared towards achieving the 11 per cent, the Governor of the Bank of Ghana will remind him. Thank you.

5:13 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I would put the Question on the revised proposed amendment by Hon Kojo Oppong Nkrumah. So, the proposal is to delete, after target, the phrase ‘jointly with the Government’. So, the rendition would then be, “The bank shall determine the medium-term inflation targets”.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I want to propose a safe landing Clause, if Hon Haruna Iddrisu would lend me his ears. Because of what he said, that he does not have a problem with the phrase “joint determination” being taken off—*[Interruption]*—very well, if he did not say that, no problem.

Mr Speaker, I hold a view that, we can further look at the word ‘shall’ and rather use the word ‘may’. I think if the Minister for Finance—that is safer. So that we do not create a certain impression, if that is fine by him. The new rendition should read ‘The bank may determine the medium-term inflation target jointly with Government.’ If the word ‘may’ is used, I think we would be sending a certain positive signal out there. We have had all the debate; those who do not want to hear of Civil Society Organisations (CSOs)

being their masters are still here with us. But the CSOs are their masters, and they caused them to withdraw their Lithium Agreement.

Mr Speaker, we are dealing with a Central Bank Bill and Dr Ato Forson knows that when he comes here with something good, we would support him. So, let us deal with the word ‘may’ to protect Dr Forson.

Mr Speaker, he says he is unopposed.

Dr Forson: I will support the further amendment in view of the fact that, we are here to build consensus. But it should not be lost in us, that what we are proposing is to be in line with global practise. Countries have such provisions and we are only seeking to make sure that Ghana is in sync with what is being done as best practice.

Mr Speaker, again, Ghana is on an International Monetary Fund (IMF) Programme. The Bill cannot introduce fiscal dominance; it is rather the reverse. We are doing everything possible to make the Central Bank a better place for the development of our country. I so submit.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposal is that after the word ‘bank’, delete the word ‘shall’ and insert ‘may’. So, the new rendition should read; “The Bank may determine the medium-term inflation target jointly with Government.”

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 2 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, you are on your feet. Clause 3—

Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah: Mr Speaker, I want to ask of the Minister and the Chairperson to help us with something. Please indulge me. There was a problem with this Clause at the Committee meeting and they were supposed to look at it and get back to us. I am the Ranking Member and I do not have an answer yet. So, it would be good that as we are considering this, we get it. In the original Act 612, Section 5(1), it read;

“The authorised number of shares of the Bank shall be 700 billion shares of no-par value.”

The emphasis is on the phrase “of no-par value”. In this amendment, under Clause 3, it seeks to say that the principal enactment is amended by the insertion after Section 5. So, this becomes an addition; it is not a replacement of 5(a), the authorised capital of the bank is now GH¢1 billion. So, the question that we were asking is, do the two not run contradictory? If they say it is of no-par value and they have given a number and now they are given an amount of GH¢1 billion, do the two not run contrary? If so, why do we not just replace the 5 (1) with this new rendition, instead of adding it to it? They have not come back to us and they say there is no amendment and that is why I am raising it on the floor.

Thank you.

Dr Forson: Mr Speaker, what we seek to do is to make sure that the Central Bank has a minimum of GH¢1 billion as a minimum stated capital. Today, the Central Bank has a GH¢100,000 as their stated capital. The amendment is to give a minimum share capital. So, the drafters that we worked with, are the ones supposed to guide us in terms of how to situate it in law.

Mr Speaker, again, this GH¢1 billion is a conditionality in the previous one. But the phrase “of no-par value”, if I may consult with the drafters to see how the drafting was done. But the intention is to make sure the GH¢1 billion is there. But on the phrase “of no-par value”, I will do some consultation with the drafters, the Attorney General’s Department and I will revert.

Thank you.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I would want to yield to the respected Chair of the Committee. After his explanation, I can come in, if you do not mind.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, you have the floor.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Very well.

Mr Speaker, I think the point being made is very clear, that the principal enactment makes provision for the minimum shares to be held by the Bank of Ghana as its capital. Now, this proposed amendment, that seeks to insert

Section 5(a) and (b)— For the time being, we are dealing with Section 5(a), it says;

“That the principal enactment is amended by the insertion after Section 5(a), the authorised capital of the bank is GH¢1 billion.”

But in the principal enactment itself, there is an existing provision that talks about GH¢700 billion of no-par value. We are not seeking to amend that. So, it means that the two would co-exist. So, all we want to know is clarity on this. If this Bill is passed, then we are going to have two provisions.

One is saying that the minimum capital is GH¢1 billion and another is saying that they have a GH¢700 billion of no-par value capital. I want clarity and I would want to be very much educated, especially so, given the fact that the phrase that introduces these new two clauses does not talk about amendment. Unless their understanding is that once the language in section is introduced, it automatically amends the existing provision. But my little knowledge on lawmaking in this House tells me that once we use that language, it means that we are adding on to what is already there. We are not deleting, neither are we amending by way of deleting, but we are introducing a new provision to add on to the existing provision.

Mr Speaker, I think it is a fair point, that the Chairperson of the Committee, Hon Eric Afful, though the Clerk to the Committee added “Dr” to his title, that is a different matter on a different date. But

for now, let us deal with the substance of the matter and the Clerk should take note.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, we have heard from the sponsors of the Bill. The Minister indicated clearly that, in drafting, we use substitution and insertion.

5:23 p.m.

The word “substitution” in drafting has one meaning, and “in section” has another meaning. Now, in the rendition, they used the term “in section”, which means the old provision still stands; therefore, it will run parallel. But according to the Hon Minister, they intend to make the stated capital GHC1 billion, but not 700 billion shares. Therefore, we can refer this particular provision to the drafters to tidy it up. So, the issue for our consideration is whether or not the stated capital should be GHC1 billion, or it should remain 700 billion shares. If it is going to be GHC1 billion, we will put a question, and then refer it to the drafters to tidy it up for us.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, you are perfectly right, and I appreciate your guidance. But this is nothing controversial for us to refer to the draftsperson; we can deal with it. The word here is “insertion”. The right word to use is “substitution”. So, we can just amend the word “insertion” to “substitution”, then we are done with it. I do not think we should have any difficulty at all.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: If you use “substitution” again, you are going into the realm of running it in parallel. If you use “insertion”, then you are running parallel. So, the proper word is we substitute this for—

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, that is exactly what I am saying; let us do it by substituting, instead of saying that we are referring it to the draftsperson.

Mr Speaker, you get my point?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I do not understand why the Hon Minister is rather too busy on the report of the Chairman of the—*[Interruption]*—he is the Chairman, why should the Hon Minister be too busy.

Mr Speaker, the Chairperson should lead this Bill.

An Hon Member: It is not his matter.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: It is my matter.

Mr Speaker, with respect, the Chairperson of the Committee on Economy and Development must lead this Bill. The Hon Minister cannot be too busy on this matter. We know the practice in this Chamber. At the Consideration Stage, it is the Chair of the Committee who leads the discussion.

Mr Speaker, we should see the Hon Minister for Finance and the Chair of the Committee working together. It is a good call so that we can tidy up and do the needful. The Chair is sitting to my left, and the Hon Minister for Finance is sitting far away; they are not comparing notes. He has a report, and the other is here.

Mr Speaker, the practice is that at the Consideration Stage—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, are we going to argue this? Let me place on record that as a Ranking Member in the Eighth Parliament for Constitutional, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs, I was moving an amendment from this Side, and then the Hon Minister will be on the other Side. So, the issue as to whether the Chairman of the Committee and the Hon Minister should sit closely and compare notes will also be a subject matter of debate?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, new king, new law. Now, you are sitting in the Chair.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I do not intend to depart from the previous position.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, you know it. The Hon Minority Leader, Hon Haruna Iddrisu, as he then was, knows that at the Consideration Stage, it is either the Ranking or the Chair who will lead discussions. All I am saying is that the principals of Government Business must be seen to be working together. The Chair of the Committee is

sitting elsewhere, and the Hon Minister for Finance is sitting elsewhere; they are working across papers. The two of them should work together. Then, whenever we ask critical questions, instead of the Chairman leading the discussion, he is far away. So far, the Chairman has been loudly silent, and the Hon Minister is more or less trying to dictate the pace of the Committee, which is not right.

Mr Speaker, this is a House of rules, practise and procedure.

So, the Hon Minister for Finance should take it easy, and when we are done with everything, then he can come in. But he should not take away the powers of the Chairman.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Dr Forson: Mr Speaker, I had earlier indicated that there is a need for us to consult the Drafters and to make sure that we do not get it wrong.

Mr Speaker, I have asked the Central Bank and the AGs department to confer and revert. So, while we go through the other clauses, I suggest that we stand this down and then continue.

Mr Speaker, it is also important for me to give further information. While on the Floor and discussing the inflation targeting, I asked the office to send me the data. In Australia, inflation is set by the government and the Central Bank. In Brazil, the inflation target is set by the government alone. In Canada, the government and the Central Bank set the

inflation target while in Colombia it is only the Central Bank. In Chile, it is only the Central Bank. In the Czech Republic, it is the government and the Central Bank. In Hungary, it is the government and the Central Bank. In Iceland, it is only the government. In Israel, it is only the government. In Mexico, the inflation target is set by the Central Bank. For New Zealand, the inflation target is set by the government and the Central Bank. In Norway and Peru, the inflation is set by the Central Bank. In the Philippines, inflation is set by the Central Bank. In the United Kingdom (UK) and the Philippines, inflation is set by the Central Bank. I just want to put it on record for our use, so that tomorrow we can refer to it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, it is on record, but we have dealt with that particular clause.

Hon Members, if we look at clause 5 very well, clause 5, which clause 3 seeks to amend, in the original rendition, that is Act 612, has the provision in clause 5(1) and clause 5(2). So, if there is going to be an insertion, it is not the whole of clause 5, but it is clause 5(1). So, the correct proposition here should be that “the principal enactment is amended by the substitution of section 5(1). Then the new rendition would come. If this is agreeable, we can put a question on it and then further refer it to the Drafters to tidy it up for us.

Mr Nkrumah: That is so, Mr Speaker, except that the Hon Minister will need to let us understand what his consultation has led to because it was a

query that I made. I did not exactly make an amendment, so he now needs to let us understand what his consultation has led to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr Oppong Nkrumah, I think I share your view, and if you look at it, you would realise that for section 5(1), the “(1)” is omitted, and instead of “substitution”, “insertion” has been used. So, while the error is identified, we can make progress and then urge the Draft person to put it together for us. On this note, if the House is agreeable, then we put a question.

Yes, Mr Boamah?

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister in this proposal is asking the Central Bank to keep a minimum authorised capital of GHC1 billion. I believe with time, this minimum capital of 1 billion, as we are doing the amendments today, may be low again for the Central Bank to keep. So, I want to find out what the steps are, and I am also looking at ways in which this amendment, the change in the minimum capital at the Central Bank, does not keep changing within the shortest possible time.

So that is my question for the Minister.

5:33 p.m.

Dr Forson: Mr Speaker, for the record, today the Central Bank’s minimum capital is GHC10 million. We are moving it from GHC10 million to GHC1 billion. The intention is that, from

now to 2034, the Government will first clear the GH¢55 billion negative equity owed by the Central Bank, and then capitalise it adequately by GH¢1 billion.

Mr Speaker, when we do that, it will be the first step. I believe in the future, another legislation can up the minimum stated capital from, say, GH¢1 billion to, say, GH¢10 billion. The GH¢10 million was set many years ago. Today, obviously, it is of no value or very little value. Ten million then may have been a very big thing. But gradually, we want to move it to GH¢1 billion and, in the future, take steps to capitalise it properly. But it is very ambitious considering the hole they already dug. Without the hole, we could have gone to, let us say, GH¢20 billion. But they dug a bigger hole, and we need to use taxpayer money to seal it before we move on to another GH¢1 billion. It will take some time, and I think that we should ensure that it is done.

Mr Speaker, when the decision is made to use taxpayers' money to capitalise the bank, Parliament will have to appropriate the funds and bring them to Parliament for approval. Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, taking a second look at this particular provision, we realise that the clauses 5(1) and (2) deals with authorised shares and then the intersection here deals with authorised capital. There is a difference between authorised capital and authorised shares. That is why they are saying the share should have no par value. So I think it is

proper that it should be insertion, but not substitution.

Hon Oppong Nkrumah, you would realise that the clause 5(1) deals with authorised shares, which are 700, and they are not seeking to amend. And clause 5(2) says that the shares are not transferable. But the new intersection that they are bringing talks about authorised capital to be 1 billion. So, it is really an insertion but not a substitution.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I support your view. And what probably the Committee Chairperson could do to support this consideration of the matter is to state that we are not shifting from share quantity to capital. That is why I agree with you that we are inserting to have authorised capital. It is never the same thing as shares at par value. The two are not the same. We should not confuse the two. We just needed an explanation that there is no nominal value per share in the original provisions under 5(1) and 5(2).

And now he wants authorised capital, specifically one billion, to correct a certain imbalance. But we should not treat it as if we are deleting clauses 5(1) and (2). So, I share your position, Mr Speaker. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee.

Mr Afful: Mr Speaker, we need to make the two so that we can correct things here. So, when we say a share of no-par value, it means that the price cannot be determined. We determine the

price through the price mechanism, demand and supply. We will not have the right value. But here, we want to bring in a stated capital, which is quantifiable. I think we need to bring in the two and make progress. Thank you.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I want to propose an amendment to clause 5(a) if it will not hurt the Minister. I propose the insertion of “minimum” after “the” so that the new rendition will be “the minimum authorised capital of the bank is one billion cedis.” Because if it is his intention to raise it in future up to GHC10 billion, then we can just insert the “minimum” after “the” so that it can be able to cure his intention for the future. So, the new rendition will be “the minimum authorised capital of the bank is one billion cedis”

I so move, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minister, this is the proposal.

Dr Forson: Mr Speaker, I support the amendment.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Members, with this background explanation in view of the fact that the proper terminology should be in the section after clause 5.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 3 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 4 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 5— Section 8 of Act 612 amended

Mr Afful: Mr Speaker, there was an advertised amendment. *Delete* the entire clause.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposal is to *delete* the entire Clause 5. It is for the consideration of the House.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I would want to know from the Chairperson of the Committee why he is asking for the entire deletion of clause 5. I am asking that because if we look at the Governing Board of the Bank of Ghana, we have the Governor chairing with first and second Deputy Governors appointed, a representative from the Ministry of Finance, not below the rank of a director, and nine other members including a chartered accountant, appointed by the President in accordance with Article 70 of the Constitution. I find it consistent with the provision. Could the Chairperson explain why he wants the entire deletion?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr Afful: Mr Speaker, the Committee is of the view that the voting right of the director was part of an effort to ensure accountability of the institution, but does not affect the autonomy of the Bank.

5:43 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You see, Hon Members, if you look, Act 918, which earlier amended Act 612 of 2002, it has the same provision as it is in the clause 1 proposed here. The only difference is that the new amendment is seeking to take the voting right, and the Committee is of the view that the voting right was there, and it did not cause any problem. So, if it is not broken, why are we trying to fix it? Because of that, they want the old law as it is to stand. That is the reason for which clause 5 of the Bill is being deleted.

Yes, Hon Habib?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the paragraph (c) that is on section 8 (5)(c) has to do with one representative of the Ministry responsible for Finance, not below the rank of Director, who shall not vote at the meeting of the Board. Mr Speaker, is that the only reason why the Chairman is proposing that the entire Clause should be deleted? This will cure a lot. Many a time, the Minister for Finance, who was once a member of the Board, will now be serving as a referee and a match commissioner at the same time if allowed to have that authority when represented in the Board. Many a time, when you check those above the rank or below the rank of a Director, normally it is either the Deputy Minister or the Minister of State who normally sits in that Board. If I can just trace back about 12 years ago, the last four years, when the NDC was in government, he was the one there. When the NPP was in government, Hon Charles Adu Boahen

was there, then Abena Osei Asare, Dr Mohammed Amin Adams and then the rest. I do not think that it is going to be a serious problem by saying that that person shall not have the right to vote. It is intended to cure something. They cannot be a referee and a match commissioner at the same time. No, they cannot. If that is the reason the Chairman is proposing that we should delete the entire clause, I strongly think that we should not delete it. We should rather leave it there. It would strengthen the institution, and it would bring objectivity to things that they are doing. Yes, the Ministry is represented. It has a supervisory order.

We are talking about it independence of the Bank. But if a representative of the Ministry is going to sit there and take decisions for them, vote *et cetera*, then where is the independence of the Bank of Ghana? So, I think that we should allow this to stand and the Ministry should continue to appoint somebody who should be there. But the person must not have the right to vote. So, I do not think that we should completely delete this if that is the only reason proposed that it should be deleted. It should be there. But the person must not have the right to vote.

When you listen to the Minister for Finance, many of the First Scheduled proposed amendments that we were talking about, including the inflation part, the Ministry has a supervisory oversight over the Bank. So, if they are seated in the Bank's board meeting, not just like any other person like Hon Adongo who has been appointed there— He is not a representative of the Ministry.

The Minister for Finance wants to control a lot of things and that would be the problem he would have. What he should know is that he should not just be of the view that he should sit in the Bank and still have the right to vote in the Bank. He cannot be a referee and be a match commissioner at the same time. So, we should allow this to happen and maybe subject it to voting.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon First Deputy Minority Whip, if you have Act 918, page 3, “the governing body of the Bank is the Board of Directors consisting of...” you will realise that everything in the Act 918 is the same as the proposal in the new Bill. The only exception in relation to which they are repeating everything was the fact that the new Bill is saying “who shall not vote at the meeting of the Board.” Therefore, if “who shall not vote at the meeting of the Board” is deleted as the Committee is proposing, then the rendition stands. So, why then are we going to amend this particular provision? That is why the Committee is proposing that this particular proposed amendment should be abandoned so that the old law that the Bank of Ghana is working with would stand. That is the reason for the deletion.

Yes, Hon Habib?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, can the Minister for Finance speak to this issue?

Dr Forson: I submitted the Bill, and the content of the Bill was signed by me to the House. When I submit a Bill to the

House, it is for the House to take a decision on the matter. I explained that in Act 612, we took away the Ministry of Finance’s power from the Monetary Policy Committee. I was a Deputy Minister at the time. I was also a Board member at the time. I stayed on the Board, I built capacity, and understood how the Central Bank works. I was there to coordinate and also understand how public funds are being used. The function of the Central Bank’s Board is not monetary policy. It is the operation of the Bank, so it has nothing to do with the functions of the Central Bank. It has to do with the operations of the Bank; how they spend the resources of the Bank. At the Board, for example, if the Central Bank was spending huge sums of money to build a head office, it was my responsibility at the time to coordinate with my Minister and give the information to the Minister for action.

5:53 p.m.

Mr Speaker, that was the essence of putting a Deputy Minister for Finance on the Board and the Deputy Minister has always been there from the inception of the Central Bank. The decision now is to further limit the powers of the Deputy Minister who is on the board, so that he will just be there as an observer and eventually report. When we went to the Committee, the Committee’s position was that the amount of money being spent by the Central Bank has to do with public funds. For example, in the case of today, where the Central Bank is in negative equities, the same Ministry of Finance will have to look for money and capitalise the Bank.

So, if the person is on the Board and cannot partake in the decision-making that may result in losses, then why is the person there in the first place? But Mr Speaker, I made my case, as presented in the Bill, that it is for the House to take the decision, and I cannot argue against the position of the Committee. I did it at the Committee level but what is before the House is the Committee's position but my Bill says it as it is. So, Mr Speaker it is for the House to take the decision on the matter.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, if the Board is made up of 12 members, how would the vote of one person undermine the authority of all others?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, listening to the Minister for Finance, one thing was clear. He said it is further going to reduce the powers of the Deputy Minister, who will be on the Board; that was his argument. He also asked that how the representative of the Ministry serve on the Board but does not have the right to vote. My argument here is about the independence of the Bank. By the argument the Minister is making, independence is control of the Bank, and that the Deputy Minister must sit there and also take a decision.

In any case it is not always Deputy Ministers because during our time, Mr Adu-Boahen was there. When Hon Abena Osei-Asare become Minister of State he was at BoG representing the Ministry. It is not always a Deputy Minister; it could be a Minister of State. In our case it has happened that a

Minister of State served on the Board. Hon Osei-Asare, when made a Minister of State —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let us look at it this way. The Governor and the Deputy Governors who are part of the management of the bank has a right to vote, but the one representative should not have a right to vote? Why?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I want to abandon my proposed amendment, so it should stand.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 5 *deleted*.

Clause 6 – Section 10 of Act 612 amended.

Mr Afful: Clause 6 – amendment proposed – *delete* the clause. Mr Speaker, the reason is we want the Members of Parliament to be on the board with other Government appointee.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, clause 6 talks about the tenure of the members of the Board but the Chairman was speaking to the Members of Parliament not holding Government positions which is supposed to be clause 7. So, if the Chairman of the Committee —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I think I will have to come in and help.

The essence of clause 6 is to increase the tenure of office from four years to

five years. At the Committee's deliberation, the Committee is of the view that by the law cited today by Osahen Alexander Afenyo-Markin, the tenure of office should be coterminous to that of the appointor. Therefore, the proposal to make the tenure of office five years should be deleted. So, the old law gives the tenure of office to be four years. So, by the deletion of this provision, the tenure of office stands at four years; that is the essence of the proposal to delete. So, it is no longer going to be five years but it will be four years.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, that is so clear. But for the record, when you called the Chairman, he did not speak, I wanted to draw your attention to the Chairman.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, this is the issue. If the House is agreeable, then I will put the question.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: So, can the Chairman make the decision?

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 6 deleted.

Clause 7 — Section 11A of Act 612 amended.

Mr Afful: Clause 7 — amendment proposed — Section 11(a) of Act 612 amended. Delete the clause.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I do not have anything to say on clause 7 except to tell you that we are winding

out. We are tired. So, when we finish this, let us suspend Consideration Stage and do another thing, so that tomorrow we can continue.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 7 deleted.

Clause 8 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the mood of the House. We have done up to eight clauses. Let us suspend the Consideration Stage, then we can look at it. This is a very important Bill; we should not rush it. Let us suspend Consideration Stage then we can come back to it.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, earlier I engaged the Minister for Finance and it appears that he himself is doing further consultation on a number of clauses for policy reasons.

Mr Speaker, I support the call by the First Deputy Minority Whip that we suspend consideration and then come back, you know, tomorrow. We must not be seen to be rushing this Bill. I have engaged my respected Colleague opposite me, and the leadership of the Majority Side must see to it. I think we need to even do some winnowing to look at certain clauses and come back and continue, especially when the Minister for Finance himself admits that he needs to do some further consultation on this matter.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, with due respect, can we come halfway?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: No, we have agreed. Mr Speaker, there is an agreement to suspend.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, there is no difficulty from this Side. I will plead with the Minority Leader that we will suspend the amendment then we will go to Motion numbered 7. After that we can call for a close of the day. So, Mr Speaker, we will bring Consideration Stage to an end and then we will take the item numbered 7 on the *Order Paper Addendum*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The consideration of Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025 is temporarily brought to an end. Motion numbered seven on the Order Paper Addendum. Let us take Motion numbered 6 first. Minister for Education?

MOTION

Suspension of Standing Order 104(1)

Minister for Education (Mr Haruna Iddrisu) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a Motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the Motion is given, the Motion for the Second Reading of the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025 may be moved today.

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Peter Kwasi Nortsu-Kotoe): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

6:03 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, this is the *Order Paper*. The Hon Minister said page 4 of today's *Order Paper*, Motion 6, the *Order Paper* does not have the said advertised Motion. If he is referring to the *Addendum* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, mention the subject matter, and in mentioning the subject matter, I made reference to Motion 7 and later corrected it to Motion 6. That was the Motion moved.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, it is not about you at all. It is about him quoting the right Motion for the record. Mr Speaker, as for you, you are right, but what you said and what he has said are two different things. If Mr Speaker says *Order Paper Addendum*, then he gets up to say *Order Paper*. Mr Speaker, I have the *Order Paper Addendum* here, and I have the *Order Paper*. So, I want him to correct himself.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, I have mentioned Motion 6, and Motion 6 is on the *Order Paper Addendum*. The page that was mentioned, page 4 of the *Order Paper Addendum*, contains the Motion, and the Motion that was moved was the right Motion.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, once again, certificate of urgency, please, let me read the Motion:

“That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a Motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the Motion is given, the Motion for the Second Reading of the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025 may be *moved* today.”

Is that not what they are doing? Mr Speaker, they are praying this House to waive the mandatory notice required for two days. That is what they are doing. So again, is that not a certificate of urgency? Is that not what they are doing? **[Some Hon Members: No.]**

Mr Speaker, certificate of urgency in context. What they are doing now is to say that they do not want this Bill to be properly processed by Members. They have just introduced a Bill, and they want it to be taken today as an urgent matter when Members, after receiving the Report, would have to go through, and if they have any proposed amendments or anything to say on the subject matter, be it the memorandum accompanying the Bill, they would make informed decisions. But if, once again, they come to the House, then they introduce a certificate of urgency, and let us waive

the rules, and allow this to pass. Mr Speaker, what is the urgency? Why do they not want the Bill to go through a normal process? Has KNUST come to a standstill? Is there any matter in particular affecting teaching and learning at KNUST that they think, in their view, Parliament must rush this Bill?

Mr Speaker, I am concerned, and I will raise it over and over again. It is becoming one too many that Members of Parliament are not allowed to discharge their duties *bona fide*. It is becoming one too many. Almost every policy of State, almost every Bill, comes here, and they say, certificate of urgency, and waive the rules. That is why, a moment ago, I raised the issue of the Lithium Agreement. It came to this House. The Minority called for further consultation. The Minister justified why they have to take their contract agreement in the form and shape it was. Then, after the CSOs started their criticism, he rushed into this Chamber to withdraw, and now, going through the same consultations, we propose. What kind of legislature do we want to be remembered for?

6:13 p.m.

Mr Speaker, if it were to be any other democratic system, the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources would have been asked to resign for doing that. This is because it amounts to a policy failure. He introduces a policy; the Minority tells them to do the right thing. They say no, they go in circles, come back, and withdraw. They are now engaged in consultation.

In any serious democracy, the Minister would have been asked to resign because he misled Cabinet. This is because that paper went to Cabinet, and he came here with Cabinet's approval. So why, after one month, are they withdrawing? So, Colleagues, it is not a matter of trying to stop them; we cannot stop them, because they have the numbers. But please, listen, and stop this rash work. The public out there is concerned about the way the Majority rushes things through this Parliament. And we will not shut our mouths.

We will not be quiet. They bring bills and policies and want to rush Parliament. They cannot even read it. They do not have to read it. Within 24 hours, they move a Motion; *Order Paper Addendum*, *Order Paper Addendum*, why, Mr Speaker?

Their masters are the CSOs; they will go and face them. If they will not respect us, they will put them to order. The CSOs are waiting for them out there. If they will not listen, they have their whip and they will crack it and the Majority will rush and come here shamefully. We are watching.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I will give you the floor but before you come in to speak—Hon Members, order! Hon Members, let us make reference to our Standing Orders and to inform the general public that our rules make provision for withdrawal of Statements, that is Order 95; the Standing Orders makes provision for withdrawal of Papers laid, that is Order

98; and Order 106 makes provision for the withdrawal of a Motion.

So, Hon Members, if a process comes before us and the procedure is laid down for which reason that particular process should be withdrawn when we are considering a bill, I think our discussion should be limited to the Bill and the reference. Few minutes ago, I asked a rhetorical question, which was, under what circumstances do you move a Procedural Motion? If you are considering a matter under a Certificate of Urgency based on Article 106 (13), what do you waive? Is it the Orders of this House that you waive? No. What the Constitution says should be done, is what is waived when you are considering a matter under a Certificate of Urgency. So, to move a Procedural Motion cannot be equated to a constitutional waiver. Hon Members, we owe it as a duty to say the right thing to the general public.

Yes, Hon Minister for Education, let me from hear you.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, do I proceed to move the Motion since you have adequately responded to the Hon Minority Leader? Suffice it to add that this is not one of the Bill that is in his words—The Bill was gazetted 23rd October, 2025. I laid it before this House on 7th November and, therefore, there has been enough publicity to the public and to the academic community to follow through.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, do.

BILL—SECOND READING

Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025

Minister for Education (Mr Haruna Iddrisu) (MP): Mr Speaker, having said that, I beg to *move*:

That the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025 be read a Second time.

Mr Speaker, the object of the Bill is to establish the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi. As you may recall, the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology is one of Ghana's foremost public universities, which has a niche in the provision of science and technology education. It currently has a student population of 80,000 Ghanaian students, and it is important that I put it in context.

The University was established in 1962. If you want to follow the historical antecedents, there was a Kumasi College of Technology, which opened officially on 22nd January, 1952. Subsequently, it was named and established in 1961. It has operated largely on Act 80. It was named after Dr Kwame Nkrumah, the first President and Prime Minister of Ghana. It is based in Kumasi in the Ashanti Region. It is important that I emphasise that the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology has one significant feature which is that Otumfuo Osei Tutu, the Asantehene, plays an extraordinary role as the

Chancellor of the University. It has a number of colleges in humanities and social sciences. But the emphasis is that they are to focus more on the delivery of science and technology education in Ghana.

So, Mr Speaker, with the revision of Act 80, which was subsequently amended in 1998, we are doing so in order that we would expand access to higher education, which is enshrined in the Constitution as a right subject to the availability of resources, and also to ensure that we improve the governance architecture of the University. In the past, it had the Head of State, the Commander-in-Chief, or the President of the Republic as Chancellor. Now, in respect of Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Otumfuo Osei Tutu, the Asantehene, takes up that role and has lived above that task. He demonstrates personal interest in supporting the institution and ensuring that it lives up to the standard.

So, Mr Speaker, I beg to move that the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025, be now read as a revision of what was established in 1961, subsequently amended in 1998, following its establishment in 1962.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: May I call on the Chairperson of the Committee on Education to present the Report of the Committee.

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Peter Nortsu-Kotoe): Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, before I present the Report, I want to make a correction. On page 10, if you go to item numbered 5, clause 6, the second provision, instead of the University of Ghana, it should be the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology in the three lines.

Mr Speaker, I pray that the *Hansard* captures the whole Report as having been read as I take a few of the salient points in the Report.

Introduction

The Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025 was laid before Parliament on Friday, 7th November, 2025 by the Hon Minister for Education, Mr Haruna Iddrisu, in accordance with Article 106(1) of the Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992 and Order 159(3) of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Pursuant to Article 106(4) of the 1992 Constitution and the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Speaker subsequently referred the Bill to the Committee on Education for consideration and report.

Deliberations

The Committee met with the Hon Minister for Education and Officials of the Ministry of Education on Monday, 15th December, 2025 to consider the Bill. In attendance were the Vice Chancellor of the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Prof. (Mrs) Rita Akosua Dickson, the Chairperson of

Council, Akyamfour Asafo Boakye Agyemang-Bonsu, and officials of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice.

The Committee expresses its profound gratitude to the leadership of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs, the Hon Minister for Education and Officials for attending upon the Committee and providing clarification to issues raised at the meeting.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents during the deliberations:

- i. The Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992;
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament, 2024;
- iii. Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology Act, 1961 (Act 80);
- iv. Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (Amendment) Act, 1998 (Act 559);
- v. The Education Regulatory Bodies Act, 2020 (Act 1023);
- vi. The Education Strategic Plan (ESP 2018-2030), 2018; and
- vii. The Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921).

Background

The Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST), Kumasi, traces its origin to 1952 when it was established as the Kumasi College of Technology. The College was initially affiliated with the University of London and commenced operations with a student population of 200, the majority of whom were transferred from Achimota College. In 1962, the institution attained full university status following the enactment of the University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Act, 1961 (Act 80). This status was subsequently revised by the University of Science and Technology, Kumasi (Amendment) Act, 1998 (Act 559), which renamed the institution, the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology.

The contribution of the Ashanti Kingdom, particularly in providing land for the establishment of the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, is of paramount significance and cannot be overstated.

Over the decades, KNUST has undergone significant transformation in its institutional structure, academic programmes, and student population. From its modest beginnings, the University has expanded to serve approximately eighty-one thousand, two hundred and seventy-one (81,271) students, with a corresponding growth in colleges, departments, and academic offerings. These developments have exceeded the scope of the governance framework established under Act 80,

thereby necessitating a comprehensive review to align the University's legal and administrative structures with contemporary higher education standards

Furthermore, the evolving global and technology-driven nature of higher education, together with the constitutional imperative to ensure equitable access to tertiary education, underscores the need for a revised legal regime. Such a framework must promote efficiency, accountability, transparency, and effective management within the University. As KNUST positions itself to train graduates equipped for the 21st Century and to respond to rapid technological advancements, it is imperative that its establishing legislation reflects present realities and future aspirations.

This Bill therefore seeks to update and modernise the existing legal framework to strengthen the governance structure of the University and to ensure the coherent regulation of its functions for improved service delivery.

Purpose of the Bill

The Bill seeks to repeal and re-enact the existing legal framework governing the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST) under Act 559, in order to modernise the University's governance and operational structures. The proposed reforms are intended to reflect contemporary trends in higher education, respond to the significant growth and evolving needs of the University, promote effective, accountable, and transparent manage-

ment, and support equitable access to quality tertiary education.

Summary of Provisions of the Bill

Clauses 1 to 5 provide for the establishment of the University including its campuses, degrees and membership.

Clauses 6 to 13 of the Bill establish the governance structure of the University including the University Council, its functions, powers, tenure of office and establishment of committees and related matters.

Matters relating to the administration and internal organisation of the University and its principal officers are covered under Clauses 14 to 26 of the Bill.

Financial provisions including sources of funds, borrowing powers, tax exemptions and accounting and auditing procedures are provided for in Clauses 27 to 32.

Clauses 33 to 46 deal with miscellaneous provisions, including the statutes of the University, convocation, matriculation, intellectual property and academic freedom.

Clauses 45 and 46 deal with repeals and savings and transitional provisions respectively.

Observations

The observations below reflect the Committee's review of the Bill, taking

into account its deliberations and the inputs received from stakeholders.

Mandate Shift from Science and Technology

The increasing proportion of student admissions in the humanities and social sciences poses a potential risk to the University's core mandate as a science and technology-focused institution. While acknowledging the multidisciplinary nature of modern universities, it is considered inappropriate to impose overly restrictive legislative provisions.

The Bill should therefore clearly affirm science and technology as the University's principal area of focus, while permitting the provision of other academic programmes. This mandate is best protected through clear policy guidance rather than rigid statutory limitations.

In addition, increased Government subventions are essential to enable the University to effectively fulfil its mandate, particularly given the high cost of science-based programmes. Financial constraints have contributed to the expansion of fee-paying and non-science offerings. Accordingly, the explicit clarification of the University's science and technology focus within the aims and objects of the Bill is justified and necessary.

Fee-Paying Students and Access to Higher Education

The Committee observed that the increasing proportion of fee-paying

students poses challenges to equitable access to tertiary education, particularly for students from less endowed backgrounds, as guaranteed under Article 38 of the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana.

This trend has been influenced by the high cost of science-based programmes and constraints in public funding.

The Committee further noted that provisions limiting the proportion of fee-paying students, subject to the approval of the Ghana Tertiary Education Commission in consultation with the Hon Minister, are appropriate and should be retained. Effective enforcement of institutional mandates must be supported by corresponding increases in Government funding.

In addition, the Committee underscored the need to strengthen scholarship and student support schemes for qualified but needy applicants, and considered that broader policy issues relating to fee-paying admissions are best addressed at the sectoral level rather than solely through the provisions of this Bill.

Access to University Precincts and the Public Character of the Institution

A provision seeking to restrict access to the University premises exclusively to members, raises concerns about consistency with the public character and national role of the University. Such a restriction would unduly exclude surrounding communities, stakeholders, and public officials who have legitimate interactions with the institution.

The Committee was of the view that access to the University premises should remain sufficiently open to reflect the University's responsibility to engage with and serve the wider community, and that any limitations on access should be reasonable and consistent with this public mandate.

Aims and Objects of the University

The Committee reviewed the University's aims and objects, identifying areas for improvement. They proposed revisions to emphasise science and technology, align the African focus with global relevance, clarify provisions on world affairs and emerging technologies, and refine ambiguous wording, aiming to enhance clarity and alignment with comparable university legislation.

The Committee proposes maintaining the existing structure, with improvements to drafting clarity and alignment with comparable university legislation.

Campuses and Future Expansion

The Committee was informed about ongoing discussions on campus expansion plans, including the establishment of new campuses such as Obuasi and potential restructuring of existing ones. It was further noted that specifying particular campuses in the Act could limit flexibility and lead to frequent amendments.

The Committee therefore proposes a general provision that empowers the

University Council, with the approval of the Ghana Tertiary Education Commission, to establish campuses, thereby providing sufficient flexibility to meet the University's growth and development needs.

Proposed Amendments

The Committee proposed the attached amendments during its deliberations.

Conclusion

The re-defining of tertiary education to meet contemporary needs, the creation of a more efficient and effective university governance structure, and the institution of robust measures are critical to the University's growth and development.

The Bill responds to the University's significant growth and transformation, aligns its governance and administrative structures with global higher education standards, and strengthens its capacity to deliver quality, technology-driven teaching, research, and innovation.

This Bill to repeal and re-enact the legal framework establishing the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology is both necessary and timely.

The Committee therefore recommends that the House adopt this Report and pass the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025, in accordance with Article 106(1) of the 1992 Constitution.

Respectfully submitted.

Question proposed.

6:23 p.m.

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (NPP — Old Tafo): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to the Report of the Committee on Education with respect to the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025.

Mr Speaker, yesterday, I joined the Committee to have a perusal of the Bill. There is one important thing that I want to bring to the fore. Let me take you to Article 38(3) (a) of the 1992 Constitution which guarantees equal access that will have to be given in terms of university education.

Today, if one goes to the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, one would realise that 25 per cent of admissions is given to fee-paying students. The question that I ask myself is, as representatives of the people, how are we protecting ordinary students who cannot pay this amount of money? For a university to, as it were, give 25 per cent of its quota to fee-paying students is unacceptable, and I want to see how this Bill is going to cure this. When we speak to the school authorities, they tell us that because the school needs money to run the institution, it is on that basis that they give a 25 per cent quota to fee-paying students. This cannot be acceptable and I hope that the Committee will find a way to deal with it and maybe incorporate that in the Bill.

Mr Speaker, with respect to emphasis as to what the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology was actually established for, today, if one goes to KNUST, emphasis is not really on science and technology. In fact, emphasis is on the humanities more than science and technology. This is a troubling issue. I believe that the Minister and the Committee will find a way to deal with this matter because it cannot be that an institution will be established for the purposes of science and technology, and more emphasis is given to, as it were, the humanities.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, let me thank you for the opportunity to contribute to the Report.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Prof Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko (NPP — Kwadaso): Mr Speaker, thank you for giving me the space to speak to the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025.

Mr Speaker, at the Committee meeting yesterday and also going through the Report, I have made a few observations that caught my attention. The first one has to do with mandate shifts, which is also referred to as mandate creep or mission creep, that is, an institution shifting from its core mandate. It is true that Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology and other similar universities are shifting, but in this global age and space, it is difficult to restrict institutions at that level to operate within a certain milieu.

All we have to do is help them identify niches where they have strength. We can resource them so they can exercise control over that area.

For example, the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology cannot be asked not to run programmes in the arts and humanities. We need to strengthen their core mandate and niche areas. Anybody in the world, for example, who will want to come to KNUST must do so because of the strength in that area. That has been my position, and I am happy that the Committee came to that conclusion.

Mr Speaker, the fee-paying is worrying because of the effects of denying access to children from families that are not well-to-do. How do we deal with this matter? I do not think that universities will want this to happen. It is also because of budget subvention from the Government. Our Government does not have the financial envelope huge enough to deal with universities in terms of providing their resources, their monetary incentives, compensation and all that. I used to be a lecturer, and lecturers also want to live well, but they are limited in terms of how much they earn. So if the Government is able to expand its allocation to the universities, I am convinced that we will see a reduction in the focus on the restriction regarding fee-paying. I think that the Minister should have a way of dealing with that.

Again, one issue also deals with access to the university precincts. There was a restriction in the Act and a

consideration where access is denied to the public in having some form of activities on campus. I am happy that that restriction has been removed. I will advise KNUST to follow the example of the University of Ghana, where, when Prof Ernest Aryeetey was Vice-Chancellor, the university implemented access point restriction. If one wants to enter the University of Ghana, one needs to pay before one can enter. That is also a channel of raising resources for the university. I have not seen that at KNUST. If they can also do that, they can generate some money to carry out their roles and do other activities.

We also saw other aims and objectives, and I am happy that this Act is under consideration. The first aim of the university was to provide higher education. It was so broad and nebulous. We encouraged them to tweak that to include, for example, more emphasis on science and technology education. I am sure that if these observations are dealt with, they will inure to the benefit of the university. Ghanaian students will find pleasure and commitment to access education at KNUST which sits in the heart of Kumasi where the Supreme King, Otumfuo, lords over.

On that score, I want to thank the Committee and support the continual work on this Bill to become an Act to the benefit of Ghana's education. Thank you for the opportunity. I am grateful.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I will give the floor to Hon Dominic Napare.

Mr Dominic Napare (NDC — Sene East): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to the Motion on the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025.

Mr Speaker, the need for a comprehensive review of the Bill for this university has been long overdue. This is so because, looking at the time the university was established, as espoused by the Minister, the University's Act, Act 80, which was reviewed the last time in 1998, since then, a lot has happened in the university to the effect that there is a need for a review of the legal regime of the university to enable it to execute its mandate as a university.

Mr Speaker, it is even so important given the evolving global dynamics; the university needs to move with the times. With the evolving global and technology-driven nature of higher education today, it is important that the legal regime is revised to move with the changing trends.

6:33 p.m.

Mr Speaker, the Committee also noted during its deliberation that the University is now deviating from its core mandate of providing science and technology-based education. During the discussion, the University authorities' attention was drawn to the fact that even though they would want to expand the scope to include the Humanities, it is important that they actually respect the core mandate for which the university was established. One main response that

came out was that it is for the sake of getting resources to run the universities. That is why they are straying into other areas apart from their core mandate. But, it was noted that in spite of the fact that they need the resources to run the universities, it is also important that they respect the core mandate, particularly because the modern trend of development generally is technological-based. For this reason, as a country, if we deviate from the provision of a higher education in terms of science and technology, then we will be doing Ghana a disservice because that is where the world is moving to. So, Mr Speaker, it is important that the university focus on their core mandate rather than drastically deviating from their core mandate. It was noted that it was not only the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, all other State universities are deviating from their core mandate. It is important that this Parliament draws their attention to the fact that they need to respect the core mandate.

Mr Speaker, another thing the Committee noted was that, as a Colleague mentioned, the proportion of the fee-paying students they admit these days is almost equal to those who enjoy the normal fees that they pay. It also came out that it is also as a result of the same reason for wanting to expand their resource base to be able to manage the universities. The Committee came out with the proposal that Governments should make sure that they provide adequate incentives and facilities at the universities so that they will not be drifting toward attempting to be asking students to pay higher fees for

admission. It was even noted that those who are admitted by fee-paying, most often than not, their grade point of entry is normally reduced. They rather tighten the poor ones who are to have access and have free education, they rather tend to focus on fee-paying and rather admit more of them, depriving the poor ones and the marginalised ones from having access to the university education.

Mr Speaker, the University was urged to rather respect the general admission protocols rather than over-emphasising on the fee-paying process. On this note, we will urge the House to approve the Report so that the revised legal regime of the University be taken, and they can actually implement the core mandate of the University. Thank you very much for the opportunity, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr Francis-Xavier Sosu, you have the floor.

Mr Francis-Xavier Kojo Sosu (NDC — Madina): I also rise to support the Motion that the Bill be read a Second time. I rise to make this very brief point when it comes to paragraph 5 of the Report. The Report said that the Bill seeks to repeal and re-enact the existing legal framework governing the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology under Act 559. It is needful for us to realise that at the time this university was first established, my research shows that it had a little bit over 4,000 students. As we speak today, the student population of that school is over 85,000. Obviously, things have evolved, and it is so important that we reform our

laws to meet contemporary directions. That is why, Mr Speaker, I rise to support this Motion that we adopt this Report for the Second reading of the Bill. Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leadership. Hon Minority Leader?

Minority Leader (Osahen Alexander Kwamina Afenyo-Markin): Mr Speaker, I am very happy to have been here today to deal with this matter which is so dear to my heart, our universities and corporate social responsibility. Let me root my argument on a very profound statement by the Committee itself. The conclusion of the Committee's Report says, and with your permission, I beg to quote:

“The Bill responds to the University's significant growth and transformation, aligns its governance and administrative structures with global higher education standards, and strengthens its capacity to deliver quality, technology-driven teaching, research, and innovation.”

Mr Speaker, three important points emerge from this phrase alone. Firstly, the university seeks to align its structures with contemporary global standards in higher education. I have a university in my Constituency, and I started a crusade way back in 2010. By 2022, I gave up because I realised that I was not going to have any success. But even before I started my own crusade in Winneba, I did some work in all the other public universities and realised that the

situation in Winneba was the same as we have in other public universities. That has to do with corporate social responsibility.

Mr Speaker, if we go to Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST), University of Ghana, Legon, University of Cape Coast (UCC), and my own Constituency, University of Education, Winneba (UEW), one will hardly find tangible social impact programmes and projects that impact on the community. The budgets of these universities do not factor the community where they operate. That is a worrying situation. Therefore, if I read that the Committee is talking about the university aligning its policies with contemporary global standards in higher education, I am curious to know whether this means that after this enactment, they are now going to pay attention to corporate social responsibility. This is not only for KNUST, Kumasi alone, but for all other universities.

Back in the days, I remember when I was at St. Augustine's College, the Ogua Traditional Council was able to negotiate with the secondary schools in Cape Coast to give them a quota. So, it did not really matter, St. Augustine's, Adisadel College, Mfantshipim School and others, one needed to have a certain minimum qualification. But, back in the days, I remember very well that the Traditional Council was able to negotiate for a certain quota so that indigenes from Cape Coast could also get admission into these first-class secondary schools. Mr Speaker, there is no such thing in our

universities where they have a whole programme enacted by the Council to look at this. The essence of higher education is to create a balance and create a certain ecosystem of inclusiveness for everybody to have opportunity. There are those who are placed at the lowest ebb of fortune's wheel who may not get opportunity. There are communities that are impacted. In fact, Mr Speaker, if we go to Oxford, for instance, the whole economy of Oxford—and by the way, Mr Speaker, without boasting, I was privileged to have been educated there—the whole economy of Oxford, the Oxford city, is hinged on the University of Oxford. It is a fact. If we go to Harvard, which is in Boston, I hope I am right, Boston is an educational hub where Harvard and other universities are transforming the economy of that city.

6:43 p.m.

When we go to Switzerland, because of international diplomacy and international organisations that are populated there, universities there have taken advantage and are providing higher education. That is having an impact on the economy.

Mr Speaker, I know—The Deputy Majority Leader wants me to refer to his alma mater. I know he got his master's degree at the University of Chicago, a very prestigious university. I know the University of Chicago itself has a lot of social impact policies in Chicago, and people pride themselves in attending that university. It has this direct nexus with the community and city development.

Mr Speaker, we do not have that in our public universities in Ghana. What they have done well, which I applaud them for, is that when we saw the upsurge of private universities, they were quick to come up with programmes that made them attractive, and students preferred to be in public universities rather than going to private universities, not necessarily because of cost, but the prestige and the fact that there were programmes that they found attractive.

But that has not been done when it comes to this area. So, to the Hon Minister perhaps I am signalling my intention of bringing amendments, when we get to that stage, which would look at corporate social responsibility as part of this new KNUST. This is especially so, when it is clear from the Committee's report that this university is now saying it is embracing new contemporary global standards. This is because globally, those universities have certain standards that impact on the community.

Mr Speaker, my second point is on institutional capacity to deliver quality and technology-driven teaching. Today, diplomacy is even Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven. What are our universities doing? I just enquired from my Colleagues in that area, the educationists amongst us, whether any of our public universities is offering a programme in AI? Do we have a first-degree programme, BSc, AI technology? There is nothing like that. Are we being deliberate about this as a nation?

We are aware of what happened in the recent West African Senior Secondary Certificate Examination. We

are not here to talk about the politics of it; no. This is a national issue, and it goes to the root of the challenges we have. If we do not pay attention to all these, we will set up the university, come here with amendment to the law and the impact will be zero.

So, if the observation is that there are going to be innovation-driven research then we must tell our Minister, that it is not just about talking about research, but how much is invested in research. When COVID-19 struck, we know how relevant Noguchi Memorial Centre of Research became. After COVID-19 what have we done by way of expanding the frontiers of research and the investment we have made? Have we done anything? Are we really supporting our universities? Beyond the law we enact, are we also resourcing them? Are we going to stop at this enactment, or we will go beyond it? Is the Minister going to get Cabinet support to look at research support, or we are only interested in the tangibles?

Gold Board, there is gold, they are being sold, and the dollar to cedi rate is stable. When we are only creating a bubble, a burst will expose all of us when we are not investing in production, yet we say there is the Gold Board, this and that because there is stability. I agree that it may be temporary. So, we have to pay attention to this research and invest there.

Mr Speaker, I will conclude on one worrying thing, we know that the universities are by themselves very independent. All the recent enactments that we have passed on this floor, have

sought to allow them to operate independently with at least no Executive interference. Mr Speaker, I am not too sure what I am reading, but I am quite concerned and curious. Is this new law seeking to chip away the independence? It looks like today we have been talking about independence of institutions and all. I want clarity, and I am sure we will get there.

I read the Memorandum accompanying the Bill, but I am not too sure what the Hon Minister is seeking to do. Per Act 80, the council is the highest authority. It appoints its principal officer such as the Vice Chancellor (VC). The Chancellor is appointed by the President. Mr Speaker, what we are reading is not clear. But fortunately, the Minister himself is here. It appears that this new law is giving some powers to the president. It appears so. Mr Speaker, the Minister must bring clarity. The ambiguity is rather too glaring and too obvious.

Whenever the Executive proposes a Bill and decides to create such ambiguity, one must be concerned. It means that there is something under the sleeves of the Executive. Mr Speaker, we know that the overlord of Ashantis is the Chancellor and it has always been. Now this enactment is introducing a term limit and saying that, no, he has to be appointed. There has to be clarity. So, they are saying that if he serves two terms, he is no more qualified. Is that what they are saying? When the existing law confers certain rights? That is why I am saying that I know the Minister has what it takes to bring clarity.

We do not want a KNUST that will be controlled by the Executive. I do not think for a moment that that is their intention. They are giving some limited powers to make appointments. But even so, those are fettered powers by law. We cannot have them absolute. This Bill is introducing—

Mr Speaker, what is clear is that a certain level of ambiguity is being introduced in the Memorandum accompanying this, Bill. It is not too clear how the powers of the Chancellor are to be administered, how those powers are to be exercised. We are not so clear to what extent; the President is now invading into the powers of the Chancellor in addition to his already wider powers given to him by the 1992 Constitution.

6:53 p.m.

Mr Speaker, how independent would KNUST be after today? That is the main concern. How independent will KNUST be? How independent can the Vice Chancellor be in taking decisions and managing the affairs of the university with the deans and other faculty heads after today? There has to be clarity. From what I am reading, we are now giving those powers to the President. The Minister must clarify. He has the opportunity to clarify. Has there been wider consultations in the Ashanti Region, the media stakeholders, the chiefs, and the people? Have they seen this amendment?

Mr Speaker, under this reset dispensation, we have been told that they engage in wider consultation. We do not

want to start this Bill, and then they will withdraw as usual and say they are coming back again because it is in accordance with our Rules. Mr Speaker, the Minister must tell us the extent of consultation and engagement with the immediate stakeholders in the Ashanti Region, particularly the traditional authorities. We need to know. Because this Bill is taking away some rights and powers. It is doing away with some relationships that the traditional authority had with the University, which has helped it to grow that far.

Mr Speaker, I shall conclude by urging the respected Minority Leader, as he then was, Hon Haruna Iddrisu, to take on board all the views, all the issues and concerns we have raised, and address them for the purpose of clarity, even as we proceed to deal with this Bill. Mr Speaker, on matters of campuses to be established and future expansions, we would deal with it at the Consideration Stage so I would not belabour the point.

Mr Speaker, let me thank you for indulging me.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Majority Bench?

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, we want the Hon Minister to clear the doubts from the minds of the Minority Leader—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That does not lie in your mouth, so it is either you are speaking, or you are not speaking.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we are yielding to—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Minister has the right to conclude, so if you are not going to make use of the opportunity to speak as the Majority Bench, leave that to me.

Hon Minister, you may conclude.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I should thank you once again for the support and thank the Chairperson and Members of the Committee. I want to particularly thank Prof Mrs Rita Akosua Dickson, the Vice-Chancellor of the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, and Council Chairman Nana Akyamfoo Asafo Boakye Agyemang-Bonsu. They sat through the meeting with the Committee on Education.

Mr Speaker, I should also put on record that the existing Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology Act, 1961 (Act 80), is what we are revising. Mr Speaker, it has gone through a thorough consultative process. The University itself set up the Prof John Tia Bugri Status and Acts Review Committee, and they made recommendations.

Subsequently, we engaged with Otumfuo, the Asantehene, Council Chairperson and Vice-Chancellor, before the Bill was introduced. Mr Speaker, there is nowhere in the Bill where there is a proposition for the President to appoint the Chancellor of the University. The Chancellor is determined by the Council of the University. President Mahama has appointed, as I mentioned, Akyamfoo

Asafo Boakye Agyemang-Bonsu as the Chairman of Council.

Mr Speaker, in this Bill, academic freedom is guaranteed and assured, and the University is assured of it. Let me assure the Hon Minority Leader that consultation was thorough. On corporate social responsibility (CSR), we have taken his view on it. But naturally, when universities are doing admissions, they pay respect to their immediate catchment and environment, and I am sure in the use of their Internal Generated Fund (IGF), they will be guided by what he has mentioned.

Mr Speaker, yesterday, the Hon Vincent Assafuah sat through the Committee's meeting to share his own personal experience that he was unable to pursue law because his father could not afford the fees at the time. That is why the Government has introduced the No Fees Stress Policy to support those who may be financially excluded.

So, Mr Speaker, I want to thank Members for their support, and then assure that Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology has one of the best medical schools in the country, and the Government is working to equip and get the teaching hospital operationalised before the end of the year 2026, so that it can take some burden off for another teaching hospital.

Mr Speaker, once again, I thank our Colleagues and they should be assured. We have encouraged the University to lead with Artificial Intelligence (A.I.). They should be the first as a science and

technology dedicated University. I myself express concern that they should not be admitting more students into social sciences and humanities, so that they stay to their core mandate.

Once again, I am grateful.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025 accordingly read a Second time.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may we pray you to take the items on *Order Paper Addendum 2*, we would lay a Paper and then take the Motion numbered 2. So, I pray that we take item numbered 1 on *Order Paper Addendum 2*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That has already been done.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, the Majority Chief Whip is talking about *Order Paper Addendum 2*. We are now being given *Order Paper Addendum 2*. We do not want to believe that when the Minister for the Interior, with additional responsibility to National Security, enters this Chamber, he comes with all his might.

Mr Speaker, he came, and they quickly printed this *Order Paper Addendum 2*. We have not been given copies. When I got up, the Clerk-at-the-Table brought it. Mr Speaker, the Minister for the Interior has been in

Leadership before, and we have all his records as a Minority Chief Whip. He has always emphasised consultation. He said there must be consultation and procedure. He did not engage. The Deputy Majority Leader had discussed the possibility of looking at this. Mr Speaker, if he wants to do it, at least put us on notice and tell us why.

7:03 p.m.

Mr Speaker, these things must stop. If they want to run a one-sided Parliament, they should say so and the CSOs will come after them. They are the only people they fear. When the Minority is telling them to do the right thing, they set up a Government *WhatsApp*—They think they would have their support forever? They should wait and see. Soon and very soon, the CSOs will leave them at no parking. They are the people they fear, so they created a Government *WhatsApp* group where they leak information to them and alert them ahead of time. Very soon, they will see. The Majority should listen to this Side of the House. We are their partners in this Chamber. When we talk, they should listen.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Hon Minority Leader misses the Chamber. He has been away for some time so I even suspect that the 15-day rule may kick in.

Mr Speaker, I believe that the item numbered 1 is captured in the frame of the way it is, but the particular matter has not been tackled, so I believe that after we lay it, we will engage and explain the

circumstances. So, we will stand it down and take—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, subject to the pleasure of the House, can we lay the Report and defer the consideration of the Motion?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we are obliged.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, we are part of the governance architecture of the country, and we do not do the usual thing with national security matters. The Deputy Majority Leader had hinted me on this matter, so we would oblige them to lay and take the Report because that was the prayer. We do not mind because this has to do with the national security of our state. But Mr Speaker, the amount, when they cannot provide for the Women Development Bank that they stated in their Manifesto—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, are you debating the Motion? The Report has not been laid. The Motion has not been moved. But it appears you are in the mood to debate the Motion.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, you know opposition matters are always at large. We are in opposition—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I understand you are in opposition, and you are the Opposition Leader, but as Opposition Leader, you do not operate too much outside the rules.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: It is always at large, but it is all right. I was only signalling them that the amount that they are giving to the Minister for the Interior with additional responsibility—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, you are forcing me to say that you are out of order.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with all the provocation, he has decided not to respond. He has to respond.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, Hon Minority Leader, you are compelling me to say that you are operating completely out of order.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, he cannot be quiet today. Hon Muntaka is not known for being quiet. He has taken GH¢4 billion, *nti w'aye din*. He cannot be quiet. *Sika mpe dede*. [Laughter] He cannot be quiet today. *W'anum aye ma nti wo mpe se wo kasa*. *Wo be kasa*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I will urge Hon Muntaka to resist the temptation.

Hon Members, *Order Paper Addendum 2*, Presentation of Papers, Chairperson of the Committee

PAPER

By the Chairperson of the Committee—

Report of the Committee on Security and Intelligence on the Annual Budget Estimates of the

National Security Council for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Report duly presented, and it is for distribution to the House.

Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I pray that we turn to *Order Paper Addendum* and take the Motions numbered 8 and 9.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion numbered 8.

MOTION

Suspension of Standing Order 169(1)

Minister for Education (Mr Haruna Iddrisu): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 169(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that when a Bill has been read a second time, the Bill shall pass through a Consideration Stage which shall not be taken until at least two sitting days have elapsed, the Consideration Stage of the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025 may be *taken* today.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Motion moved, any seconder?

Mr Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, I beg second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now, we will take the item numbered 9, Kwame Nkrumah, University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025 at Consideration Stage

BILL — CONSIDERATION STAGE

Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025

Clause 1 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 2 — Aims of the University

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, amendment proposed, sub-clause 2(d), *delete* and *insert* the following:

“Provide students with an understanding of global affairs through the application of modern tools including emerging technologies for teaching, learning and dissemination of knowledge in support of sustainable development.”

I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I have not seen any advertised amendment on the *Order Paper*.

Hon Members, on this note, I will take two minutes' suspension.

7:12 p.m. — *Sitting suspended.*

7:22 p.m. — *Sitting resumed.*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, kindly resume your seats. Chairman of the Committee, I humbly advise that the Committee's proposed amendment be printed on the *Order Paper Addendum*. It is neater that way, and everybody would be carried on board. So, temporarily, we suspend the consideration of the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi Bill, 2025. We shall come back to it shortly.

Now, we will go to *Order Paper Addendum 2*—Motion.

ANNUAL ESTIMATES, 2026

NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL

Chairperson of the Committee (Dr Zanetor Agyeman-Rawlings): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Security and Intelligence on the allocation of the sum of GH¢3,751,733,088.00 for the services of the National Security Council for the year ending 31st December 2026.

And in so doing, I present your Committee's Report.

Introduction

The Budget and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026

Financial Year was presented on Thursday, 13th November, 2025, by the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, in accordance with Article 179(1) of the 1992 Constitution, Section 21 of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921) and Order 193 of the Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana.

Pursuant to Order 195(4) and 258(3) of the Standing Orders, the Rt Hon Speaker referred the 2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the National Security Council Secretariat to the Parliamentary Select Committee on Security and Intelligence for consideration and report.

Deliberations

The Committee met on Thursday, 4th December, 2025, and considered the Budget Estimates of the National Security Council Secretariat for the 2026 financial year. The Committee was assisted in its deliberations by the Hon Minister for the Interior with responsibility for National Security, Alhaji Mohammed-Mubarak Muntaka; the National Security Coordinator, COP Osman Abdul Razak; officials of the National Security Council Secretariat, National Intelligence Bureau, National Signals Bureau, the Research Department and the Ministry of Finance.

The Committee expresses its appreciation to the Hon Minister, Heads of Agencies and officials of the Ministry of Finance for their support.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents during the consideration of the 2026 Budget Estimates of the National Security Council Secretariat:

- i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;
- ii. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana;
- iii. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year;
- iv. The Programme-Based Budget (PBB) Estimates of the National Security Council Secretariat for 2026;
- v. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year; and
- vi. The Presentation of the National Security Council Secretariat at the Committee's 2026 Budget Hearing.

Agencies Under the National Security Council Secretariat

- i. National Security Council Secretariat (NSCS)
- ii. National Intelligence Bureau (NIB)

- iii. National Signals Bureau (NSB)

- iv. Research Department (RD)

Core Functions

The National Security Council Secretariat performs the following functions:

- i. formulates, implements, co-ordinates, monitors and evaluates national security policies and programmes;
- ii. promotes political tolerance, stability, security and peace in Ghana and the sub-region;
- iii. enhances institutional capacity and creates an enabling environment for effective, efficient and sustainable service delivery;
- iv. provides timely internal and external intelligence for policy directions;
- v. maintains physical security at vital installations in the Regions and Districts throughout the year;
- vi. liaises with Agencies to organise training programmes for National Security Personnel and Operatives; and
- vii. gathers economic intelligence to provide appropriate and relevant information to Ghanaian businesses to boost economic activity within the sub-region.

Financial Performance for the 2025 Financial Year

5.1 Total Approved Budget for 2025

For the 2025 fiscal year, a total amount of two-billion, nine hundred and ninety-eight million, four hundred and thirty-three thousand, seven hundred and

seventy-six Ghana cedis (GH¢2,998,433,776.00) was allocated to National Security Council Secretariat, the National Intelligence Bureau, the National Signals Bureau and the Research Department for its planned programmes and activities for the year 2025. The table 1 below shows the allocations.

Table 1 Economic classification and sources of funding for 2025

ITEM	2025 BUDGETARY ALLOCATIONS APPROVED (JAN – DEC)
COMPENSATION OF EMPLOYEES	2,348,677,923.00
GOODS & SERVICES	176,960,000.00
MONS-HQ SPECIAL OPERATIONS	373,040,000.00
CAPEX	99,755,853.00
TOTAL	2,998,433,776.00

Source: 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy & Appropriation Act,2025 (Act 1126) (A breakdown of the approved budget as contained in the Statement and Appropriation Act, 2025 are attached as Appendices)

Expenditure and Outstanding balance for 2025

For the year 2025, the expenditure of the National Security Council Secretariat as at November 2025 stood at two-

billion, nine hundred and ninety-eight million, four hundred and thirty-three thousand, seven hundred and seventy-six Ghana cedis (GH¢2,998,433,776) of the total allocation as shown in table 2.

Table 2: Releases and Expenditure for the year 2025 as at November, 2025

Expenditure Classification	2025 Approved Budget (Gh¢) A	Amount Released (Gh¢) as at November, 2025 B	Amount Utilised (Gh¢) as at November, 2025 C	VARIANCE D=(A-B)
<i>Compensation of Employees</i>	2,348,677,923.00	2,197,776,464.37	2,197,776,464.37	150,901,458.63
<i>Goods & Services</i>	550,000,000	560,760,000	560,760,000	(10,760,000.00)
<i>Capex</i>	99,755,853	26,901,733.20	26,901,733.20	72,854,119.80
GRAND TOTAL	2,998,433,776	2,785,438,197.57	2,785,438,197.57	212,995,578.43

Source: Secretariat's Presentation to the Committee on Security and Intelligence

Performance Overview

National Security Council Secretariat

The National Security Council Secretariat (NSCS) successfully undertook Project Karel, a command-and-control course for security officers in collaboration with UK-JCTAT, and conducted a RECCE, ahead of the annual Ex Homeshield Programme. The Secretariat's 'See Something, Say Something' Campaign effectively engaged over 13,000 congregants across churches and mosques throughout the country.

Further, the Secretariat completed 13 mechanised boreholes in the Ho Central Municipality and the Ho West District for some key public institutions. These include: Tanyigbe Senior High School; OLA Girls' Senior High School; Ho Technical Institute; Awudome Senior High School; Mawuko Girls Senior High School; Ho Air Field Cluster of Schools; and Taviefe Health Centre in the Ho Central Municipality.

The Secretariat continued to facilitate linkages with development partners and international organisations such as Global Community Engagement and Resilience Fund (GCERF) to leverage technical support and funding for human security programming.

What is more, the Secretariat also secured approval for engagement with the Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund) to support school infrastructure projects in deprived border communities. It improved its human resource capacity and capabilities of officers in both technical and operational know-how regarding evolving security threats, trends, and global best practices.

National Intelligence Bureau

The National Intelligence Bureau (NIB) undertook operations in countering violent extremism, organised crimes and other related national security threats, and completed investigations on twelve (12) dockets in respect of

Operation Recover All Loot (ORAL), and other serious offences of national importance.

The Bureau arrested and seized the highest cocaine bust in the country's history, weighing 3,319.66 kilogramme with a street value estimated over three hundred and fifty million dollars (US\$350,000,000.00).

In addition, the Bureau forwarded actionable intelligence to the National Security Council Secretariat and other relevant stakeholders, contributing to informed policy decisions and improved national security. The Bureau also established four (4) new operational command headquarters in Nkawkaw, in the Eastern Region; Konongo and Offinso in the Ashanti Region; and Atebubu in the Bono East Region.

National Signals Bureau

The National Signals Bureau (NSB) monitored and analysed political, social and security developments and provided intelligence reports to relevant government agencies and decision-makers. The Bureau conducted regular security audits, promoted best practices in information assurance, and collaborated with other agencies and stakeholders to mitigate cyber threats.

Also, the Bureau facilitated knowledge sharing, capacity building, and technical assistance, ultimately enhancing the Bureau's effectiveness in achieving its goals.

Additionally, the Bureau implemented measures to enhance communication

networks and infrastructure which ensured reliable and secure communications for security, intelligence, emergency response, and other government agencies.

Furthermore, the Bureau supported security agencies in the areas of digital forensics and identification and mitigation of social media threats promoting misinformation and disinformation in the country.

Research Department

The Research Department provided intelligence for the protection and enhancement of national security, particularly in the area of terrorism and other existential security threats to the country.

It continued to deploy officers on short-and-long-term assignments in various countries to enable the Department to achieve its objectives.

Likewise, the Department expanded scope of liaison operations by significantly increasing the number of liaison partners, and participated in regional security meetings to have first knowledge of emerging threats in the region to enhance security and protection of the state.

As part of its mandate, the Department deployed Officers to liaise with its external counterparts in countries that the President, the Vice-President, the Speaker of Parliament and other high-profile dignitaries visited to ensure that their movements, personal

security, vehicles and accommodation were secure under the appropriate protection of the Department's Officers and those of the state security agencies of the host countries.

Further, the Department also conducted due diligence on companies and persons to enable public institutions to take decisions on government businesses.

Implementation Challenges in 2025

The challenges faced by the National Security Council Secretariat are listed below:

- i. Inadequate allocation and delay in release of funds;
- ii. Changing trends of modern-day crimes;
- iii. Increasing terrorism threats;
- iv. Logistical and technical constraints;
- v. Inadequate staff strength in the newly created and operational regions;
- vi. Inadequate and obsolete equipment; and
- vii. Under-capacity in critical areas such as cyber skills-gap.

Outlook for 2026

Among others, the National Security Council Secretariat aims to undertake the following programmes and projects in the 2026 fiscal year:

- i. complete the review of the National Security Strategy (NSS), commence and monitor implementation;
- ii. undertake intelligence, technical and operational trainings to enhance the competencies of personnel in countering the threats of emerging modern-day crimes;
- iii. continue investigations in respect of Operation Recover All Loot (ORAL) and other serious offences of national importance;
- iv. establish new operational command headquarters in Paga in the Upper East Region; Bimbila in the Northern Region; Hamile in the Upper West Region; Bole in the Savannah Region; Akosombo and Asamankese in the Eastern Region; Sogakope in the Volta Region; and Enchi in the Western North Region;
- v. purchase security and other office equipment to augment operations of the Secretariat, especially in the newly created operational commands;
- vi. continue to prioritise the maintenance of a secure and reliable infrastructure and communications security;
- vii. construct new headquarters building, data centre and a new office building to accommodate the increase of personnel; and

viii. intensify covert operations to obtain more useful intelligence to safeguard national security.

Budgetary Allocation for the 2026 Financial Year

The National Security Council Secretariat has been allocated a total amount of three-billion, seven hundred

and fifty-one million, seven hundred and thirty-three thousand, and eighty-eight Ghana cedis (GH¢3,751,733,088.00) for its planned programmes and activities for the year 2026.

The breakdown of the allocation, by source of funding and economic classification, is presented in Tables 3 and 4.

Table 3: Budgetary Allocation by Sources of Funding and Economic Classification

Economic Classification	Source of Fund				
	GoG (GH¢)	IGF (GH¢)	Donor (GH¢)	Total (GH¢)	%
Compensation	2,441,977,235.00			2,441,977,235.00	65.1
Goods and Services	386,960,000.00			386,960,000.00	10.3
Special Operations	863,040,000.00			863,040,000.00	23
Capex	59,755,853.00			59,755,853.00	1.6
Total	3,751,733,088.00			3,751,733,088.00	100
%	100			100	

Source: 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy and the Presentation of NSCS

Table 4: Budgetary Allocation for Cost Centres under the NSCS for 2026

S/N	AGENCY	Compensation of Employees	Goods and Services	Capex	Total (GH¢)
1	National Security Council Secretariat	427,318,514	1,017,443,087	16,585,285	1,461,346,886
2	National Intelligence Bureau	715,251,628	97,954,646	16,585,284	829,791,558
3	National Signals Bureau	564,877,864	79,691,916	16,585,284	661,155,064
4	Research Department	734,529,229	54,910,351	10,000,000	799,439,580
	GRAND TOTAL	2,441,977,235	1,250,000,000	59,755,853	3,751,733,088

Source: 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy and the Presentation of NSCS

Observations and Recommendations

During the Committee's meeting to consider the 2026 Budget Estimates of

the National Security Council Secretariat, some observations were made and where necessary, recommendations made:

Stand-Alone Budget Line for Special Operations

The Committee observed that the utilised amount of five hundred and sixty million, seven hundred and sixty thousand Ghana cedis (GH¢560,760,000) for goods and services as at November, 2025 was more than the amount of five hundred and fifty million Ghana Cedis (GH¢550,000,000.00) allocated for goods and services for 2025. It was explained that the amount utilised for goods and services was largely for Special Operations, which is captured under the goods and services economic classification. The Secretariat further informed the Committee that the classification of Special Operations under goods and services had resulted in inadequate releases for the actual goods and services for the Secretariat.

In cognisance of the inadequate releases for the actual goods and services for the Secretariat, the Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance should separate the special operations budget line from goods and services so that the Special Operations becomes a stand-alone budget item.

Increase in 2026 Goods and Services Ceiling

The Committee found that the ceiling for goods and services for 2026, GH¢1,250,000,000, exceeded the 2025 allocation of GH¢550,000,000 by about 126 per cent. The Committee was informed that the increase is as a result of the increase in the establishment of

new regional and district offices to boost the performance of the Regional and District Security Councils. This expansion comes with additional costs, particularly in the provision and movement of logistics and equipment.

In addition, the increase takes into consideration the implementation of the new National Security Strategy.

Source of Funding

The Committee observed that the entire budget of the Secretariat is Government of Ghana (GoG) funded, with no internally generated fund or donor support. This heavy reliance on the Government of Ghana (GoG) funding exposes the National Security Council's core activities, including intelligence gathering, risk monitoring, cybersecurity operations, and field deployments to significant fiscal vulnerabilities. Hence, a fall in the national revenue performance or delay in releases may cause operational disruptions. The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance should ensure the timely release of funds to the Secretariat, considering its critical role.

Reduction in Capital Expenditure Ceiling for 2026

The Committee noted that the ceiling for 2026 which amounted to GH¢59,755,853.00 was about 40 per cent less than the 2025 allocation of GH¢99,755,853.00. The reduction, according to the Co-ordinator, will adversely affect its work and operations for the year.

Furthermore, the decline in CAPEX raises important concerns about the Secretariat's long-term infrastructure development, surveillance capabilities, and technological modernisation. The Committee, therefore, recommends that this imbalance should be addressed as it may limit the Secretariat's ability to invest in critical security assets which could weaken future operational effectiveness.

Quarterly Budget Reporting

The Committee observed that the nature of the activities and operations of the National Security Council Secretariat and its agencies often results in unforeseen expenditures, leading to spending beyond the approved budgetary allocation. In view of the above, the Committee recommends that the National Security Council Secretariat submit quarterly reports on its budget expenditure for the Committee to be abreast of the adjustments made.

Conclusion

The Committee, having taken into account the critical role played by the National Security Council Secretariat in enhancing security, freedom of the citizenry and national development, is of the considered view that the Secretariat must be adequately resourced to effectively discharge its mandate in the 2026 Fiscal Year.

In the light of the foregoing, the Committee respectfully recommends to the House to adopt its Report and approve the sum of:

three-billion, seven hundred and fifty-one million, seven hundred and thirty-three thousand, and eighty-eight Ghana cedis (GH¢3,751,733,088.00) to enable the National Security Council Secretariat to implement its programmes and activities for the fiscal year ending 31st December 2026.

Respectfully submitted.

Vice-Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Oscar Ofori Larbi): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, to open the debate, it took two minutes to understand, and I will ask the Minister for the Interior to give the entire House the same background leading to this particular Motion.

Question proposed.

Minister for the Interior (Alhaji Mohammed-Mubarak Muntaka) (MP): Mr Speaker, if you recollect, exactly a week today, a number of Motions were moved. And if you check the records, you will see that the Motion numbered 34 of last week, Tuesday, was that the honourable House adopts the Report of the Joint Committee on Defence, Interior and Security, and Intelligence, the allocation sum. When they were putting the sum together, there was an error because the sum was supposed to be the sum of both the Ministry of the Interior and the National Security. The total would have been GH¢16.3 billion.

Unfortunately, the figure presented that day was only GH¢12.5 billion, which is for only the Ministry of the Interior, leaving that of National Security. There were two options: either come back to the Floor to correct the figure, or, better still, proceed with the full Motion on National Security. We opted to take the full Motion so that we will now have the 3.7, which will be added to the 12.5 that was taken last week.

So, Mr Speaker, there is no challenge for those who want to get clarity from the Budget document. On page 184 of the Budget document, we will see that items 37 and 38, 37 says the Ministry of the Interior, then 38 shows the National Security Council and when we put the two figures together, it is supposed to give us GH¢16.3 billion but that day, we took it as 12.5 billion.

This is just to correct that and ensure the correct figures are captured in the Appropriation. That is why we are taking this Motion. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leader.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I am not contributing yet, but I just want a proper foundation laid for the matter the Minister addressed a moment ago. Now, he referred to the Budget, and the page he referred us to, is there a line item which has National Security Council GH¢3,751,733,088?

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, rightly so. That is why I made reference

to the page. If the document is next to him, it is on page 184 of the Budget. He can take a look at it. So, on page 184 of the main Budget, appendix 4(a), item numbered 37. We will see the Minister of the Interior. To the extreme end, it states GH¢12,577,077,977. When we look at item numbered 38, it gives the National Security Council. Also, to the extreme end, it states GH¢3,751,733,088, which is what is captured on the *Addendum 2*.

So, if we were to have the *Order Paper* of last week, Tuesday, which was on the 9th, we would see that the total figure that was supposed to be captured for the two, because I supervised it, I was supposed to move the Motion as one, it should have been GH¢16.3 billion. That is putting the 12.7 and 3.7 together. But, unfortunately, that day, the total was 12.7, meaning that only that of the Ministry of the Interior was captured. And that of the National Security Council was left out. So, we had two options, as I said earlier: to either come back to the Floor to correct the figure, or to come by the Motion, as we are doing now, to take that of the National Security Council. And we opted to do this because, as we recollect last week, we did not even have the opportunity to look at and debate the Reports.

So, that is why we opted for this, just to capture that of the National Security Council appropriately, so that it will pave the way for it to feature properly in the Appropriation.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, for further clarity, and we are all learning. The figure that he says came under the Ministry of the Interior, 12 billion, that one I agree. He says that the actual amount for the National Security Council is GH¢ 3,751,733,088. However, under that item, it is incomplete. He has a research department of 64,910,351. So, Mr Speaker, if we approve the 3,751, what it means is that the research department of 64 will still be hanging, because that was not part of the 12.5 that was earlier approved under the Ministry of the Interior.

Mr Speaker, the item numbered 38 that the Hon Minister referred to has the National Security Council, the National Security Headquarters and Agencies, and the Research Department.

7:32 p.m.

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, kindly, the Hon Minority Leader should just note that we have it say ‘of which’. One may ask why was it said that just beneath the National Security Council we have ‘of which National Security Council Headquarters and Agencies’? This is because, the way we operate currently is that as we may know, the Research Department largely operates under the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, but all the others work at the National Security Council. That is why the figure was repeated when we talked about ‘of which National Security Council Headquarters and agencies’, including the research. That is why you now have

of which GH¢64,910,315 is stated. That GH¢64,910,315 is part of the GH¢3.7 billion. It is clearly part of the GH¢3.7 billion.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, then I have an issue, because under item 38, we have that same figure repeating, it is at the GH¢3,751,733,088, coming under National Security Headquarters and Agencies. So, it says at GH¢3.7 billion, of which National Security Headquarters and Agencies, it repeats the figure. I agree. When we come to the next one, the Research Department, compensation is not provided for; I agree. But what I am asking is that if they now provide for GH¢64 million over there, they need to do some additions. They cannot say that the first one of which, then the amount is repeated. There is some problem there, because the headline has the main amount, and then if we follow through, we would realise that there is some consistency. Other expenditure is added up to get the main amount. We cannot repeat National Security Council Headquarters and Agencies, and the same figure, then we say Research Department, GH¢64 million, then they come and tell us that it is part of it. When one adds, they will get the same figure.

Hon Minister, with respect, I think we have been handling this Budget. Go back to item 37. If you look at item 37, if we add all of it, we will realise that we will get that figure of GH¢12,577,077,977. How come when it gets to the National Security, we are unable to add up?

Mr Speaker, if they check what they have under paragraph 37 of page 184, they will see that there is some consistency when they add the numbers. But the National Security, there is something wrong there. Mr Speaker, it is there in black and white.

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, there is nothing wrong. Every time we say “of which”, it means that it is embedded. As we may know, if we are going to take the argument of my Minority Leader, then what it means is that under the ‘of which Research Department’, when we say ‘compensation’, it means that nobody under Research Department will be paid for that year. That is what it will mean. But they will be paid. I can give them the actual figures here. When it comes to the Research Department, the compensation is about GHC734 million—
[Interruption]

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Which document are you referring to?

Alhaji Muntaka: I am talking about the Committee’s Report, which you also have. We have Goods and Services, GHC54, 910,000—[Interruption]. That is page 10 of the Committee’s Report. Are you with me now? So, we have all the figures, and one will see that it sums up to the GHC3.751 billion. Look at that Report.

I am saying that, yes, the total figure that I was giving for the national security is the GHC3.7 billion. If we want to see the actual breakdown— Rationally, they should even state all the others, the like National Signal Bureau and the National Investigative Bureau, which have not

been done here. So, what we have here, the most interesting thing is the global figure. Embedded in it are all these that has not been stated here. But, if we go to the Appropriation Bill, we are going to be looking at the global figure and the National Security. I am telling them that the Research Department has not been left out. What they printed there, yes, to you and I, may not make sense, because we will say, based on what they printed in the Budget, the Hon Member is saying that research will not receive any compensation, but they have. Over GHC700 million is there. So, concentrate on the global figure because we said ‘of which’. Any time we talk about ‘of which’ in reading Budget, it means that it is embedded in the global figure.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister, with his experience in this Chamber, is right in his submissions, and I would concede to that. But there is a fundamental problem, which is not caused by him, which is not his fault. He refers to the Committee’s Report that has the right details, and I agree. Of course, he is a Member of Government. It is not for him to let that rotten tooth be pulled out from his mouth. I will pull that rotten tooth out. Mr Speaker, the Budget has a problem. He remembers that when I was closing the comment on behalf of the Minority, I pointed out that this Budget is a cut and paste Budget. We have listened to him—

I will show you—[Interruption]

Mr Speaker, if we go into the Budget, there are a lot of repetitions. Look at the

figure, the Minister is quoting right from the Committee's Report. The additions there are correct. But if we come here, they said 'of which', add up— This is the parent document.

Mr Speaker, they cannot place something on nothing. It will fall. This is the place where all these figures are emanating from. If it is wrong here, they cannot get it right here. It means that these, these are new figures that are coming from somewhere. I said it at the Despatch box that they should go back to the Ministry, take their time and read their Budget again and correct these figures. The Minister is right. If we add up in the Report, we would get the figure in the Appropriation right.

By the way, why are they burdening me? I am not even a finance person and I am educating them on finance? I did not read Finance. They could not add up their own figures in the parent Budget? Mr Speaker, this is simple mathematics. If they add up the paragraph 37— if we compare paragraphs 37 to the other paragraphs, they add up. Under paragraph 38, the figures are missing. They say there is no compensation. Meanwhile, in the Committee's Report, it is being provided for. The compensation must come from the Budget. So, one would ask where did it come from? As Leader of Government Business, they should only give assurance to the House that these errors will be corrected so that we make progress. But they should not attempt to force their way. Otherwise, we will challenge this Committee Report because this Committee Report and these

details are not founded in this parent document. It is the Budget that goes to the Committee for us to consider the Estimates. These are basic, 189 MPs. This is basic. That is why they must listen to the Minority. These are basic, which they should get right. When we are correcting them, they will not listen.

The Minister has made a good point and I am reasonable enough to appreciate where he is coming from, only if the Majority Frontbench will be gracious enough to concede that their Budget has a problem. They did not take their time to go through the Budget. They just brought it here to do their normal propaganda, but now they have been exposed.

7:42 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I think we have even concluded the debate. So, I intend to put the Question. After this elaborate explanation by the Minority Leader, what else does he have to say on the Motion?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I do not know why these two gentlemen are up on their feet. They should know when they have no case.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: In order to avoid three people standing, let me put the Question

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I know the circumstances we are in, but Mr Speaker, only if they will concede that their Budget—Or he wants

to correct me? Mr Speaker, if he says he wants to correct me, then there is no problem.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, you know I do not have the power to judge, so all I need to is for the Motion before us to be debated. Minority Leader, your debates have concluded everything. Do you want to debate again as to whether this correction should be made? Yes, Deputy Majority Leader?

Deputy Majority Leader (Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan): Mr Speaker, I know that Minority Leader is a lawyer. He is not a finance person, neither is he a mathematician. What is here is a presentation issue. What is here is exactly what is supposed to be here. I will explain. He said he was trying to educate us, so I think we need to give him better education on this.

What is here is exactly right. The two figures we see there that comes to GH¢64 million is basically goods and services and CAPEX. When we look at the other ones which have been put together, which is the National Intelligence Bureau and the National Signals Bureau, it is part of— If we look at page 184, we would realise that on research department, there is no figure for compensation. This is because that compensation figure is already part of this the figure above it.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: But they are a different unit.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: They have put the compensation on this together, that is what it is. Let us go back to all the budgets that we have done. We would realise that this keeps repeating itself, Mr Speaker. There is nothing here that is different from what is on this paper. It is exactly the same thing. He is just misreading it and misleading the House. The information here is the same, and there is absolutely nothing wrong here. So, he should not tell us that this budget has not been presented; it has been presented the way it has been done for years. The only thing that has been done here is that they have gone further to break down—The budget has actually put the sums together.

On one line, the same figure that we see which is the GH¢3.7 billion has been repeated because the one on top is the total for everything and the second one is a breakdown of the Bureau, and they have separated the research department. The only thing is that compensation for the National Security Council is put together. These are cost centres, and the figures have been put at different cost centres. But salaries, which is the compensation, are paid as a bulk and that is why it sits in one place. There is nothing wrong with these figures here. He is not a finance person. He should not try to mislead the House. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, these are reputational issues, so permit me.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, if I want to understand, the compensation for the employees at the research department is not part of the national security?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, kindly hear me. The Hon Deputy Majority Leader who is a finance person explained something to us. I disagree on the very foundation on which he mounted his explanation. Let us go back to it.

Mr Speaker, we have paragraph 38 which has a global figure, and sub to that, it has introduced cost centres. It is the additions that are made that sum up to the global figure. Is that not so? They have introduced—

Mr Dafeamekpor — rose —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Chief Whip, I will give you the floor after him. So, hold it. I will give you the floor after him with all due respect so that you can counter.

Minority Leader, kindly be brief.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, the cost centres that have been introduced are supposed to add up to the global figure that has already been introduced. If that is so, under the cost centres, we have two items that have been introduced. Therefore, these two cost centres must add up to make the 3.7. Is that not so? Now, first, we have National Security Headquarters and agencies, add it to the research department. Let us forget about the compensation. I would concede on the compensation, but if we add up the two, we do not get what has been provided for.

Meanwhile, what the Minister explained which is in the Report is different from what is here because that

provides details of the various departments. *[Interruption]* Let me make my point. The Committee's Report gives a complete breakdown of the cost centre, whereas in the Budget, it provided for only two cost centres. That is why I am saying that when we go to the item numbered 37, there is a detailed breakdown of all the agencies. Why is it that when it gets to the 38, only two agencies are introduced? But when we go to the Committee's Report, it has all the cost centres. That is what I want him to clarify.

Dr Agyeman-Rawlings: If the Minority Leader will kindly look at page 184, the number 38, the National Security Council gives the global figure of which National Security Council Headquarters and agencies which is still that global figure of which the research department is then presented. This is because the research department is always separate because it finds itself under a different Ministry, that is why it has been put where it is. So, it is actually presented correctly; it is not a repetition.

The National Security Council is the umbrella Agency under which we have the headquarters and agencies, which still presents that global figure, and that is broken down from which we have the research department. That is where the GH¢64 million plus comes from.

7:52 p.m.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, well explained. Therefore, my question is, is the GH¢64 million plus part of the GH¢3,751,733,088.00?

Dr Agyeman-Rawlins: That is correct. If we look at this version of the budget that is relating to the breakdown specific to the sector— it is on this page here and I can show it to him. It breaks it down exactly into where we have the research department broken into Goods and Services, which is the GH¢54,910,351, and the Capital Expenditure (CAPEX) which is the GH¢10 million. That adds up to the GH¢64 million.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: The respected Chairperson of the Committee is right. I have that version of the Estimates, but it still does not answer the fundamental question in the main budget. Mr Speaker, it is not politics that we are doing. It is the issue at stake which must be acknowledged and rectified. They need to rectify this. It is something that has to be done. They cannot get it right in that document and then put all of them together in another document.

In other paragraphs, they have itemised them and created cost centres for each one of them. But when it gets here, they said its head agencies and give us a global figure. That explanation, I buy it, but they are supposed to give a breakdown. They are saying in the previous budget, this is how it is. I am sorry, it is not the case. If you say —

[Interruption]. No, I came to this House with the Hon Member together; he should not say he has been in this House long time ago. That is what you said. We came together, and I got into Leadership long before him. And right here in this Chamber, I am the Senior-most. I am the most senior in Leadership. He knows it —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I humbly ask that you both resume your seats.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopts the sum of GH¢3,751,733,088.00 for the services of the National Security Council for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Yes, Deputy Majority Leader?

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, I think we want to end the Business for today. We have been here for five hours, so we are in your hands.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was adjourned at 7:56 p.m. till Wednesday, 17th December 2025, at 12:00 noon.

